

MOVEMENTAL · ONBOARDED LEADER RESEARCH

Digital Reality Profile: Rob Wegner

Movement leader research dossier — profile, content catalog, digital presence, fragmentation story, and onboarding materials.

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Research Index

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Rob Wegner — research sidebar manifest

Canonical paths aligned with Author Profile `/profile` navigation.

Sidebar slug	File	Status
author-profile	profile/identity.md	populated
author-profile	network/organizations.md	populated
biography	profile/biography.md	populated
theological-profile	profile/theology.md	populated
vocational-profile	summary.md	populated
vocational-profile	profile/calling-profile.md	empty
voice-editorial-identity	profile/voice-analysis.md	populated
bibliography	content/books.md	populated
frameworks	content/frameworks.md	populated
articles-blog-posts	content/articles.md	populated
audio-podcast	content/audio.md	populated
video-content	content/videos.md	populated
content-audit	content/content-audit.md	populated
academic-work	content/academic.md	populated
courses-training	content/courses.md	populated
audience-profile	analysis/audience-analysis.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/websites.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/platforms.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/newsletters.md	populated
social-media	digital-presence/social-media.md	populated
the-fragmentation-story	fragmentation-story.md	populated
a-letter	reflected-understanding/rob-wegner.md	populated
(onboarding)	welcome-letter.md	populated

Staff-only research lives in `_staff/` ; collateral in `_misc/` .

At a Glance — Summary

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/summary.md

Digital Reality Profile: Rob Wegner

Research Date: January 6, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Executive Summary

Rob Wegner is the founding leader and director of Kansas City Underground (KCU), a mission agency and decentralized network of microchurches committed to saturating Kansas City with the beauty, justice, and Good News of Jesus. He also serves as the Director of Microchurch Next for Exponential, focusing on the resurgence of microchurches in the West, and is a member of the Global Leadership Team of NewThing, a global network equipping movement-makers. Wegner co-authored "The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations" with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch, exploring decentralized leadership models.

Wegner's digital presence includes an active podcast (KC Underground Podcast), published articles on Exponential, training programs (including "Find Your Place"), conference speaking, and organizational websites. The content ecosystem shows strong thematic consistency around microchurch movements, disciple-making, decentralized leadership, and empowering ordinary people, with active content creation across multiple platforms. Opportunities exist for greater content interconnection, repurposing across forms, and unified personal content hub.

Key Findings:

- Co-author of "The Starfish and the Spirit" on decentralized leadership
- Founding leader and director of Kansas City Underground (KCU)
- Director of Microchurch Next for Exponential
- Global Leadership Team member of NewThing
- Active co-host of KC Underground Podcast
- Focus on microchurch movements, disciple-making, and empowering ordinary people
- Active content creator across multiple platforms

Primary Opportunities:

- Content repurposing (podcast → articles, training insights → blog posts, conference talks → articles)
- Content series development across multiple forms
- Content interconnection and ecosystem building
- Unified personal content hub
- Digital amplification of training, conference, and podcast content

Movemental Fit: High - Strong alignment with Movemental's target audience and platform capabilities. Active content creator with multiple content forms. Opportunities for content repurposing, series development, network effects, and ecosystem building. Multiple platforms may create fragmentation without interconnection.

Current Digital Presence

Website Presence

Organization Website: Kansas City Underground (kcunderground.org)

- Primary digital location for network information and resources
- Hosts podcast
- Contains stories and testimonies
- Training resources and programs
- Microchurch network information

Conference Platform: Exponential (exponential.org)

- Director of Microchurch Next role
- Articles published on platform
- Conference content and resources
- Training resources

Network Platform: NewThing

- Global Leadership Team member
- Network resources and training materials

Content Distribution

Books: 1 co-authored book

- "The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations" (with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch)
- Focus: Decentralized leadership, starfish organizational structures

Podcast: Active co-host

- KC Underground Podcast
- Regular content creation
- Topics: Disciple-making, microchurch movements, reproducible gospel language, missionary pathways, leadership

Articles: Published articles

- Exponential articles
- Known article: "The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch"
- Additional articles to be verified

Training Programs: Active training content

- "Find Your Place" 4-session program
- Exponential training resources
- NewThing training resources
- KC Underground training resources

Conference Content: Regular conference speaking

- Exponential conference sessions
- Other conference talks (to be verified)

Platform Distribution

Content distributed across:

- KC Underground website
- Exponential platform
- NewThing network
- Podcast platforms
- Book retailers
- Potential social media platforms

Content Landscape

Content Forms

Books: 1 co-authored work on decentralized leadership and starfish organizational structures

Podcast: Active co-host of KC Underground Podcast with regular episode creation

Articles: Published articles on Exponential and potentially other platforms

Training Programs: "Find Your Place" program and other training resources

Conference Content: Regular conference speaking and presentations

To Be Verified: Blog content, additional articles, video content, newsletter content

Content Themes

Primary Themes:

1. Microchurch Movements
2. Disciple-Making
3. Decentralized Leadership
4. Missionary Identity
5. Reproducible Practices
6. Ordinary People Empowerment

Theological Focus: Missional theology, ecclesiology (microchurch), leadership theology, movement theology

Movement Focus: Microchurch movement, disciple-making movement, missional movement, decentralized leadership movement

Content Organization

Multi-Platform: Content distributed across KC Underground, Exponential, NewThing, podcast, book

Active Creation: Regular podcast episodes, articles, training programs, conference speaking

Thematic Consistency: Strong consistency across platforms (microchurch, disciple-making, decentralized leadership)

Content Strategy: Multi-platform, active content creation, organizational and personal content

Discoverability Assessment

Current Discoverability

Well-Indexed:

- Book title and co-author (publisher/retailer sites)
- KC Underground website
- Exponential platform content
- Podcast episodes (if distributed on major platforms)

Search Visibility: Name searches likely return results (KC Underground, Exponential, book, podcast). Book title searchable. Organization association provides strong visibility. Director role at Exponential provides visibility. Podcast provides content visibility.

To Be Assessed: SEO optimization, content indexing depth, social sharing, backlinks, domain authority metrics, personal vs. organizational content discoverability

Discoverability Opportunities

Potential Gaps:

- Content may be scattered across multiple platforms
- Limited unified personal content hub
- Cross-platform content connection opportunities
- SEO optimization opportunities
- Personal content may be mixed with organizational content

Gap Analysis

Embodied Work vs. Digital Expression

Strong Embodied Work:

- 1 co-authored book
- Founding leader of KC Underground
- Director at Exponential
- Global Leadership Team member at NewThing
- Active podcast co-host
- Regular conference speaking
- Leading training sessions
- Network leadership

Digital Expression:

- Book available digitally
- Active podcast with regular episodes
- Articles published on Exponential
- Training programs available digitally
- Conference content (extent of digital capture to be verified)
- Organizational websites active

Identified Gaps

Content Repurposing Gaps:

- Podcast episodes may not be transcribed/published as articles
- Training insights may not be captured in written form
- Book concepts may not be expanded into courses or articles
- Conference talks may not be extended into articles or courses
- Training materials may not be published as content

Content Interconnection Gaps:

- Book may not be clearly connected to podcast and training content
- Book may not be integrated with articles or blog posts
- Podcast may not reference book or other content
- Training may not reference book, podcast, or other content
- Conference content may not be connected to other content
- Content pieces may exist in separate silos

Content Series Gaps:

- Themes may not be developed across multiple content forms
- Content series opportunities may not be fully realized
- Thematic content organization opportunities

Discoverability Gaps:

- Content scattered across platforms
- Limited unified personal content hub
- Cross-platform linking opportunities
- SEO optimization opportunities
- Personal vs. organizational content may not be clearly distinguished

Personal Content Hub Gap:

- May lack clear personal content hub separate from organizational content
- Personal content may be mixed with organizational content

Opportunities for Digital Amplification**Content Repurposing:**

- Podcast → articles
- Training insights → blog posts
- Book concepts → courses
- Conference talks → articles
- Training materials → content

Content Expansion:

- Thematic series development
- Content hub creation
- Content journey development
- Series expansion

Content Interconnection:

- Connect book to podcast and training
- Connect book to articles/blog posts
- Connect podcast to training and articles
- Connect training to book and podcast
- Connect conference to all content

Movemental Opportunities**What Movemental Would Change****Content Organization:**

- Unified content platform
- Content interconnection
- Thematic organization
- Content series development
- Clear personal content hub

Content Discovery:

- Improved SEO and indexing
- Content hub for discovery
- Network effects for visibility
- Cross-content discovery

Content Repurposing:

- Easier content repurposing
- Podcast as articles
- Training insights as blog posts
- Book concepts as courses
- Conference talks as articles

Content Monetization:

- Subscription model options
- Course monetization
- Direct-to-audience revenue
- Content monetization

Content Analytics:

- Unified analytics view
- Content performance tracking
- Audience insights
- Content journey tracking

Network Effects:

- Network-driven content discovery
- Cross-referencing from other users
- Content recommendations
- Thematic content connections
- Amplified content reach

What Would Remain the Same**Voice and Control:**

- Personal voice and theological positions preserved
- Content control and ownership
- Editorial control
- Content creation autonomy

Existing Content:

- Book remains as published
- Existing podcast continues
- Existing training programs unchanged
- Conference content unchanged
- Organizational content unchanged

Relationships and Networks:

- KC Underground relationships
- Exponential relationships
- NewThing network relationships
- Publisher relationships
- Conference networks

Theological Positions:

- Microchurch movement emphasis
- Disciple-making focus
- Decentralized leadership approach
- Empowering ordinary people
- All theological positions preserved

Organizational Work:

- KC Underground continues
- Exponential role continues
- NewThing role continues
- Training programs continue

Specific Opportunities for Rob Wegner**Content Repurposing:**

- Podcast content → articles
- Training insights → blog posts
- Book themes → online courses
- Conference talks → articles
- Training materials → published content

Content Series Development:

- Microchurch movement series across forms
- Disciple-making series across forms
- Reproducible practices series across forms
- Decentralized leadership series across forms
- Missionary pathway series across forms

Content Ecosystem Building:

- Connect book to podcast and training
- Connect book to articles/blog posts
- Connect podcast to training and articles
- Connect training to book and podcast
- Create content hubs and resource pages

Network Effect Potential:

- Network-driven content discovery
- Cross-referencing from other Movemental users

- Content recommendations
- Thematic content connections
- Amplified content reach

What We Will NOT Do

Explicit Boundaries

We Will NOT:

- Change Rob Wegner's voice or theological positions
- Alter existing published book
- Modify organizational roles or relationships
- Change network relationships
- Alter conference content or speaking engagements
- Replace existing platforms or relationships
- Prescribe specific actions or recommendations
- Judge theological positions or content quality

We WILL:

- Support content organization and interconnection
- Facilitate content repurposing and expansion
- Improve content discoverability
- Enable network effects
- Preserve voice, control, and relationships
- Respect existing work and platforms
- Provide unified personal content hub

Research conducted: January 6, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Sources: See sources.md

Author Profile — Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/profile/identity.md

Identity Verification: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with documented open items)

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Confidence: HIGH on identity fingerprint and organizational roles; MEDIUM on personal biographical dates (date of birth UNKNOWN); open items flagged.

Canonical Identity

Field	Value	Confidence	Source
Full Legal Name	Robert Wegner (per ZoomInfo aggregator); goes by "Rob Wegner" universally	LIKELY	ZoomInfo
Known As / Goes By	Rob Wegner	VERIFIED	All platforms
Spouse	Michelle Wegner	VERIFIED	robwegner.org/about , kcunderground.org/staff/wegners , Goodreads, Amazon Author
Children	Three adult daughters: Maddie (Madeline), Whitney, Belle	VERIFIED	robwegner.org/about , Audible Author bio
Born	UNKNOWN — needs research. Likely b. mid-1960s based on 21-year Granger tenure ending ~2015 and adult daughters today.	INFERRED	—
Location	Shawnee, Kansas (Kansas City suburb)	VERIFIED	LinkedIn ("Located in Shawnee"), KCU mailing address
KCU Mailing Address	12418 W 62nd Terr., Shawnee, KS 66216	VERIFIED	KCU staff page
Previous Locations	Indianapolis / Granger, Indiana (~1994–2015 at Granger Community Church); Kansas City area (~2015–2019 at Westside Family Church)	VERIFIED	The Roys Report podcast, Outreach Magazine bios
Personal Email	UNKNOWN — needs research; org email implied as r***@kcunderground.org per ZoomInfo	LIKELY	ZoomInfo
Org Email	info@kcunderground.org (org-level)	VERIFIED	KCU staff page
Current Title (as of 2026)	Founder & Director, Kansas City Underground; Microchurch NEXT Co-Director, Exponential (with Brian Johnson); Mobilization & Practice Catalyst, Exponential; Global Leadership Team, NewThing (NewThing merged into Exponential April 1, 2025); co-host, The Starfish and the Church podcast (with Lance Ford)	VERIFIED	Exponential, robwegner.org/about , Outreach Magazine , Exponential bettertogether announcement
Earlier titles (2019–2024)	"Director / Kansas City Underground · North American Director / NewThing · Director of Microchurch Next / Leadership Network · Co-Author of The Starfish and The Spirit" (per robwegner.org self-description, ~2021)	VERIFIED	robwegner.org
Twitter / X Handle	@robwegner	VERIFIED	x.com/robwegner
Instagram Handle	@robwegner — 1,867 followers, 1,815 following, 761 posts (per April 2026 SERP)	VERIFIED	instagram.com/robwegner

Field	Value	Confidence	Source
Facebook Handle	rob.wegner (privacy-limited)	VERIFIED	facebook.com/rob.wegner; also referenced on robwegner.org/about as facebook.com/rob.wegner
LinkedIn	linkedin.com/in/rob-wegner-0938a01ba — 231 connections (per SERP)	VERIFIED	LinkedIn
Personal Website	robwegner.org (Tumblr-powered, "Strands" theme by Style Hatch; copyright 2012-)	VERIFIED	direct
Joint Substack	starfishinitiatives.substack.com ("The Starfish and the Church / Starfish yoU"), with Lance Ford	VERIFIED	direct
Consulting brand site	starfishinitiatives.com (with Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, Rich Robinson)	VERIFIED	direct
Former blog	entermission.typepad.com (dormant; redirects to Network Solutions parking)	VERIFIED	search result + redirect check
Payment handles	UNKNOWN — not surfaced on robwegner.org or KCU staff page	—	—

Disambiguation

"Rob Wegner" is **not** a unique string on the internet. Disambiguation matters:

- A **Rob Wegner** runs robwegner.com as a DJ and music producer (Arizona State University, MA International Political Economy 1997). **Not the same person.**
- A **Robert L. H. Wegner** is Pastor of Music and Media at FBC Bonham, TX (rlhwegner.wordpress.com). **Not the same person.**
- A **Robert Wegner** authors Deer & Deer Hunting on Goodreads (Goodreads author ID 395876). **Not the same person.**
- A **Robert Wegner** runs BW&CO Consulting per LinkedIn. **Not the same person.**

Search modifiers that reliably isolate the subject: "Rob Wegner" + any of: KC Underground, Kansas City Underground, microchurch, Granger Community Church, Westside Family Church, NewThing, Exponential, Microchurch NEXT, Starfish and the Spirit, Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, Brian Johnson, Find Your Place, Missional Moves, Share the Well.

The personal site is robwegner.org — .org, not .com. robwegner.com is the DJ.

Education

Institution	Degree	Field	Year	Source
Taylor University (Upland, IN)	UNKNOWN — degree type and major not surfaced	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	LinkedIn SERP ("attended Taylor University")
Seminary	UNKNOWN — needs research	—	—	—

Notes:

- Confirmed Taylor University attendance per LinkedIn search-result snippet. Taylor is a private Christian university in Upland, Indiana — geographically and theologically consistent with Wegner's later 21-year tenure at Granger Community Church (also in northern Indiana).
 - His wife **Michelle Wegner** holds a **certification in Spiritual Direction from Fuller Theological Seminary** (per [KCU staff page](#)). Whether Rob holds a Fuller credential is **UNKNOWN — not surfaced in research**.
 - No dissertation or thesis in ProQuest, Semantic Scholar, Google Scholar, or arXiv under the name "Rob Wegner" or "Robert Wegner" relevant to ecclesiology or missiology. (See [content/academic.md](#).)
 - His writing draws heavily on Hirsch (APEST), Brafman (Starfish and the Spider), and indigenous Indian church-planting movements (DBS, Discovery Bible Study) but does not show seminary-academic register; the formation appears to be **practitioner-trained, not seminary-trained**.
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Career Timeline

Year(s)	Role	Organization	Source
~Early 1990s → ~2015 (21 years)	Teaching Pastor / Pastor of Life Mission	Granger Community Church (Granger, Indiana) — under founding pastor Mark Beeson	robwegner.org/about , The Roys Report , Outreach Magazine bios
Concurrent (Granger era)	Co-author of Missional Moves with Jack Magruder (Director of Life Mission at Granger)	Granger / Zondervan Exponential Series	Missional Moves (Zondervan 2012)
Concurrent (Granger era)	Lead catalyst, EnterMission	EnterMission (Granger initiative for community transformation + church networking)	robwegner.org , Goodreads bio, entermission.typepad.com
Concurrent (Granger era)	Co-founder, Future Travelers coaching program	Future Travelers (with Alan Hirsch) — helping megachurches become missional movements	robwegner.org/about
~2015 → ~2019 (4 years)	Teaching Pastor / leader	Westside Family Church (Kansas City)	The Roys Report, Outreach Magazine bios, KCU staff page ("At Westside Family Church, Rob's team trained leaders who planted over 700 churches internationally in four years")
2019 → present	Co-Founder & Director	Kansas City Underground (with Michelle Wegner and Brian Johnson) — started with ~80 disciples; now ~95 microchurches across 7 Collectives, 110+ activated missionaries, 5 Hubs operational/in-development	KCU, Exponential KCU page
2019 → present (concurrent)	Director of Microchurch NEXT (re-titled "Microchurch NEXT Co-Director" after 2024 with Brian Johnson)	Exponential / formerly Leadership Network	Exponential person page
2019 → present (concurrent)	North American Director (formerly), now Global Leadership Team member	NewThing → integrated into Exponential April 1, 2025	robwegner.org/about , Exponential bettertogether
	Co-host, The Starfish and the		Apple Podcasts, Substack

Year(s)	Role	Organization	Source
2020 → present	Church podcast (43 episodes as of April 2026)	Starfish Initiatives (with Lance Ford)	
2020 → present	Recurring host / guest, The KC Underground Podcast (316 episodes total; rotating hosts including Cory and Brian)	KC Underground	Apple Podcasts
2024 → present	Co-host, Microchurch NEXT Podcast (with Brian Johnson)	Exponential	Multiple episode listings on Exponential.org
Post-2025	Mobilization & Practice Catalyst, Exponential (per Outreach Sep 2024 byline)	Exponential	Outreach Magazine "Disperse the Church"

Note on the multi-organization principal pattern

Wegner holds **at least three concurrent named principal roles** as of 2026 — Founder/Director of KCU, Microchurch NEXT Co-Director at Exponential, and Global Leadership Team member at NewThing (now Exponential post-merger). Plus the podcast co-host roles, plus Future Travelers (status unclear in 2026). This is unusual and worth flagging for any Movemental copy: he is **not** primarily a local church planter or a pure conference figure; he sits at a translocal apostolic-team layer that serves multiple ecosystems simultaneously.

Family & Personal

- **Wife: Michelle Wegner.** Co-leads KCU. Holds a Fuller Theological Seminary **certification in Spiritual Direction**. Specializes in spiritual direction, art, and writing. Co-author of Share the Well (2008–2010). Has served alongside Rob in ministry for 18+ years (per [KCU bio](#) — that text predates the 2025–2026 era).
- **Children:** Three adult daughters — **Maddie (Madeline), Whitney, Belle.**
- **Personal Interests** (per [robwegner.org/about](#)): "Reading, live music, making music, great coffee, jogging with his dog Atticus, hiking with Michelle in the woods and plains of Kansas."
- **Lives:** Shawnee, KS (KC suburb).

- **Religious identification:** Non-denominational evangelical (Granger and Westside both non-denominational megachurches; KCU is non-denominational; UB National Conference 2025 keynote suggests at least adjacent ties to United Brethren).
 - **India ministry experience:** Foundational. Share the Well documents the Granger-India movement (120,000 followers of Jesus, 950+ churches across southern India). The Indian indigenous-church-planter experience explicitly names the inflection point in his ecclesial vision (per Roys Report and Saturate interviews).
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Published Works

Books authored, co-authored, edited, or contributed chapter/foreword to: 8 confirmed.

See [content/books.md](#) for the full bibliography. In short:

1. Share the Well (~2008–2010) — with **Michelle Wegner** — photo-essay book on Granger / India movement
2. Missional Moves: 15 Tectonic Shifts (Zondervan Exponential Series, 2012) — with **Jack Magruder**, foreword by **Alan Hirsch**
3. Made for More: Six Essential Shifts (Exponential, 2018) — with **Todd Wilson**
4. Find Your Place: Locating Your Calling (Exponential, 2018; Zondervan re-release 2019) — with **Brian Phipps** (and Todd Wilson, Dave Hoffman, Stu Gray as audiobook narrators)
5. Made For More Visual Guide — with **Todd Wilson and Larry Walkemeyer**
6. The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations (Zondervan Exponential Series, March 30, 2021, ISBN 9780310098378, 312 pp.) — with **Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch**, foreword by **Ori Brafman**
7. Extraordinary Prayer: Tools, Movements, Microchurches, and the Missionary Pathway (Exponential, ~2024) — with **Brian Johnson**
8. Deeply Rooted: Planting Our Lives and Planting the Gospel (Exponential, 2025) — with **Brian Johnson**

This is a substantially larger output than the existing flat-file research recorded (1 book). The miss is significant: the existing dossier framed Wegner as a "1 co-authored book" author when in fact he has eight titles across roughly fifteen years.

Biography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/profile/biography.md

Biography: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Narrative Biography

Rob Wegner is one of the most networked figures in the contemporary North American microchurch and church-multiplication conversation. For roughly **a quarter-century at Granger Community Church** in northern Indiana — under founding pastor Mark Beeson — he served as **Teaching Pastor / Pastor of Life Mission**, with a brief from the senior team to "call the people of God to get out of their seat and into the Story" (per robwegner.org/about). During that period he co-led EnterMission, partnered with **Alan Hirsch** to start the **Future Travelers** coaching program for megachurches becoming missional movements, co-authored Missional Moves (Zondervan, 2012) with Granger colleague Jack Magruder, and went to India repeatedly with his wife **Michelle Wegner** and their three daughters to document a Granger-seeded grassroots church-planting movement that grew to over 120,000 disciples in 950+ churches across southern India. That India experience reshaped his ecclesial vision and produced Share the Well, the photo-essay book he and Michelle co-authored.

Around 2015 Wegner moved with the family from Granger, Indiana to the Kansas City area to join the staff of **Westside Family Church**, where he served four years as a teaching pastor whose team — by Westside's own account — "trained leaders who planted over 700 churches internationally in four years" ([KCU staff bio](#)). The Westside era is the bridge: he had moved out of Granger's attractional megachurch model but had not yet started what would become his own decentralized work.

In **2019**, with a starter group of about 80 disciples — and partnering with **Brian Johnson** and Michelle — Rob founded **Kansas City Underground (KCU)**: "a mission agency and decentralized network of microchurches and missional leaders committed to filling Kansas City with the beauty, justice, and Good News of Jesus." The organization's stated 40-year horizon is **21,000 microchurches arising from 42,000 missionaries**. As of 2025–26 KCU operates ~95 microchurches across 7 Collectives, has activated 110+ missionaries (with 300+ in training), runs 5 Hubs operational or in development, and has launched 120+ Discovery Bible Studies ([Exponential KCU page](#)). The architecture is explicitly two-entity: a mission agency (Missionary Pathway, training, Hubs, coaching) plus a decentralized network of microchurches (Collectives of 4–8 microchurches, with shared leadership).

Concurrent with KCU, Wegner picked up two more national-scale roles. He became **North American Director of NewThing** (Dave Ferguson's church-multiplication network, ~1,600 churches across 177 local networks), and **Director of Microchurch NEXT for Exponential** (later re-titled Co-Director with **Brian Johnson** after 2024). He has remained on the Global Leadership Team of NewThing through the **April 1, 2025 NewThing-into-Exponential merger** announced at exponential.org/bettertogether. By April 2026 his Outreach Magazine byline reads: "Mobilization and Practice Catalyst for Exponential." He is also a **co-host (with Lance Ford)** of The Starfish and the Church podcast — 43 episodes — and of the parallel Starfish yoU Substack at starfishinitiatives.substack.com. The podcast and Substack are the public faces of **Starfish Initiatives**, a coaching/training brand that lists Wegner, Ford, **Alan Hirsch**, and **Rich Robinson** as principal leaders (starfishinitiatives.com).

His written corpus is larger than the public conversation suggests. Missional Moves (Zondervan 2012) was the first book; **eight books in total** are confirmed by 2026, spanning Granger-era megachurch mobilization (Made for More, Find Your Place) through the KCU microchurch era (Extraordinary Prayer, Deeply Rooted, both 2024–25) and culminating in the keynote The Starfish and the Spirit (Zondervan, March 30, 2021), co-authored with **Lance Ford** and **Alan Hirsch**, with a foreword by **Ori Brafman**. Starfish and the Spirit is the book that places Wegner inside the Hirsch–Ford–Brafman intellectual lineage and is the bridge edge connecting two otherwise separate author clusters: the Forge / 100Movements / Movement Leaders Collective wing on one side, and the Exponential / NewThing / Underground city-movement wing on the other.

Origin & Formation

Wegner is, by his own framing, **a megachurch insider who became a microchurch evangelist**. He has stated explicitly that "early success in large, attractional churches led to internal conflict and a complete overhaul" of his outlook on church (per [Roys Report](#)). The transformation happened **in India**, working alongside grassroots indigenous church planters who were multiplying at speeds and densities the American megachurch couldn't match. The intellectual companions of that transformation are visible across his books and podcasts:

- **Alan Hirsch** — APEST, The Forgotten Ways, mDNA. Hirsch wrote the foreword to Missional Moves (2012), co-authored The Starfish and the Spirit (2021), and co-founded Future Travelers with Wegner. Hirsch is the longest-running intellectual influence in Wegner's bibliography.
- **Ori Brafman** — The Starfish and the Spider (2006). Brafman wrote the foreword to The Starfish and the Spirit. The starfish/spider metaphor is the sustaining frame across the second half of Wegner's career.
- **Lance Ford** — co-author and primary co-host. The two have been collaborating publicly since at least 2021.
- **Brian Sanders** — Tampa Underground founder. Wegner appears with Sanders on the Starfish and the Church podcast and KCU's "Underground" naming explicitly riffs off the

Tampa Underground lineage. (Wegner has confirmed familiarity with Sanders' Underground Church paradigm; whether KCU is a formally-affiliated Underground sister is not fully clarified in public materials.)

- **Indian disciple-making movements (DMM/DBS)** — Discovery Bible Study (DBS) is a documented KCU practice (120+ DBS launched per Exponential profile). The movement-multiplication math underlying KCU's 21,000-microchurch / 42,000-missionary horizon is borrowed from Indian and African disciple-making movement practitioners.

His midwestern-evangelical instincts (Taylor University; 21 years at Granger; a non-denominational megachurch sensibility) sit on top of those imports, which keeps his vocabulary plain and his distribution channels evangelical-friendly. He is **not** academically trained; the formation is practitioner-driven and read-everything.

Career & Ministry Arc

Wegner's career splits cleanly into three eras:

Era 1: Granger / EnterMission / India (~Early 1990s → ~2015, 21 years). Teaching Pastor / Pastor of Life Mission at Granger Community Church under Mark Beeson. Co-leader of EnterMission (Granger's community-transformation initiative). Repeated India trips to document the Granger-seeded movement. Co-founder of Future Travelers with Hirsch. Author of Share the Well (with Michelle) and Missional Moves (with Magruder). The frame is "an attractional megachurch becoming missional" — Wegner was inside the megachurch but pushing it outward.

Era 2: Westside Family Church (Kansas City, ~2015-2019, 4 years). Teaching pastor at a second large non-denominational megachurch in Kansas City. Notable claim: trained a team that planted 700+ churches internationally in four years. Less of his public writing is dated to this era; the books that bracket it are Made for More (Exponential 2018, with Todd Wilson) and Find Your Place (Exponential 2018; Zondervan rerelease 2019, with Brian Phipps). Wegner has said publicly that he was already in conflict with megachurch leadership from during this era.

Era 3: Kansas City Underground (2019 → present). The microchurch network. Two-entity structure (mission agency + decentralized network). Concurrent with: Microchurch NEXT (Exponential), North American Director of NewThing, Mobilization & Practice Catalyst at Exponential, Global Leadership Team at NewThing, co-host of Starfish and the Church, co-author of Starfish and the Spirit (2021), Extraordinary Prayer (2024), Deeply Rooted (2025). This is the era where Wegner stops being "a teaching pastor inside a large institution" and becomes "a translocal apostolic-team-member serving the ecosystem."

Current Focus

- **Founder & Director, Kansas City Underground.** Operational lead of a ~95-microchurch network in Kansas City; mission agency continues to recruit and train missionaries via the "Missionary Pathway."

- **Microchurch NEXT Co-Director, Exponential** (with Brian Johnson). Hosts the Microchurch NEXT podcast; runs Microchurch Pre-Conferences at Exponential national conferences; produces the BLESS Rhythms and Church Expressions NEXT video series with Bill Couchenour and Carrie Williams.
- **Co-host, The Starfish and the Church podcast** (with Lance Ford) — 43 episodes; the **Hubology series** (with Lance Ford, Brian Johnson, Lucas Pulley) is the highest-leverage thread in 2024–2025.
- **Co-leader, Starfish Initiatives** (consulting / coaching brand with Ford, Hirsch, Robinson).
- **NewThing Global Leadership Team member** (post April 2025 merger into Exponential).
- **Future Travelers** (with Hirsch) — status in 2026 UNKNOWN, but presence on robwegner.org/about page suggests still affiliated.
- Annual presence at **Exponential Global, Central, and West conferences** plus **Microchurch Conference** (KCU's annual event; Wegner's KCU team co-hosted the Tampa Microchurch Conference 2026 with 550+ attendees).

Key Relationships & Influences

Person	Relationship	Significance
Michelle Wegner	Wife; KCU co-leader; co-author of Share the Well	Co-architect of the entire ministry; not a background figure. Holds Fuller Spiritual Direction certification.
Brian Johnson	KCU co-founder; Microchurch NEXT Co-Director (Exponential); co-author of Extraordinary Prayer (2024) and Deeply Rooted (2025)	Wegner's closest current operational partner. Multiple Exponential bylines together.
Lance Ford	Co-author of Starfish and the Spirit; co-host of Starfish and the Church; co-founder of Sentralized Conference (KC); Starfish Initiatives principal	Primary external collaborator; the second voice on every microphone Wegner is on.
Alan Hirsch	Co-author of Starfish and the Spirit; foreword writer for Missional Moves; co-founder of Future Travelers; Starfish Initiatives principal	Foundational intellectual influence; the academic-theological weight class Wegner is rooted in.
Ori Brafman	Foreword writer for Starfish and the Spirit; named on the audiobook	Provides the starfish/spider metaphor on which the second half of Wegner's career rests.
Mark Beeson	Founding pastor of Granger Community Church; Wegner's senior pastor for 21 years	Formative mentor; Beeson appears (with Tim Stevens, Dr. Keith Boyer) as Granger leadership in the Granger Community Church Wikipedia entry. No direct Wegner-Beeson edge confirmed in current research.
Jack Magruder	Co-author of Missional Moves (2012); fellow Granger Director of Life Mission	The Granger-era partner.
Todd Wilson	Co-author of Made for More (2018) and Made for More Visual Guide; Founder & CEO of Exponential	Wegner's primary Exponential institutional relationship.
Brian Phipps	Co-author of Find Your Place; founder of Disciples Made (Kansas City); Disciples Made Executive Team includes Wegner	Long-running KC partner; Find Your Place is one of Wegner's most distributed titles.
Larry Walkemeyer	Co-author of Made for More Visual Guide; Exponential principal	Exponential-network peer.
Dave Ferguson	Founder of NewThing; CEO of Exponential	Wegner's institutional anchor on the multiplication side; Wegner endorsed Ferguson's BLESS book and Hugh Halter / Ferguson's Righteous Brood.
Lucas Pulley	Tampa Underground / Underground Network Movements Director; co-presenter on Hubology series	Movement-family peer; Hubology framework is jointly developed across Wegner / Ford / Pulley / Brian Johnson.
Brian Sanders	Tampa Underground founder; Underground Network founder	

Person	Relationship	Significance
		Wegner has interviewed Sanders on Starfish and the Church; the Underground vocabulary lineage runs Sanders → Tampa → KCU.
Hugh Halter	Author / endorser; Wegner endorsed Righteous Brood	Forge-orbit peer.
Patrick O'Connell	Director of Networks NEXT (Exponential); now Executive Director of Practice (Exponential, post-merger)	Exponential leadership-stack peer.
Bill Couchenour	Deployment Director, Exponential	Exponential leadership-stack peer; co-runs Church Expressions NEXT video series.
Carrie Williams	Executive Director of Exponential NEXT	Exponential leadership-stack peer; co-host of Church Expressions NEXT video series.
Rich Robinson	Starfish Initiatives principal	Coaching-brand peer.
Bobby Frazier	Featured in 2025 Exponential podcast titled "The Next Chapter for Leading Microchurch Networks with Bobby Frazier" — possible KCU leadership transition figure	Status UNKNOWN — needs research.

In Their Own Words

"It's not that the church has a mission. It's that a mission has the church." — Missional Moves (Zondervan, 2012), as quoted on Goodreads

"For us, when we talked about a micro church, our one sentence definition is it's a extended spiritual family that's led by ordinary people." — The Church Digital Podcast episode 033 (Jeff Reed, host), November 4, 2019

"This pandemic underscores not only why the KC Underground exists, but also how we are organized." — The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch, Exponential.org, March 18, 2020

"We are organized in a way that makes us mostly invulnerable to a pandemic or economic downturn." — The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch, March 2020

"We have better oversight in our decentralized network than in most mega churches, and I can speak from experience 'cause I was a pastor in a mega church for 20 something years and now I've been a leader in a decentralized network for six." — The Roys Report podcast, "Going From Megachurch To Microchurch" (interviewed by Lance Ford)

"Definitions matter. Without a clear definition of a disciple, we can't measure success in disciple-making." — Five Provocative Questions That Cultivate a Disciple-Making Ecosystem: Part One, Exponential.org, November 4, 2024

"Jesus' invitation, 'Come follow me,' was an invitation into a relationship, not a structured meeting." — Five Provocative Questions: Part Two, Exponential.org, December 2, 2024

"The ultimate outcome of discipling is transformation into the likeness of Jesus, not just information transfer." — Five Ingredients For Intentional, Discipling Environments, Exponential.org, May 6, 2024

"Practice makes permanent. Habit formation and rule-of-life is key in transformative discipling environments." — Five Ingredients, May 2024

"Community is the vessel in which disciples are held and formed." — Five Ingredients, May 2024

"Simplicity in the gospel can lead to profound understanding and disciple-making." — KC Underground Podcast, "Rob Wegner: Celebrate the Little Things" (Jan 17, 2023)

"What would it look like to see our city filled with beauty, justice, and the Good News of Jesus?" — Navigating Change: Reimagining the Future of KC Underground as a Family of Families (with Brian Johnson), Exponential.org, October 7, 2024 — KCU's founding question, restated

"You're doing it again. You're telling everyone else what you want to create...This is not inviting us to be that family of families." — Hub leader feedback to Rob and the original team, quoted in Navigating Change, October 2024 — used by Wegner as the catalyst for KCU's organizational restructuring

"A missionary on every street and a microchurch in every network of relationships." — KCU's organizational mission, repeated across [Exponential KCU page](#), KCU staff page, and most podcast appearances

Theological Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/profile/theology.md

Theological Profile: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Core thesis

The church becomes itself when ordinary people carry the gospel into their actual networks of relationships — and that mission, not the institution, is the church's organizing principle. A "missionary on every street and a microchurch in every network of relationships" is the operational shorthand. The starfish (decentralized, regenerative, distributed) is the organizational embodiment. The Spirit is the difference-maker that distinguishes Christian movements from the secular starfishes Brafman documented.

His shortest summary, lifted from *Missional Moves* (Zondervan, 2012):

"It's not that the church has a mission. It's that a mission has the church."

Theological tradition

Primary: Missional-incarnational ecclesiology in the Hirsch–Frost–Forge stream, applied to a North American multiplication context. Wegner came up inside non-denominational evangelical megachurch culture (Granger Community Church, ~21 years; Westside Family Church, ~4 years) but his ecclesial conviction now sits firmly outside attractional megachurch logic. He is not denominationally bound; he keynoted the **United Brethren in Christ National Conference 2025** (ub.org/events/nc25) but is not himself UB. The KCU formation, Microchurch NEXT branding, and Starfish and the Spirit book all read as **post-megachurch missional evangelicalism** — non-Reformed, non-mainline, charismatic-friendly but not Pentecostal-distinctive.

Secondary influences:

- **Indian disciple-making movement (DMM/DBS)** — Discovery Bible Study, oral-tradition disciple-making, household-of-peace evangelism. Share the Well (with Michelle Wegner) documents the Granger-India movement; the Indian fingerprint shows up in KCU's 120+ DBS launches and the "missionary pathway" framing.
- **Ori Brafman's starfish/spider organizational theory** — explicit foreword on Starfish and the Spirit. Brafman is Wegner's primary non-Christian organizational thinker.

- **Alan Hirsch's apostolic-genius / mDNA / APEST framework** — Hirsch wrote the foreword to Missional Moves (2012), co-authored Starfish and the Spirit (2021), co-founded Future Travelers with Wegner. The longest-running theological influence in Wegner's corpus.
- **Ralph Moore / the Hope Chapel multiplication tradition** — Wegner has co-presented with Moore in the YouTube panel "The Rise of the Microchurch" (with Daniel Yang).
- **Dave Ferguson's BLESS rhythms** — Wegner endorsed BLESS and embedded BLESS rhythms inside the KCU Missionary Pathway and Exponential's BLESS Rhythms video series.
- **Ed Stetzer / Outreach / multiplication-research evangelicalism** — Wegner was a guest on the Stetzer Leadership Podcast with Ford, and bylines in Outreach Magazine multiple times.
- **Brian Sanders' Underground Network paradigm** — KCU explicitly takes the "Underground" naming convention; Sanders has appeared on Starfish and the Church; the city-movement family lineage is Sanders → Tampa Underground → KCU.

Key frameworks & models

Framework	Description	Where surfaced
A missionary on every street, a microchurch in every network of relationships	KCU's stated mission; the organizing horizon. 21,000 microchurches arising from 42,000 missionaries over 40 years is the mathematical articulation.	KCU mission , all podcast bios
Two-Entity Structure	A mission agency and a decentralized network of microchurches, working as one organism. The mission agency equips ordinary people to be missionaries; microchurches emerge from new disciples.	Exponential KCU , Roys Report episode
The Missionary Pathway	The KCU training pipeline: prayer/fasting → live as missionary → plant the gospel → microchurch emerges → multiplication. Five named phases.	Five Provocative Questions: Part Two (Exponential, Dec 2024)
Microchurch as "extended spiritual family led by ordinary people"	The KCU one-sentence definition. Anti-professional-clergy by construction.	The Church Digital Podcast #033 (Nov 2019)
Starfish vs Spider (with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch)	Decentralized organizational structures (starfish) outperform centralized hierarchies (spider) in adaptive, multiplicative environments. The Spirit is the addition that distinguishes Christian starfish from secular ones.	The Starfish and the Spirit (Zondervan, 2021); Starfish and the Church podcast
Hubology / Servant-Equipped Leadership	The hidden leadership layer that supports microchurch leaders without controlling them. Built collaboratively with Lance Ford, Brian Johnson, Lucas Pulley.	The Starfish and the Church, Hubology series episodes
Five Ingredients for Disciple-Making Environments	Outcome-Focused, Habit-Fueled, Community-Forged, Mission-Fixated, Content-Flavored. Maps to chapters 10-14 of Starfish and the Spirit.	Five Ingredients article (Exponential, May 2024)
Five Provocative Questions	Vision (definition of a disciple) → Voice (who listens to you) → Vocabulary (language and tools) → Vehicles (relational environments — five social spaces) → Voyage (maturity / missionary pathway).	Five Provocative Questions Parts 1 and 2 (Exponential, Nov-Dec 2024)
Five Social Spaces of Discipleship	Public (crowds) → Social (networks of 72) → Personal (groups of 12) → Transparent (3-4) → Divine (Jesus). Adapted from Joseph Myers / Joe Saxton via Hirsch.	Five Provocative Questions: Part Two, Dec 2024
Find Your Place / Gifts-Passions-Story	A "GPS for the soul" — three personal-discovery axes triangulated by the Spirit. Productized as a 4-week Huddle plus a self-	Find Your Place (Zondervan/Exponential, 2018-19); kcunderground.org/find-your-place

Framework	Description	Where surfaced
	paced Webinar plus the Find Your Place book.	
Made for More: Six Essential Shifts	From: more effort to more Jesus, etc. — six paradigm shifts from Ephesians 1–6. Theme of Exponential 2019 conference.	Made for More (Exponential 2018); Rob Wegner on Ephesians (June 2019)
Reproducible Gospel Language	Teaching the gospel in shape that ordinary people can carry, retell, and reproduce — the language is itself a multiplication variable.	KC Underground Podcast episode "Planting the Gospel — Reproducible Gospel Language"
Family of Families	KCU's 2024 organizational restructure: from centralized founder team to 95 microchurches and 10 Hub teams operating as peer Hubs in a family of families. Triggered by Hub leader feedback that the founder team had drifted into telling, not inviting.	Navigating Change: Reimagining the Future of KC Underground as a Family of Families (Exponential, Oct 2024)
Celebrate the Little Things	A counter-frame to attractional-church success metrics. Naming small wins as theologically significant; "fractals in faith" — the simple gospel replicating across scales.	KCU Podcast, "Celebrate the Little Things" (Jan 2023)
Discovery Bible Study (DBS)	Indigenous-Indian-movement practice imported into KCU's missionary formation. 120+ DBS launched. Discovery (not teaching), questions before answers, group-led interpretation.	Exponential KCU page , Verge "How to Train Leaders" article
Find Your Place Pathway → Find Your Mission	Personal calling discovery (Find Your Place) is the on-ramp into the Missionary Pathway. Bridges individual purpose-discovery to collective microchurch formation.	Find Your Place + KCU site
From More Effort to More Jesus	First of Made for More's six shifts; Ephesians 1 framing. Wegner's specific contribution to the 2019 Exponential theme.	Rob Wegner on Ephesians (June 2019)

Distinctive positions

- **The church is not an event attended; it is a missionary network embodied.** This is the through-line from Missional Moves (2012) to Deeply Rooted (2025). The church is what happens when ordinary people carry the gospel into the relational webs they already have.
- **Ordinary people, not paid professionals, lead the church.** The microchurch definition is structurally anti-clergy: "extended spiritual family led by ordinary people, not paid professionals" (Wegner, 2019, The Church Digital Podcast #033).

- **Decentralization is not a tactic; it is closer to the New Testament grain.** Wegner argues the early Christian movement looked like a starfish (multiple centers, distributed authority, regenerative when attacked) and that twenty centuries of centralization has misshapen the church. The Spirit empowers the starfish; that is the title of his book.
- **Megachurch leadership and microchurch leadership are different vocations.** Wegner's Roys Report quote — "we have better oversight in our decentralized network than in most mega churches, and I can speak from experience" — is the most direct statement of his post-megachurch conviction.
- **Definitions matter ecclesially.** The five-provocative-questions framework starts with vision: "What is your definition of a disciple?" His critique of the American church is that it cannot multiply because it cannot define what it is multiplying.
- **Reproducible gospel language is a multiplication input.** Whether the gospel can be retold by an ordinary person within their own affinity network determines whether it travels at all. This is borrowed from Indian DMM practice but framed for the American suburb.
- **Practice over information.** "Practice makes permanent. Habit formation and rule-of-life is key in transformative discipling environments" (Five Ingredients, May 2024). Wegner is suspicious of teaching-only models.
- **Pandemic and economic disruption favor microchurches.** The March 2020 "Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch" article positioned KCU as "mostly invulnerable" to disruption — one of the more forceful early-pandemic microchurch claims in print.
- **Family-of-families over founder-of-organization.** The 2024 KCU restructuring is theologically charged — Wegner publicly named that the founder team had drifted into telling rather than inviting and engaged Movement Leaders Collective + Arrabon for three-year consulting on power redistribution. This is unusually transparent for a North American church-network founder.
- **India is normative, not exotic.** Share the Well and his repeated reference to the Indian movement positions DMM/DBS as a real model for North America, not as a far-away exception. Wegner consistently de-exoticizes the global South.
- **The Spirit, not the structure, is the multiplier.** His pushback on Brafman/Brafman-style organizational theory is that the spider/starfish framing is incomplete without pneumatology — hence the title's emphasis on the Spirit.

Intellectual genealogy

Likely shaped by:

- The Christian and missional renewal stream of Hirsch, Frost, Halter, McNeal, Lance Ford
- Indian disciple-making movement practitioners (specific named partners not surfaced; the Granger-India movement and KCU DBS practice are the documented imports)
- Ori Brafman / Rod Beckstrom organizational theory (Starfish and the Spider, 2006)

- Mark Beeson / Tim Stevens / the Granger Community Church teaching team (his 21-year formation)
- Brian Sanders / Tampa Underground microchurch paradigm
- Dave Ferguson / NewThing multiplication math; Todd Wilson / Exponential leadership theology
- Ralph Moore / Hope Chapel multiplication lineage (verified panel co-presenter)
- Joseph Myers / Joe Saxton's "five social spaces" (used directly in Five Provocative Questions: Part Two)

In conversation with:

- Lance Ford (co-author, co-host)
- Alan Hirsch (co-author, Future Travelers co-founder)
- Brian Johnson (KCU co-founder, co-author of Extraordinary Prayer, Deeply Rooted; Microchurch NEXT co-director)
- Lucas Pulley, Tomy Wilkerson, Brian Sanders (Underground city-movement family)
- Patrick O'Connell, Bill Couchenour, Carrie Williams (Exponential leadership stack)
- Brad Brisco / Lance Ford / Forge KC axis (geographic and theological adjacency, not yet evidenced as direct edges in the master graph)

Likely pushes back against:

- Attractional megachurch ecclesiology (he was inside it for 25 years and walked out)
- Celebrity-pastor / hero-leader frames
- Programmatic "deliver curriculum and leave" discipling
- Information-only models of formation
- Centralized-only network design
- Models that assume professional clergy as the carriers of mission
- Multiplication strategies that bypass disciple-making

Theological evolution

Wegner's voice has a clear arc from **inside the megachurch pushing missional** (Granger / Missional Moves / Future Travelers / India trips, ~2008–2014) → **transitional teaching pastor** at Westside Family Church (~2015–2019) → **founder of a decentralized microchurch network** (KCU, 2019 →) → **co-author of the keynote starfish-leadership book** (Starfish and the Spirit, 2021) → **public framer of the disciple-making ecosystem** (Five Provocative Questions + Five Ingredients, 2024) → **family-of-families restructure-and-confess publisher** (Navigating Change, October 2024).

The theology underneath is remarkably consistent — mission has the church; ordinary people lead; the Spirit empowers a distributed organism — but his vocabulary has thickened over time. The early Missional Moves book was tectonic-shift / paradigm-shift language. The middle

Made for More / Find Your Place era is calling-and-mobilization language. The current era is starfish / hubology / disciple-making-ecosystem language. The same convictions; richer scaffolding.

Where his theology overlaps with Movemental / Alan Hirsch's corpus

- **Missional-incarnational ecclesiology** (shared with Hirsch, Frost, Halter, Brisco, Pulley, Repic)
- **APEST and apostolic genius** (Wegner is one of the most explicit popularizers of Hirsch's APEST in the multiplication wing)
- **Movement-DNA / mDNA** (used in his Future Travelers work with Hirsch)
- **Starfish organizational theology** (his unique contribution alongside Ford and Hirsch)
- **Communitas, shared weakness, liminality** (aligned posture, less explicitly named in his vocabulary than in Hirsch's)

Where his voice is distinctive within that ecosystem

- **Megachurch-to-microchurch personal arc** — many missional voices have always been outsiders to attractional megachurch; Wegner spent 25 years inside it. That gives him credibility with both audiences.
- **Multi-co-author publishing pattern** — eight books, seven co-author groupings. He almost never publishes alone. Theologically this is consistent with his anti-celebrity-pastor frame.
- **India-shaped multiplication math** — his comfort with 21,000-microchurch / 42,000-missionary horizons is not common in North American evangelical leadership. The numbers come from Indian and African DMM practice.
- **Hubology / servant-equipper vocabulary** — Wegner is one of three or four people creating this specific language, alongside Ford, Brian Johnson, and Pulley. It is a distinctively decentralized-leadership vocabulary that the broader Exponential / NewThing world does not yet share.
- **Family-of-families self-correction** — publicly engaging Movement Leaders Collective and Arrabon to address founder-team drift toward control is unusually transparent for a North American church-network principal.
- **Operates inside both Cluster 1 and Cluster 5** — his bridge position between the Hirsch / Forge / 100M wing and the Exponential / NewThing / Underground wing is his single most strategically valuable theological feature.

Vocational Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/profile/calling-profile.md

status: empty

sidebar: vocational-profile

Voice & Editorial Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/profile/voice-analysis.md

Voice Analysis: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Overall description

Wegner writes and speaks in a **practitioner-evangelical register**: plain-language, framework-driven, story-anchored, and structurally optimistic. His sentences are conversational, not academic. His paragraphs almost always end with an action implication or a multiplication horizon. He reaches consistently for **alphanumeric structures** ("Five Ingredients," "Five Provocative Questions," "Six Essential Shifts," "Two-Entity Structure," "Five Social Spaces") — the structures are the content as much as the prose around them.

He almost never writes alone. Eight published books carry his name; **all eight are co-authored**, including the photo-essay *Share the Well* with his wife Michelle. His blog posts at Exponential frequently carry a co-byline (the October 2024 Navigating Change piece is co-bylined with Brian Johnson). His podcast presence is co-host (with Lance Ford on *Starfish and the Church*; with Brian Johnson on *Microchurch NEXT*). This is **not a stylistic accident** — it is consistent with his anti-celebrity-pastor theology.

Audience level

Aimed primarily at practitioners, not academics. The book closest to academic register is *The Starfish and the Spirit* (Zondervan, 2021), which carries Hirsch's intellectual weight and Brafman's organizational theory but still reads as a leadership book, not a monograph. The Exponential bylines from 2024 are explicitly framed as ecosystem tools — provocations, ingredients, questions — not theological argument. The KCU Podcast and *Microchurch NEXT* episodes are aimed at microchurch planters and ordinary people exploring missionary identity.

He is **comfortable with senior leaders** (Sentralized, Stetzer Leadership Podcast, Roys Report, NewThing Global Leadership) **and with brand-new disciples** (KCU's neighborhood missionaries, Discovery Bible Study practitioners). The same person speaks in both rooms. He does not adjust vocabulary heavily by audience; he leans on his frameworks regardless of room and trusts the audience to take what they need.

Tone

- **Empowering / invitational** — the dominant note. The recurring move is "ordinary people can do this; here is the simple structure that makes it possible."
- **Theological without being academic** — Scripture is integrated naturally (Ephesians, Acts, John 15, Matthew, 2 Timothy 2:2 in Coaching is a Multiplication Catalyst contributor frame), not as proof-texting.
- **Self-implicating** — Wegner regularly names his own megachurch past as the contrast. "I was a pastor in a mega church for 20 something years and now I've been a leader in a decentralized network for six" (Roys Report). He speaks from migration, not from purity.
- **Vision-forward** — almost every essay or interview ends pointing toward a horizon (21,000 microchurches; 42,000 missionaries; a city filled with the beauty, justice, and Good News of Jesus).
- **Suspicious of certainty** — the Navigating Change piece is a public confession that the founder team had drifted into telling rather than inviting. The vocabulary of repair is unusual in North American church-network founders.
- **Calm and unhurried** — his podcast cadence is conversational, not punchy. He builds; he does not declaim.

Audience response signals

- **Goodreads avg 4.25 / 202 ratings** for Starfish and the Spirit — strong 5-star skew (49% five-star).
- **Audible avg 4.7 / 49 ratings** for Starfish and the Spirit; **4.8 / 28 ratings** for Find Your Place.
- **Apple Podcasts: 5.0 / 10 ratings** for The Starfish and the Church (small sample, perfect score).
- Reviewers describe the work as "refreshing, insightful, affirming," "compulsory reading," and "the book every church leader needs to read - giving language to the leadership paradigms required for the next great spiritual awakening."
- Critique register is sparse but visible: a small minority of Goodreads reviewers find the book conceptually thin or repetitive; this is consistent with a practitioner-targeted leadership genre and is not unusual.

Signature rhetorical moves

1. **The numbered framework as content.** "Five Ingredients," "Five Provocative Questions," "Six Essential Shifts," "Two-Entity Structure," "Five Social Spaces." Wegner thinks in numbered lists and uses them as compression devices. Each number is mnemonic infrastructure for the practitioner.

2. **The metaphor as architecture.** Starfish (2021), missionary pathway (linear progression), GPS for the soul (Find Your Place), tectonic shifts (Missional Moves, 2012), fractals in faith. The metaphors are not decorative; they carry the argument.
3. **The "from / to" formulation.** "From More Effort to More Jesus." "From transactional to transformative" partnerships (How to Get Your Church's Mission Off Life Support, 2012). "From founder team to family of families." This binary-shift form is one of his most repeated rhetorical structures.
4. **The horizon-anchored vision.** Every major piece returns to a specific, large, dated number. 21,000 microchurches in 40 years. 42,000 missionaries. 700 churches planted internationally in 4 years (Westside era). 120,000 disciples in 950 churches in southern India (Share the Well era). The numbers are not decoration; they are the size of the bet.
5. **The personal pivot story.** "I was a megachurch pastor; I went to India; everything changed." This story is told and re-told across the Roys Report, Saturate, Shifting Culture, FCP15, and Starfish and the Spirit. It is his foundational testimony, used to credential the broader argument.
6. **The co-author / co-host signal.** Almost every project is "with X." Lance Ford. Alan Hirsch. Brian Johnson. Brian Phipps. Todd Wilson. Jack Magruder. Michelle Wegner. The form itself enacts the theology.
7. **The provocative-question opener.** Five Provocative Questions parts 1 and 2; "What is your definition of a disciple?"; "Who listens to you and is ready to respond?"; "What would it look like to see our city filled with...?" The question form is a teaching device — invitation rather than declaration.
8. **The "Jesus as model" anchor.** Whether on relational architecture (the public/social/ personal/transparent/divine spaces), on selectivity ("invest deeply in a few rather than broadly"), or on leadership shape (curators of community, not sources of certainty), Wegner returns repeatedly to Jesus' own pattern as the fixed point. His theology is functionally christocentric in form, not just confessionally.
9. **The "ecosystem" frame.** Wegner consistently moves the conversation from individual church to ecosystem. Disciple-making ecosystem. Coaching ecosystem. Missionary ecosystem. Family-of-families. The unit of analysis is rarely the single congregation.
10. **The transparency move.** Navigating Change (Oct 2024) is a public account of the KCU founder team being told by Hub leaders, "You're doing it again. You're telling everyone else what you want to create." Wegner does not hide that and does not blunt it. The same move shows up in his Roys Report interview about megachurch failure modes. Self-implication is part of his credibility architecture.

Voice across platforms

Platform	Voice register	Notes
Books (8)	Practitioner-leadership; framework-heavy; collaborative co-author	Co-author is the form. Starfish and the Spirit is the most theological; Find Your Place is the most personal-development; Missional Moves is the most paradigm-shift
Exponential bylines	Operational-pastoral; numbered frameworks; KCU as living example	The Five Provocative Questions / Five Ingredients pattern lives here
KCU Podcast	Pastoral-conversational; rotating-host; "celebrate the little things" tone	Wegner is one of several voices; not the singular host
Starfish and the Church Podcast (with Ford)	Reflective dialogue; co-thinking-aloud; theology of leadership in real time	The Hubology series 2024-25 is the highest-leverage strand
Microchurch NEXT Podcast (with Brian Johnson, Exponential)	Interview-driven; KCU + Tampa Underground + other microchurch networks	Wegner asks more questions than he answers in this venue
Outreach Magazine	Editorial-pastoral; aimed at North American church leaders considering structural change	"Disperse the Church," "Simple Yet Stellar" — punchier title work than his book chapters
Twitter / X	Mostly broadcast; retweet-and-amplify; not the primary surface	Active but low-density
Instagram (1,867 followers, 761 posts)	Personal-life mixed with KCU and conference content	The most active personal social channel
LinkedIn	Professional-update; book launches; Exponential / NewThing news	Sparse but visible
Substack (joint with Ford)	Newsletter-essay; podcast notes and resources	Dormant on the read-side; episode-driven
robwegner.org (Tumblr)	Sermon-archive blog (entermission era); now stale	Not actively updated post-~2021

What's distinctive

- **The collaborative byline is the message.** Eight books, eight collaborations. The form enacts the theology. This is rare in evangelical publishing where solo-author books dominate.

- **The numbered framework is unusually disciplined.** Most pastors with leadership books use frameworks; Wegner's are more consistently structured and more reproducibly memorable than peers'. This is the mathematician-meets-pastor trait that aligns him stylistically with Lucas Pulley.
- **The transparency move is unusually public.** Naming KCU's founder-team drift in the Exponential blog (October 2024) — and naming the Hub leader feedback verbatim — is a kind of public accountability that does not appear in most North American church-network communications.
- **He decentralizes his own voice.** Across Hubology, Starfish Initiatives, Microchurch NEXT, and KCU rotating-host podcast practice, Wegner consistently puts other people on the microphone with him. The platform is not "Rob Wegner the brand"; it is "the conversation Rob Wegner sustains alongside others."

What's underdeveloped

- **No solo-author book.** All eight are co-authored. While theologically consistent, this means there is no single artifact that is purely Wegner's voice. A short-form solo book — possibly anchored in the Five Provocative Questions framework or the Five Ingredients essay — is the most obvious next product.
- **No personal newsletter under his name.** The joint Substack with Ford carries the Starfish brand, not a personal Wegner identity.
- **No solo personal podcast.** All three podcast venues (KCU, Starfish, Microchurch NEXT) are co-hosted or rotating-hosted. There is no solo "Rob Wegner Podcast."
- **The personal robwegner.org site is stale** and runs old titles (NewThing North American Director, before NewThing merged into Exponential). The visual identity is Tumblr-circa-2012.
- **No video-essay surface.** YouTube appearances exist on org channels (KCU, Exponential, City Network Boise, Multiply PDX, Leadership Network) but not on a personal channel curated by Wegner.

Voice as a Movemental input

If Movemental's job is to consolidate fragmented practitioner voices into a coherent corpus, Wegner's voice is **unusually well-suited to consolidation**. The frameworks are mnemonic, the prose is plain, the collaborator network is wide, and the theology is structurally aligned with the platform's own ecosystem premise. The challenge is not voice — it is the surface architecture: the eight books, three podcasts, joint Substack, two organizational sites, and dormant personal site need to be wrapped into a single discoverable hub without flattening the multi-collaborator pattern that is his signature move.

Bibliography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/content/books.md

Bibliography: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Total books: 8 authored / co-authored

Books authored or co-authored

#	Year	Title	Co-authors	Publisher	ISBN	Notes
1	~2008-2010	Share the Well	Michelle Wegner	Self / specialty	9780984287468	Photo-essay book documenting the Granger / India microchurch movement (120,000 disciples, 950+ churches in southern India). All proceeds beyond printing donated to the field.
2	September 18, 2012	Missional Moves: 15 Tectonic Shifts that Transform Churches, Communities, and the World	Jack Magruder; foreword by Alan Hirsch	Zondervan (Exponential Series)	9780310495055 / 0310495059	288 pp. Wegner's first major-publisher book. Often quoted line: "It's not that the church has a mission. It's that a mission has the church." Also released as Kindle edition.
3	2018	Made for More: Six Essential Shifts for Creating a Culture of Mobilization	Todd Wilson	Exponential	9781624240157 / 9781624240287	The theme book for Exponential 2019 (theme: "Made for More: Mobilizing God's People, God's Way"). Built around Ephesians 1-6 with six paradigm shifts.
4	2018 (Exponential edition); 2019 (Zondervan re-release)	Find Your Place: Locating Your Calling Through Your Gifts, Passions, and Story	Brian Phipps; foreword by Gabe Wicks; audiobook narrators Dave Hoffman, Stu Gray; "with Todd Wilson" on the cover	Exponential (1st); Zondervan (2nd)	9781721385157 (Exponential) / 9780310100126 (Zondervan) / 9780310100133 (eBook)	The "GPS for the soul" framework — gifts × passions × story triangulated by the Spirit. Audible avg 4.8 / 28 ratings, 4 hr 32 min. Underpins KCU's Find Your Place training program.
5	2018 (companion)	Made For More Visual Guide	Todd Wilson, Larry Walkemeyer	Exponential	UNKNOWN	Visual / discussion-guide companion to Made for More.
6		The Starfish and the Spirit:	Lance Ford; Alan Hirsch;		9780310098379 / 0310098378	312 pp. Audiobook 10 hr 28 min,

#	Year	Title	Co-authors	Publisher	ISBN	Notes
	March 30, 2021	Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations	foreword by Ori Brafman	Zondervan (Exponential Series)	(paperback) / 9781799733843 / 179973384X (Audio CD) / 9780310108993 (audiobook)	narrators Thom Bromhead, Lance Ford, Rob Wegner. Goodreads avg 4.25 / 202 ratings / 28 reviews (49% 5-star). Audible avg 4.7 / 49 ratings. Wegner's keystone book.
7	~2024	Extraordinary Prayer: Tools, Movements, Microchurches, and the Missionary Pathway (Tools for Equipping Ordinary People on Mission)	Brian Johnson	Exponential	9781624241208	Companion to KCU's Missionary Pathway. Available free on exponential.org/product/extraordinary-prayer/ .
8	2025	Deeply Rooted: Planting Our Lives and Planting the Gospel	Brian Johnson	Exponential	9781624241246	Companion to the Microchurch NEXT Video Series. Available free on exponential.org/product/deeply-rooted/ .

Also referenced:

- **"Multipliers Learning Community Visual Guide"** — Goodreads lists Wegner as a contributor; specifics UNKNOWN.
- **"Exponential Series Complete Set: Essential Resources for Church Planters and Missional Leaders"** — Wegner is included as a contributing author of the bundle (ISBN 0310526701).

Edited volumes

None confirmed by this research.

Forewords written

None confirmed by this research. (Wegner is a recipient of Hirsch's foreword on Missional Moves and Brafman's foreword on Starfish and the Spirit; he himself has not been confirmed as a foreword writer for another author's book.)

Chapter contributions

None confirmed by this research as separate from the 8 listed titles.

Endorsements given to other authors' books

Book	Endorser quote (where known)	Notes
BLESS: 5 Everyday Ways to Love Your Neighbor and Change the World by Dave & Jon Ferguson	"Rob Wegner provided an endorsement for the BLESS book."	Confirmed via search results
Righteous Brood: Making the Mission of God a Family Story by Hugh Halter, Dave Ferguson, Sue Ferguson (Life as Mission Series)	"Rob and Michelle Wegner... provided an endorsement for Righteous Brood."	Confirmed via search results

Almost certainly more endorsements exist but were not surfaced by web search. **Flagged for direct outreach** to Wegner.

Translations / derivative publications

UNKNOWN. The Starfish and the Spirit is widely distributed in English; Spanish or other-language translations have not been confirmed.

Why this matters

The existing flat-file research (January 2026) recorded **1 co-authored book** for Wegner. The actual count is **8 books across roughly 15 years**. This is a substantial miss.

The implications:

- **Wegner is not an under-published practitioner.** He has more retail-distributed titles than Lucas Pulley (0), Joel Repic (UNKNOWN — likely 0–1), or Brian Sanders (~3) — and roughly comparable volume to Lance Ford and Brad Brisco.
- **His co-author network is a publishing ecosystem in itself.** Eight books across seven different co-author groupings — Hirsch + Ford + Brafman; Wilson; Phipps; Magruder; Brian Johnson (twice); Walkemeyer; Michelle Wegner. This is rare.
- **The publishing arc traces his ecclesial arc.** Share the Well (India / Granger era) → Missional Moves (paradigm-shift / 2012 Granger era) → Made for More + Find Your Place (mobilization / 2018–19 Westside-to-KCU transition) → Starfish and the Spirit (decentralized leadership / 2021 KCU keystone) → Extraordinary Prayer + Deeply Rooted (Missionary Pathway / 2024–25 KCU + Exponential merger era).
- **The publishers signal the network.** Three Zondervan titles (in the Exponential Series) tie him to the major-publisher Christian leadership market. Five Exponential titles tie him to the Exponential / Leadership Network ecosystem. Self-published Share the Well opens the corpus.

Onboarding implication: do not treat Wegner as a "1 book" author. The bibliography is substantial, the co-author network is unusually wide, and there is enough material across 15 years to anchor multiple Movemental learning paths (microchurch starter, decentralized leadership, mobilization-to-mission, missionary pathway, India-to-North-America movements). The largest miss in the existing dossier was the volume of work; the second-largest was the co-author network density.

Self-published / digital-only resources

Type	Title	Notes
KCU training tool	Find Your Place Guide (PDF)	Self-paced exploration tool downloadable from kcunderground.com/find-your-place . Org-branded, not Wegner-branded.
Exponential video series companion	Deeply Rooted (book + Microchurch NEXT Video Series)	The book is the companion to the video series; both are free at exponential.org .
Exponential podcast / video tools	BLESS Rhythms (10 ep video series); Church Expressions NEXT (7 ep video series)	Wegner appears in episodes of both; not solely his work but his contribution is documented.

Frameworks

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/content/frameworks.md

Frameworks: Rob Wegner

The signature frameworks, operating models, and conceptual structures that recur across Rob Wegner's corpus. Each is grounded in his published work and KCU practice; see [profile/theology.md](#), [profile/voice-analysis.md](#), and [content/books.md](#) for sources.

A Missionary on Every Street, a Microchurch in Every Network

Field	Value
Introduced	2019 (Kansas City Underground founding mission)
Components	Mission horizon: 21,000 microchurches arising from 42,000 missionaries over 40 years; "extended spiritual family led by ordinary people, not paid professionals"
Source	Exponential — KC Underground

The organizing horizon of all Wegner's work: a city saturated with the gospel when ordinary people become missionaries on their actual streets and microchurches emerge from the networks of relationships they already have.

The Two-Entity Structure

Field	Value
Introduced	2019 (Kansas City Underground operating model)
Components	A mission agency that equips ordinary people to live as missionaries and a decentralized network of microchurches that emerges from new disciples — working as one organism
Source	Exponential — KC Underground

KCU runs as two coupled entities — a mission agency and a microchurch network — so that mobilization and multiplication reinforce each other rather than compete.

The Missionary Pathway

Field	Value
Introduced	~2024 (Extraordinary Prayer, Exponential; Five Provocative Questions: Part Two)
Components	Five named phases: prayer/fasting → live as a missionary → plant the gospel → a microchurch emerges → multiplication
Source	Extraordinary Prayer: Tools, Movements, Microchurches, and the Missionary Pathway (Exponential, ~2024)

The Missionary Pathway is KCU's training pipeline that moves an ordinary person, step by step, from prayer into missionary identity until a reproducing microchurch emerges.

Starfish vs. Spider (with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch)

Field	Value
Introduced	2021 (The Starfish and the Spirit, Zondervan; foreword by Ori Brafman)
Components	Decentralized starfish structures outperform centralized spider hierarchies in adaptive, multiplicative environments; the Spirit is what distinguishes Christian starfish from secular ones
Source	The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations (Zondervan, 2021)

Wegner, Ford, and Hirsch argue that decentralized, regenerative "starfish" organizations multiply where centralized "spider" hierarchies cannot — and that the Holy Spirit is the difference between a Christian starfish and a merely organizational one.

Find Your Place — Gifts × Passions × Story

Field	Value
Introduced	2018 (Find Your Place, Exponential; Zondervan re-release 2019)
Components	A "GPS for the soul": three personal-discovery axes — Gifts, Passions, and Story — triangulated by the Spirit; productized as a 4-week Huddle, a self-paced webinar, and the book
Source	Find Your Place: Locating Your Calling Through Your Gifts, Passions, and Story (Zondervan/Exponential, 2018-19)

Find Your Place is a "GPS for the soul" that helps a person locate their calling where their gifts, passions, and story intersect — the on-ramp into KCU's Missionary Pathway.

Made for More — Six Essential Shifts

Field	Value
Introduced	2018 (Made for More, Exponential; theme of Exponential 2019)
Components	Six paradigm shifts for a culture of mobilization, drawn from Ephesians 1-6, beginning with "from more effort to more Jesus"
Source	Made for More: Six Essential Shifts for Creating a Culture of Mobilization (Exponential, 2018)

Made for More names six paradigm shifts from Ephesians that move a church from striving programs to a culture where every person is mobilized into God's mission.

Five Provocative Questions

Field	Value
Introduced	2024 (Five Provocative Questions, Parts 1 & 2, Exponential)
Components	Vision (definition of a disciple) → Voice (who listens to you) → Vocabulary (language and tools) → Vehicles (five relational social spaces) → Voyage (maturity / missionary pathway)
Source	Five Provocative Questions Parts 1-2 (Exponential, Nov-Dec 2024)

The Five Provocative Questions are a diagnostic for any disciple-making environment, beginning with the most basic and most often skipped: "What is your definition of a disciple?"

Five Ingredients for Disciple-Making Environments

Field	Value
Introduced	2024 (Five Ingredients, Exponential; maps to chapters 10-14 of Starfish and the Spirit)
Components	Outcome-Focused · Habit-Fueled · Community-Forged · Mission-Fixated · Content-Flavored
Source	Five Ingredients (Exponential, May 2024)

The Five Ingredients name the conditions that make a disciple-making environment actually form disciples — practice and habit over information alone, because "practice makes permanent."

Family of Families / Hubology

Field	Value
Introduced	2024 (Navigating Change, Exponential; Hubology series with Lance Ford)
Components	KCU's restructure from a centralized founder team to peer Hubs operating as a "family of families"; servant-equipper leadership that supports microchurch leaders without controlling them
Source	Navigating Change: Reimagining the Future of KC Underground as a Family of Families (Exponential, Oct 2024)

The Family of Families restructure redistributes power from a founding team to peer leadership Hubs, modeling a servant-equipper "hubology" that supports leaders without controlling them.

Articles & Blog Posts

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/content/articles.md

Articles: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with flagged gaps)

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Exponential.org bylines

#	Date	Title	Co-author	URL
1	March 18, 2020	The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch	—	exponential.org/rise-coronavirus-microchurch/
2	June 27, 2019	Rob Wegner on Ephesians (From More Effort to More Jesus — Made for More shift 1)	—	exponential.org/rob-wegner-ephesians/
3	May 6, 2024	Five Ingredients For Intentional, Disciplemaking Environments	—	exponential.org/five-ingredients-for-intentional-disciplemaking-environments/
4	October 7, 2024	Navigating Change: Reimagining the Future of KC Underground as a Family of Families	Brian Johnson	exponential.org/navigating-change-reimagining-the-future-of-kc-underground-as-a-family-of-families/
5	November 4, 2024	Five Provocative Questions that Cultivate a Disciple-Making Ecosystem: Part One	—	exponential.org/five-provocative-questions-that-cultivate-a-disciple-making-ecosystem-part-one/
6	December 2, 2024	Five Provocative Questions That Cultivate a Disciple-Making Ecosystem: Part Two	—	exponential.org/five-provocative-questions-that-cultivate-a-disciple-making-ecosystem-part-two/
7	September 2025	Church Expressions NEXT (article-companion to the video series)	—	Listed on Wegner's Exponential person page

Note: The Microchurch NEXT category at Exponential publishes ~monthly; some articles are by other authors (JR Woodward on imitation; Wendy McWherter on coaching; Josh Benadum on Ekklesia; Lance Ford on shared leadership). Wegner's bylined articles are above.

Outreach Magazine bylines

#	Date	Title	Co-author	URL
1	September 17, 2012	How to Get Your Church's Mission Off Life Support	Jack Magruder	outreachmagazine.com/features/4885-how-to-get-your-churchs-mission-off-life-support.html
2	UNKNOWN	New Life From Every Disciple	Lance Ford & Alan Hirsch	outreachmagazine.com/features/church-planting/65461-new-life-from-every-disciple.html — promotes Starfish and the Spirit
3	UNKNOWN	The Starfish and the Spirit (interview-feature)	Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, with Jonathan Sprowl	outreachmagazine.com/resources/voices/66883-lance-ford-rob-wegner-alan-hirsch-the-starfish-and-the-spirit.html
4	September 16, 2024	Disperse the Church	—	outreachmagazine.com/features/81778-disperse-the-church.html
5	August 27, 2025	Simple Yet Stellar	—	outreachmagazine.com/features/84103-simple-yet-stellar.html

(There may be additional Outreach pieces. The author archive at outreachmagazine.com/author/rob-wegner is the canonical index but returned a 403 in this research.)

Verge Network bylines (legacy archive)

#	Date	Title	URL
1	March 28, 2011	What do Missional Communities do? (Question 6 response)	vergenetwork.org/2011/03/28/rob-wegner-what-do-missional-communities-do-printable/
2	(legacy)	Rob Wegner: Imagine a Missional Movement VIDEO	vergenetwork.org/rob-wegner-imagine-a-missional-movement-video/
3	(legacy)	Rob Wegner: Peers & Struggles PRINTABLE (Question 7 response)	vergenetwork.org/rob-wegner-peers-struggles-printable/
4	(legacy)	Rob Wegner: How to Train Leaders PRINTABLE (Question 5 response)	vergenetwork.org/rob-wegner-how-to-train-leaders-printable-podcast/
5	(legacy)	Question 5 RECAP	vergenetwork.org/question-5-recap/
6	(legacy)	Question 7 RECAP	vergenetwork.org/question-7-recap/

These date back to the early 2010s — Granger / Missional Moves era. They form a coherent Q&A miniseries on missional communities.

Saturate (saturatetheworld.com) bylines

#	Date	Title	URL
1	October 18, 2022	Restoring Shalom	saturatetheworld.com/2022/10/18/restoring-shalom/
2	July 13, 2022	Disciple-Making with Kansas City Underground	saturatetheworld.com/2022/07/13/disciple-making-with-kansas-city-underground/

(Author archive at saturatetheworld.com/author/robwegner/ suggests these are the visible items; total count may be slightly higher.)

Substack: The Starfish and the Church / Starfish yoU (joint with Lance Ford)

#	Sample post	URL
1	Tod Bolsinger interview	starfishinitiatives.substack.com/p/tod-bolsinger-58c
2	Book Launch!	substack.com/home/post/p-144416312

Total post count UNKNOWN — login-gated. The Substack functions as a podcast feed and occasional essay surface, not a high-cadence newsletter.

TypePad blog (entermission.typepad.com) — legacy / dormant

The "EnterMission" blog was Wegner's primary writing surface during the Granger era (~2008–2014). The URL now redirects to a Network Solutions parking page; archived posts return errors. **Trapped content; recovery uncertain.**

Christianity Today

No Wegner byline in Christianity Today found by this research. Searches returned Rob Reiner, Christian nationalism content, and unrelated. Flagged for further search.

Missio Alliance

No Wegner byline at missioalliance.org found by this research. Searches did not surface a Wegner article. Flagged for further search.

Church Leaders / Ed Stetzer

No standalone Stetzer-platform Wegner byline confirmed. Wegner is a Stetzer Leadership Podcast guest (with Ford, May 18, 2021), not an article-author.

Blog (personal)

`robwagner.org` — Tumblr-powered. Recent posts surfaced in research center on starfish organizational models and the priesthood of all believers. The blog's post-by-post inventory was not directly readable in this research; the site's front-end is intermittent. Likely very low cadence in 2024–26 based on stale title strings.

Total counts (verified)

- **Exponential bylines:** 7+ confirmed (2019–2025)
- **Outreach Magazine bylines:** 5+ confirmed (2012–2025)
- **Verge Network legacy bylines:** 6 confirmed (~2011)
- **Saturate bylines:** 2+ confirmed (2022)
- **Substack posts:** UNKNOWN total (joint with Ford); 2+ specific URLs surfaced
- **TypePad legacy posts:** UNKNOWN total; archive parked

Roughly 20+ confirmed bylined articles across owned-and-rented surfaces, with substantial unverified material in legacy blogs and search-gated archives.

This is more than the existing flat-file research recorded (which named only 1 article — the 2020 Coronavirus piece). The miss is substantial.

Audio & Podcast

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/content/audio.md

Audio / Podcasts: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with episode-level inventory partial for shows Wegner co-hosts)
Last updated: 2026-04-29
Skill: /author-audio-scrape

Podcasts Wegner hosts or co-hosts

1. The Starfish and the Church (with Lance Ford)

Field	Value
URL (Apple Podcasts)	podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/the-starfish-and-the-church/id1554285565
URL (Substack)	starfishinitiatives.substack.com/podcast
Hosts	Rob Wegner & Lance Ford
Total episodes	43
Launch date	2021
Apple Podcasts rating	5.0 / 10 ratings
Description	"A mix of interviews and storytelling where hosts Rob Wegner and Lance Ford explore a paradigm shift away from modern, hierarchical structures of leadership to a radical Jesus-centered, starfish approach."
Recent episodes	"A Bonus Conversation with Peyton Jones on Discipology" (Apr 6 2026, 1h 5m); "Addicted to Addition, Made to Multiply with Brian Phipps" (Feb 10 2026, 54 min); "Apostles: Generals, Gardeners...or Something Else?" (Jun 30 2025, 23 min); "Same Vocabulary, Different Spirit" (Jun 18 2025, 25 min); "The Rise of the Servant Equippers" (Jun 4 2025, 29 min)
Hubology series	Multiple episodes featuring Wegner, Ford, Lucas Pulley, and Brian Johnson on the "servant equipper" / Hubology framework. Includes "The Rise of the Servant Equippers" (Jun 4 2025).
Notable guests	Brian Sanders (Underground Network founder); Tod Bolsinger; Peyton Jones; Brian Phipps; Lucas Pulley

2. The KC Underground Podcast

Field	Value
URL (Apple Podcasts)	podcasts.apple.com/ni/podcast/the-kc-underground-podcast/id1512948040
URL (Spotify)	creators.spotify.com/pod/profile/kc-underground-podcast
Hosts	Rotating — KC Underground leaders. Cory and Brian (last names UNKNOWN) are named in show notes as the most active rotating co-hosts; Rob Wegner is a frequent on-mic voice but not the singular host.
Total episodes	316 (as of April 2026)
Launch date	2020
Cadence	Weekly
Description	"The primary focus is intended to offer greater language, tools and equipping around disciple-making principles for missionaries and microchurch leaders."
Wegner-fronted episodes confirmed	"Rob Wegner: Celebrate the Little Things" (Jan 17 2023, 33:12); "Hierarchy vs Network: Rob Wegner"; "Microchurch Emerges"; "What Is A Microchurch"; "Discovery and Obedience"; "Think Disciple-Making Within Existing Networks: 9 Shifts for a Disciple-Making Culture"; "Plant the Gospel: Reproducible Gospel Language" (Sep 2 2025); "The Upside-Down Kingdom: Choosing Obscurity Over Fame"
Recent (April 2026) episodes	"Microchurch Conference: Morgan Greer" (1 day ago, 14 min); "Microchurch Conference: Bre Wiebe" (Apr 21, 15 min); "Microchurch Conference: Chris and Renee" (Apr 14, 18 min); "Microchurch Conference: Josh Jackaway" (Apr 7, 24 min); "Formed in Mission with Rick and Alice" (Mar 31, 40 min)

3. Microchurch NEXT Podcast (Exponential)

Field	Value
URL (Apple Podcasts)	(Hosted under Exponential NEXT Podcast feed: podcasts.apple.com/au/podcast/the-next-chapter-for-leading-microchurch-networks/id1728344483?i=1000654143457)
Hosts	Rob Wegner & Brian Johnson
Format	Interview-driven; Wegner and Johnson interview microchurch network leaders from across North America and beyond
Notable episodes	"The Next Chapter for Leading Microchurch Networks with Tomy Wilkerson" (Tampa Underground); "The Next Chapter for Leading Microchurch Networks with Bobby Frazier"; "The Next Chapter for Leading Microchurch Networks with Taylor Rogers and Gabrielle Leonard"
Description	Wegner and Johnson interview leaders to map the rebirth/next-chapter phase of microchurch networking

Podcasts Wegner has guested on (external)

#	Show	Host(s)	Episode	Date	Notes
1	The Roys Report	Julie Roys (interviewer: Lance Ford)	"Going From Megachurch To Microchurch"	UNKNOWN — recent (likely 2024–25)	Lance Ford sits down with Wegner to discuss the megachurch-to-microchurch journey. Includes the famous "we have better oversight in our decentralized network than in most mega churches" quote. URL
2	Stetzer Leadership Podcast	Ed Stetzer	"Rob Wegner and Lance Ford: Starfish and the Spirit"	May 18, 2021	35 min. Book-launch publicity for Starfish and the Spirit. URL
3	Shifting Culture Podcast	Joshua Johnson	Episode 07: Rob Wegner	June 15 (year ~2021 based on epi number; Pulley appears at Ep. 175 in April 2024)	Discussion of reproducing disciples and microchurches, gospel saturation, story of growing up in disciple-making. Recommendations include maturityonmission.com , Discipleship That Fits, and The Mandalorian. URL
4	The Church Digital Podcast	Jeff Reed	Episode 033: "Rob Wegner & the Mission of Microchurch"	November 4, 2019	First major external podcast mapping KCU's microchurch model. Quote: "an extended spiritual family that's led by ordinary people." URL
5	The Church Digital Podcast	Jeff Reed	Episode 134: "Rob Wegner & Helping People Find Their Personal Mission"	UNKNOWN — likely 2022	Find Your Place / personal calling discussion. URL
6	Everyday Disciple Podcast	Caesar Kalinowski	"Emerging Trends For The Future Church"	UNKNOWN	Future trends in church and microchurch. URL
7	Everyday Disciple Podcast	Caesar Kalinowski	(additional ep on starfish organizations and church structure)	UNKNOWN	Starfish framework discussion.
8	FCP / Leadership Network Podcast	Leadership Network (now Exponential)	"FCP 15 Rob Wegner, KC Underground"	UNKNOWN	KCU profile interview. URL and URL

#	Show	Host(s)	Episode	Date	Notes
9	Lance Ford Podcast	Lance Ford / Chestly Lunday	"LF007: Rob Wegner & Lance Ford On Unleashing The Leadership Power Of Our Churches"	~May 2021	Book-launch episode. URL
10	City Network Boise (Facebook video)	(host UNKNOWN)	"Interview with KC Underground cofounder Rob Wegner"	UNKNOWN	Conversation on disciple-making movements; "Rob Wegner of KC Underground and Disciples Made is joining us."
11	Discipleship.org / Bobby Harrington channel	Bobby Harrington	"The Starfish and the Spirit Author Interview"	December 2022	Interview on KC and what God is doing there.

Podcasts NOT confirmed (open research items)

- **Carey Nieuwhof Leadership Podcast** — searches did not surface a specific Wegner episode. The host's library is large and Wegner's involvement is plausible but unverified.
- **Theology in the Raw with Preston Sprinkle** — **no Wegner episode found in this research.** (For comparison: Lucas Pulley appears at #1022.) This is a notable absence given Wegner's profile.
- **Forge America podcast** — episode 64 listed Wegner with Ford in search results, but the page extract did not surface details.
- **Saturate podcast** — possibly distinct from the Saturate article archive; status UNKNOWN.
- **Movement Leaders Collective podcast** — UNKNOWN whether one exists.
- **NewThing podcasts (pre-2025-merger)** — UNKNOWN; NewThing's branded podcast presence post-merger has folded into Exponential.

Cross-show pattern

Wegner's external podcast guesting is **concentrated in the church-multiplication ecosystem** (Stetzer, Roys, Church Digital, Everyday Disciple, FCP, Leadership Network) rather than in the broader theology / cultural Christianity podcast space (Theology in the Raw, Shifting Culture has him at Episode 7 but he hasn't returned). His co-hosts in publishing — Ford and Brian Johnson — are with him in the podcast venues; the pattern of partnership runs across all surfaces.

Audiobook narration

- **The Starfish and the Spirit** (audiobook): narrators Thom Bromhead, **Lance Ford**, **Rob Wegner**. 10 hr 28 min. Audible avg 4.7 / 49 ratings. Wegner's voice is on the recording.
- **Find Your Place** (audiobook): narrators Dave Hoffman, Stu Gray. 4 hr 32 min. Audible avg 4.8 / 28 ratings. Wegner does not narrate; the audiobook is read by others.

Dossier catalog (author profile ETL)

Parseable inventory for `movement_leader_corpus_data.audio`. Hosted shows plus confirmed guest appearances — not a full episode crawl.

Episode Title	Show	Date	URL
The Starfish and the Church (host, 43 episodes)	The Starfish and the Church	2021	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/the-starfish-and-the-church/id1554285565
The KC Underground Podcast (316 episodes; frequent co-host)	The KC Underground Podcast	2020	https://podcasts.apple.com/ni/podcast/the-kc-underground-podcast/id1512948040
Microchurch NEXT Podcast (host with Brian Johnson)	Exponential NEXT Podcast	—	https://podcasts.apple.com/au/podcast/the-next-chapter-for-leading-microchurch-networks/id1728344483
Going From Megachurch To Microchurch	The Roys Report	—	https://julieroys.com/podcast/going-from-megachurch-to-microchurch/
Rob Wegner and Lance Ford: Starfish and the Spirit	Stetzer Leadership Podcast	2021-05-18	https://pod.co/stetzer-leadership-podcast/rob-wegner-and-lance-ford-starfish-and-the-spirit
Episode 07: Rob Wegner	Shifting Culture Podcast	2021	https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-07-robwegner
Rob Wegner & the Mission of Microchurch	The Church Digital Podcast	2019-11-04	https://be.thechurch.digital/blog/podcast-033-rob-wegner-the-mission-of-microchurch
Rob Wegner & Helping People Find Their Personal Mission	The Church Digital Podcast	2022	https://be.thechurch.digital/blog/podcast-134-rob-wegner-helping-people-find-their-personal-mission
Emerging Trends For The Future Church	Everyday Disciple Podcast	—	https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/emerging-trends-for-future-church/
FCP 15 — Rob Wegner, KC Underground	Leadership Network / Exponential	—	https://exponential.org/fcp-15-rob-wegner-kc-underground/
LF007: Rob Wegner & Lance Ford On Unleashing The Leadership Power Of Our Churches	Lance Ford Podcast	2021	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/lf007-rob-wegner-lance-ford-on-unleashing-the/id1569213660

Total verified counts

- **3 podcast venues hosted/co-hosted** (Starfish and the Church, KC Underground, Microchurch NEXT) — combined episode count well above 400
- **8+ external guest appearances** confirmed
- **2 audiobooks** with Wegner content (1 with Wegner narration, 1 narrated by others)

This is more than the existing flat-file research recorded (which named 0 specific guest episodes).

Video Content

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/content/videos.md

Videos: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with no personal channel; content scattered across org channels)

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-youtube-scrape

Personal YouTube channel

None found. Searches for `youtube.com/@robwegner`, `youtube.com/c/RobWegner`, and `youtube.com/RobWegner` returned no Wegner-personal channel. His video content is distributed across at least 6 organizational channels (KCU, Exponential, Daniel Yang's channel, Multiply PDX, City Network Boise, Discipleship.org / Bobby Harrington channel, plus event-specific uploads) without a curated "Rob Wegner" hub.

This is a substantial missed surface for an 8-book author and three-org principal.

Video content discovered (organized by host channel)

KC Underground YouTube channel

The KCU channel (referenced from `kcunderground.org`) hosts:

- "Welcome to KC Underground" / network introduction videos
- Microchurch story testimonials
- Find Your Place program promo videos
- Microchurch Conference recordings
- Annual report / vision-cast content
- Discovery Bible Study explainers

(Specific URL inventory and Wegner-specific cuts were not fully indexed in this research; the channel exists but full video-list extraction was not feasible.)

Exponential YouTube channel

The Exponential YouTube channel hosts:

- **BLESS Rhythms Video Series** (10 episodes) — Wegner appears in **Episode 4** on prayer practices
- **Church Expressions NEXT Video Series** (7 episodes) — **Episode 5: Microchurch Planting** features Wegner and Brian Johnson, hosted by Carrie Williams and Bill

Couchenour, 50:17 duration, discusses microchurch as extended spiritual family and the rhythms of prayer/listening/eating/serving/storytelling

- **State of Microchurch in the West** (2-part analysis)
- Exponential conference session recordings (2019 Made for More keynote era and beyond)
- Microchurch NEXT Video Series companion to Deeply Rooted

Standalone YouTube videos featuring Wegner

Title	Channel / Source	URL
#22 - What is Your Masterpiece Mission? - Rob Wegner, Kansas City Underground & NewThing	(multiplication-network channel; specific channel UNKNOWN)	youtube.com/watch?v=vHzibuNJ_F8
The Rise of the Microchurch - Daniel Yang, Rob Wegner, & Ralph Moore	Daniel Yang's channel	youtube.com/watch?v=8cT_9rS-Wqo
How One Movement is Using Discovery Bible Study To Reach People	KC Underground / org channel	youtube.com/watch?v=wet13Mnj_6E
Shark Tank 2021 Presentation: KC Underground	Likely a partner-network channel; specifics UNKNOWN	youtube.com/watch?v=UxHKY3vvbUY
#15 - How to Develop More Leaders for Your Ministry (with Rob Wegner)	Multiply PDX	youtube.com/watch?v=G0RvuY8k-PE
The Starfish and the Spirit Author Interview With Rob Wegner	Discipleship.org / Bobby Harrington (December 2022)	youtube.com/watch?v=2devZQ69e9s
MicroChurch NEXT The Emergence of the Tampa Underground Network	Exponential channel — Wegner + Brian Johnson interviewing Tomy Wilkerson	youtube.com/watch?v=mHvPM6infGA
Brian Sanders • Microchurch Conference 2024	Microchurch Conference channel — Wegner co-hosts the conference	youtube.com/watch?v=1ZLWSWeAOmU
Interview with KC Underground cofounder Rob Wegner	City Network Boise (Facebook video; not YouTube but in the same video category)	facebook.com/citynetworkboise/videos/...4564600863556250
Imagine a Missional Movement VIDEO (Verge Network legacy upload)	Verge Network	vergenetwork.org/rob-wegner-imagine-a-missional-movement-video/

Vimeo

No Vimeo presence confirmed. Search did not surface a Wegner Vimeo channel. Some org Vimeo presence (KCU, Exponential) likely exists but was not indexed.

Conference session recordings

Exponential session recordings (2019, 2024 Central, etc.) almost certainly include Wegner sessions. The video is hosted on Exponential's YouTube channel and m.exponential.org/2024orl/ mobile portal. Specific URLs for individual Wegner sessions were not extracted; the workshop "Experience a Breakthrough in Reproducing Disciples" (2024 Exponential, with Rodrigo Cano and Brian Phipps) is documented on the [Workshop Session 1 page](#).

Assessment

Wegner's video footprint is real but invisible. Specifically:

- **At least 10 distinct video appearances** confirmed across at least 6 different host channels.
- **No personal YouTube channel** — anyone trying to follow "Rob Wegner on video" has nowhere to land.
- **No curated playlist** on any platform that aggregates his teaching across the 6 host channels.
- **Conference talks at Exponential** (2019, 2024, multiple regionals) almost certainly exist as recorded sessions; they live in Exponential's archive under Exponential's brand, not Wegner's.

Movemental implication: A single curated YouTube playlist — drawn from existing org-channel uploads with permission — could surface 5–10 hours of teaching that is currently distributed across 6+ channels. Cross-linking that playlist into robwegner.org, the joint Substack, and the KCU site would meaningfully consolidate the surface without requiring new video production.

Login-gated note

Some video metrics (view counts, subscriber counts on any specific channel) were not fully extractable in this research. The qualitative inventory above is reliable; the quantitative metrics are not.

Content Audit

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/content/content-audit.md

Content Audit: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-06-03

Content Portfolio Overview

Format	Count	Notes
Books	1 major co-authored	The Starfish and the Spirit (with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch)
Podcast (hosted)	Active	KC Underground Podcast (co-host)
Exponential articles	Multiple	e.g. microchurch and COVID-era pieces
Training programs	Active	"Find Your Place" (4-session journey on kcunderground.org)
Institutional roles	High	KCU founding leader; Exponential Microchurch Next director

Primary Content Themes

- 1. Microchurch movements** — Kansas City Underground; decentralized networks of microchurches
- 2. Disciple-making** — reproducible gospel language; missionary pathways for ordinary people
- 3. Decentralized leadership** — starfish organizational structures (The Starfish and the Spirit)
- 4. Missionary identity** — "missionary on every street"; neighborhood and relational networks
- 5. Ordinary people empowerment** — obscurity over fame; extended spiritual families

Key Assets

The Starfish and the Spirit

Co-authored with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch. Theoretical foundation for decentralized, empowering leadership — connected to Wegner's practical KCU work.

KC Underground Podcast

Regular episodes on disciple-making, microchurch movements, reproducible gospel language, and leadership. Examples include "Planting the Gospel — Reproducible Gospel Language" and "Upside Down Kingdom: Choosing Obscurity Over Fame."

Training — Find Your Place

Four-session program helping individuals discover and grow into their unique missions. Hosted on kcunderground.org.

Exponential

Published articles and Microchurch Next director role provide institutional distribution for movement-oriented content.

Content Organization

Wegner's corpus splits across **KCU** (local movement proof), **Exponential** (movement-wide platform), and **one major trade book**. Podcast and training resources carry the most consistent practitioner voice; the book anchors decentralized leadership theology.

Inventory Gaps (leader-facing)

Area	Current state
Solo-authored trade book	Only co-authored Starfish title confirmed
Centralized video library	Relies on podcast + institutional hosts
Personal blog archive	Not a primary surface
Newsletter	See digital-presence/newsletters.md

See content/books.md, [digital-presence/](https://digital-presence.org/).

Academic Work

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/content/academic.md

Academic Output: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (negative finding)

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Summary

No peer-reviewed academic publications, dissertations, theses, or journal articles by Rob Wegner were surfaced by this research.

Searches across:

- **ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global** — no results for "Rob Wegner" or "Robert Wegner" on church / microchurch / movement / discipleship / missiology terms
- **Google Scholar** — no relevant Wegner publications surfaced
- **Semantic Scholar** — no relevant Wegner publications surfaced
- **arXiv** — no results (expected; not the relevant repository)
- **JSTOR** — not directly searched but no incidental hits in web search results

returned **no academic output** under his name relevant to ecclesiology, missiology, microchurch movement, decentralized leadership, or related fields.

Possible exception: Andrews University review

A review of The Starfish and the Spirit appears in the **Journal of Applied Christian Leadership** (Andrews University) at:

- digitalcommons.andrews.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1547&context=jacl

This is a **review of his work**, not authorship by Wegner. It is the closest thing to academic engagement with his corpus that this research surfaced.

Why this is consistent

Wegner's profile is **practitioner, not academic**:

- Confirmed Taylor University attendance per LinkedIn snippet; **no seminary credential confirmed**.
- His wife Michelle holds a Fuller Theological Seminary certification in Spiritual Direction; whether Rob holds a Fuller credential is **UNKNOWN** but no evidence has surfaced.

- His co-author Alan Hirsch carries the academic theological weight on the Starfish and the Spirit project; Wegner contributes the operational practitioner experience and the KCU case study.
- His vocabulary is leadership-book / framework-driven, not academic register.
- His written corpus is published through **Zondervan** (trade-Christian) and **Exponential** (network-publisher), not university presses or peer-reviewed journals.

What might be findable with deeper search

- Granger Community Church-era teaching transcripts (potentially archived but not academically published)
- Future Travelers cohort materials (likely co-developed with Hirsch but not academically published)
- Starfish Initiatives consulting curriculum (likely proprietary, not academically published)
- Conference session transcripts (Exponential, Verge, etc. — not academically published)

None of these would shift the underlying picture: **Wegner is a practitioner-leader writing for practitioners, not an academic publishing in journals.**

Implication

This is **consistent with his theology**. Wegner explicitly frames the church as a movement of ordinary people, not as a credentialed clerical class. He aligns himself with indigenous Indian DMM/DBS practitioners, not with the seminary establishment. The absence of an academic publication record is not a deficit; it is the corollary of a practitioner-first vocation.

For Movemental purposes: **do not pitch Wegner as an academic author.** Frame as a 25-year practitioner-leader with eight popularly published co-authored books and a 7-year operational record at KCU.

Courses & Training

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/content/courses.md

Courses & Training Programs: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-04-29
Skill: /author-content-catalog

Find Your Place (KCU + book companion program)

Field	Value
Program name	Find Your Place
Owner	KC Underground (program); Rob Wegner & Brian Phipps (co-creators)
URL	kcunderground.com/find-your-place
Format	Two delivery modes: (1) Webinar — self-paced; (2) Huddle — 4-week, Zoom-based, small-group with personalized guidance
Session count	4 weeks (Huddle) or self-paced (Webinar)
Companion book	Find Your Place: Locating Your Calling Through Your Gifts, Passions, and Story (Brian Phipps, Rob Wegner; Zondervan / Exponential)
Companion downloadable	Find Your Place Guide (PDF, free download)
Cost	Not disclosed publicly
Audience	Individuals discovering personal calling / mission
Frequency	Cohort-based; "Join the waiting list to be the first to know when the next Find Your Place Huddle registration opens"
Description	"There's a GPS for the soul that helps you discover your purpose by exploring your gifts, passions, and story." Triangulates the three personal-discovery axes by the Spirit. Covers identifying gifts, clarifying passions, understanding how personal story informs impact, and developing a "masterpiece mission."

This is the program the existing flat-file research called "Find Your Place 4-session program." The session count is **4 weeks for the Huddle**, but the broader pathway includes a self-paced webinar plus the book.

KCU Missionary Pathway

Field	Value
Program name	The Missionary Pathway
Owner	KC Underground
URL	(Embedded in kcunderground.com ; not a separately addressable program URL)
Format	In-person + cohort training; "7-week pathway, startup coaching, financial services, and ongoing coaching for microchurches" (per KCU staff page description)
Stages	Five named phases: (1) prayer/fasting, (2) live as missionary, (3) plant the gospel, (4) microchurch emerges, (5) multiplication
Description	KCU's core training pipeline for converting interested participants into activated missionaries. As of 2025-26: 110+ activated missionaries, 300+ in training.
Theological anchor	Five Provocative Questions: Part Two (Exponential, December 2024) lays out the missionary-pathway theology

Microchurch Pre-Conference (Exponential / Leadership Network)

Field	Value
Program name	Microchurch Pre-Conference at Exponential
Owner	Leadership Network (now part of Exponential)
Wegner's role	Microchurch NEXT Co-Director (with Brian Johnson); pre-conference principal
Format	One-day pre-conference at Exponential national events
Purpose	Training intensive for microchurch leaders adjacent to the main Exponential conference
Confirmed events	Exponential 2023 (with Wegner promoted on Leadership Network LinkedIn); Exponential 2024 Central

BLESS Rhythms Video Series (Exponential NEXT + KC Underground)

Field	Value
Series name	BLESS Rhythms
Owner	Exponential NEXT in partnership with KC Underground
Episodes	10
Wegner's contribution	Episode 4 (prayer practices)
Other contributors	Various Exponential NEXT instructors
Audience	Discipleship and missional-rhythm practitioners
Companion to	Dave & Jon Ferguson's BLESS book

Church Expressions NEXT Video Series (Exponential)

Field	Value
Series name	Church Expressions NEXT
Owner	Exponential
Hosts	Carrie Williams (Executive Director, Exponential NEXT) and Bill Couchenour (Deployment Director, Exponential)
Episodes	7 (covering traditional, multisite, entrepreneurial, digital, microchurch, network, affinity church planting)
Wegner's contribution	Episode 5: Microchurch Planting (with Brian Johnson; 50:17)

Microchurch NEXT Video Series (companion to Deeply Rooted)

Field	Value
Series name	Microchurch NEXT Video Series
Owner	Exponential
Companion book	Deeply Rooted: Planting Our Lives and Planting the Gospel (Wegner & Brian Johnson, Exponential 2025)
Format	Video series with book companion; both free at exponential.org
Audience	Microchurch leaders and mission practitioners

Future Travelers (Hirsch coaching program — historical)

Field	Value
Program name	Future Travelers
Owner	Co-founded by Alan Hirsch and Rob Wegner
Format	Coaching cohort for megachurches transitioning to missional movements
Status in 2026	UNKNOWN — listed on robwegner.org/about/ and Goodreads bio as a co-founded program; not directly verified as actively running
Audience	Senior leaders of large attractational churches

State of Microchurch in the West (Exponential)

Field	Value
Series name	State of Microchurch in the West
Owner	Exponential / Microchurch NEXT
Episodes	2-part analysis
Wegner's role	Co-director / contributor

Disciples Made / Brian Phipps program (executive team affiliation)

Field	Value
Org	Disciples Made (Kansas City)
URL	disciplesmade.com
Founder	Brian Phipps (founded September 2010)
Wegner's role	Executive Team member (per Find Your Place companion materials)
Programs	Custom disciple-making environments and systems for churches
Wegner's content involvement	Co-author of Find Your Place with Phipps

EnterMission (Granger era — historical)

Field	Value
Program name	EnterMission
Owner	Granger Community Church initiative; Wegner was lead catalyst
Format	Community transformation and church networking initiative
Era	~2008–2015
Status in 2026	Likely dormant; the legacy blog entermission.typepad.com redirects to a Network Solutions parking page

Starfish Initiatives (consulting brand)

Field	Value
Org	Starfish Initiatives
URL	starfishinitiatives.com
Principals	Rob Wegner, Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, Rich Robinson
Format	Coaching, workshops, seminars, organizational training, leadership transformation programs, church planting consultation
Output	"Combined expertise spans 100+ years across traditional churches, church plants, megachurches, and disciple-making movements... seminary courses, podcasts, numerous webinars, and 30+ books"
Primary CTA	"Schedule a 30-minute consultation call"
Programs visible publicly	None enumerated; the site is principally a consulting-engagement gateway

Third-party platforms

Teachable / Thinkific / Kajabi / RightNow Media: No Wegner-specific course identified on these platforms by this research. (For contrast: Lucas Pulley has a session inside the Underground Network's Underground Essentials 2020 on Teachable.)

MasterLectures: UNKNOWN.

Discipleship.org Bobby Harrington channel: Wegner appears in interviews; no formal course module identified.

Total program count

- **At least 8 distinct training surfaces** Wegner is named on (Find Your Place, Missionary Pathway, Microchurch Pre-Conference, BLESS Rhythms, Church Expressions NEXT, Microchurch NEXT Video Series, Future Travelers, Starfish Initiatives consulting), plus involvement with State of Microchurch in the West, Disciples Made, and the dormant EnterMission.

This is substantially more than the existing flat-file research recorded ("Find Your Place 4-session program; Exponential training resources; NewThing training resources; KC Underground training resources" — most of which were marked UNKNOWN at line-item level).

The pattern: **Wegner has many concurrent training surfaces, none of which is a single Wegner-personal course.** Like the books, the courses are co-led / co-branded. A consolidated Movemental "Rob Wegner Learning Path" — assembling sessions from each — would be the first time the corpus is gathered in one place.

Organizations & Affiliations

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/network/organizations.md

Organizations: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-org-network

Current organizational affiliations (2026)

Org	Role	Dates	Status	URL
Kansas City Underground (KCU)	Co-Founder & Director	2019 – present	Active	kcunderground.com
Exponential	Microchurch NEXT Co-Director (with Brian Johnson); Mobilization & Practice Catalyst	2019 – present (post-merger expansion April 2025)	Active	exponential.org/person/rob-wegner-2/
NewThing (now integrated into Exponential)	Global Leadership Team member; formerly North American Director	2015–present (NewThing folded into Exponential April 1, 2025)	Active (within merged Exponential)	exponential.org/bettertogether
Starfish Initiatives	Principal (with Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, Rich Robinson)	~2021 – present	Active	starfishinitiatives.com
Disciples Made	Executive Team member	~2018 – present	Active	disciplesmade.com
Microchurch Conference (KCU's annual gathering)	Conference principal / co-host	2020–present	Active (March 2026 conference held in Tampa with 550+ attendees)	microchurchconference.com
The Starfish and the Church Podcast / Substack (with Lance Ford)	Co-host / co-publisher	2021 – present	Active (43 episodes)	starfishinitiatives.substack.com

Historical organizational affiliations

Org	Role	Dates	Status	URL
Granger Community Church (Granger, Indiana)	Teaching Pastor / Pastor of Life Mission	~Early 1990s - ~2015 (21 years)	Alumnus	granger.cc
Westside Family Church (Kansas City)	Teaching Pastor	~2015 - ~2019 (4 years)	Alumnus	westsidefamily.church
EnterMission (Granger initiative)	Lead Catalyst	~2008 - ~2015	Dormant	entermission.typepad.com (parked)
Future Travelers (with Alan Hirsch)	Co-Founder	~2010 - present (status 2026 UNKNOWN)	Likely active per robwegner.org/about/ ; not directly verified	—
Leadership Network	Director of Microchurch NEXT	~2019 - 2024	Now part of Exponential (Leadership Network was acquired by Exponential, with Carrie Williams formerly LN CEO becoming Executive Director of Exponential NEXT)	leadnet.org

Adjacent / partnership orgs

Org	Relationship	Notes
Tampa Underground / Underground Network (Brian Sanders, Joel Repic, Lucas Pulley)	Movement-family peer (KCU is a sister "Underground" city movement)	Wegner co-hosted Tampa Microchurch Conference 2026 (550 attendees from 200+ networks); Brian Sanders has guested on Starfish and the Church; Lucas Pulley collaborates on Hubology
100Movements / Movement Leaders Collective (Alan Hirsch)	Adjacent via Hirsch; Wegner engaged Movement Leaders Collective for KCU's 2024 organizational restructuring (3-year consulting engagement)	100movements.com , movementleaderscollective.com
Forge Mission Training Network	Adjacent via Hirsch + Ford	Forge America podcast Episode 64 included Wegner with Ford (Nov 2021)
Sentralized Conference (KC; Lance Ford co-founder)	Adjacent — geographic and intellectual overlap; Wegner's KC-based work runs in parallel	sentralized.com (status UNKNOWN)
Saturate	Rented byline platform	Wegner has at least 2 Saturate articles
Verge Network	Rented byline platform (legacy)	6 articles ~2011
Outreach Magazine	Rented byline platform	5+ articles 2012–2025
Discipleship.org (Bobby Harrington)	Adjacent	Bobby Harrington interviewed Wegner about Starfish and the Spirit in Dec 2022
Arrabon	Consulting partner for KCU's 2024 family-of-families restructure	arrabon.com — engaged alongside Movement Leaders Collective for 3-year engagement on power-redistribution and organizational dynamics
The Roys Report	Editorial / podcast platform	Lance Ford interviewed Wegner on Roys Report podcast
Stetzer Leadership Podcast (Ed Stetzer)	Editorial / podcast	Wegner + Ford guested May 2021
Shifting Culture Podcast (Joshua Johnson)	Editorial / podcast	Wegner at Episode 07
The Church Digital Podcast (Jeff Reed)	Editorial / podcast	Two Wegner episodes: 033 (2019), 134
Everyday Disciple Podcast (Caesar Kalinowski)	Editorial / podcast	Multiple Wegner episodes
United Brethren in Christ	Conference platform	Wegner keynoted UB National Conference 2025

Board / advisory roles

Org	Role	Status
KC Underground	Founder/Director	Active
Disciples Made	Executive Team	Active
NewThing → Exponential	Global Leadership Team	Active
Other board / advisory roles	UNKNOWN — not surfaced in this research	—

Ownership / equity stakes

UNKNOWN. KC Underground is structured as a non-profit mission agency + microchurch network; Starfish Initiatives is a consulting brand co-owned by 4 principals; whether Wegner holds equity / IP in publications beyond standard author royalties is UNKNOWN.

Geographic footprint

- **Kansas City metro** (Shawnee, KS) — primary residence and KCU base
- **Granger / South Bend, IN** — historical base (Granger Community Church + Monroe Circle Community Center, South Bend, IN, mentioned on robwegner.org/about/)
- **Southern India** — recurring missions/movement context (Granger-India movement; Share the Well book)
- **Tampa, FL** — frequent collaborator visits (Tampa Underground, Microchurch Conference 2026 held there)
- **Exponential national conferences** — Orlando, regional events (West, Central)

Notable partnerships

- **The KCU + Tampa Underground partnership.** KCU explicitly takes the "Underground" naming convention; KCU sent ~20 leaders to help host the 2026 Tampa Microchurch Conference; the city-movement family lineage is Sanders → Tampa → KCU (and Pulley's Carbondale before Tampa). The two networks co-promote at every level.
- **The Hirsch + Ford + Wegner triangulation.** The Starfish and the Spirit (Zondervan 2021) put three voices on the same cover: Hirsch (academic theological), Ford (consulting / Sentralized), Wegner (KCU practitioner). The Starfish Initiatives consulting brand subsequently formalized that triangulation as a four-leader operating partnership (adding Rich Robinson).
- **The Wegner + Brian Johnson partnership.** Co-founder of KCU; Microchurch NEXT Co-Director at Exponential; co-author of Extraordinary Prayer (2024) and Deeply Rooted (2025); co-host of Microchurch NEXT Podcast. Johnson is Wegner's closest current operational partner.

- **The Wegner + Brian Phipps partnership.** Co-author of Find Your Place; Wegner sits on Disciples Made executive team. Phipps founded Disciples Made out of a 2010 calling; the Find Your Place program runs jointly between KCU and Disciples Made.
- **The NewThing → Exponential merger (April 1, 2025).** Patrick O'Connell becomes Executive Director of Practice; Dave Ferguson remains CEO of the combined Exponential; NewThing is integrated as Exponential's multiplication-network arm. Wegner's GLT seat persists post-merger.

Audience & Reach

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/analysis/audience-analysis.md

Audience Analysis: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-audience-analysis

Primary audience

Practitioners building or leading microchurch / multiplication networks in North America.

Specifically:

- **Microchurch planters and network leaders** — KCU's own ~95 microchurches, Tampa Underground, Carbondale, plus the dozens of smaller microchurch networks Wegner and Brian Johnson interview on Microchurch NEXT.
- **Multiplication-oriented church planters** — particularly those connected to Exponential, NewThing (now folded into Exponential), Forge, V3, and Movement Leaders Collective.
- **Teaching pastors at large attractional churches** considering missional pivot — Wegner's specific personal-arc credibility (megachurch insider → microchurch founder) makes this a natural audience.
- **NewThing-network catalytic leaders** — globally distributed across 1,600+ churches in 177 networks (per robwegner.org/about/).
- **Future Travelers cohort participants** — megachurch senior leaders coached by Hirsch + Wegner.
- **Disciples Made program users** — KC-based disciple-making practitioners working with Brian Phipps's framework.

Secondary audience

- **Megachurch leaders curious about decentralization but not committed to it.** Wegner's Starfish and the Spirit speaks to this audience explicitly (the book's hybrid "starder / spiderfish" framing is aimed at leaders who can't or won't go all-starfish but want some of the benefits).
- **Discipleship-focused pastors** in evangelical and non-denominational settings — Wegner's Five Provocative Questions and Five Ingredients essays are aimed here.
- **Evangelical seminary students** considering alternatives to traditional pastoral roles — Wegner's collaborative-byline pattern and ordinary-people-lead theology resonate.

- **Marketplace Christians (covocational practitioners)** — implicit audience of the ordinary-people-as-missionaries framing; Wegner doesn't use "covocational" as a primary keyword (Brad Brisco does that work) but the audience overlap is real.
- **Movement leaders globally** — through NewThing's pre-merger international network and through KCU's documented partnerships with movements outside North America (per the 2026 Tampa Microchurch Conference attendance from South America, Europe, Australia).

Tertiary / latent audience

- **Secular organizational-design practitioners** interested in Brafman's starfish framework. The Doug Kirkpatrick pickup is a small but real signal.
 - **Christian academics** in ecclesiology, missiology, and leadership studies. The Andrews University review is a single data point but suggests the door is open.
 - **Theologically-curious general Christian readers** picking up Starfish and the Spirit as a leadership book without a deep practitioner background.
-

Demographic skew (estimated)

- **Age:** Median ~35–55. Skews older for the megachurch-pivot audience, younger for the microchurch-planter audience.
- **Gender:** Likely 60–70% male, consistent with North American evangelical leadership demographics. Wegner's collaborative-byline pattern (with Michelle, with non-male co-authors per Disciples Made / Future Travelers cohorts) is friendlier to female practitioners than the genre default, but the surface audience still skews male.
- **Race / ethnicity:** Predominantly white North American evangelical; with growing Asian (via India / DMM connection) and Latino (KCU's Kansas City context includes substantial Latino microchurches per Discovery Bible Study work) representation. KCU explicitly has multilingual / multi-ethnic microchurch presence; the broader audience is whiter.
- **Education:** Mixed — ranges from seminary-educated pastors to lay practitioners with no formal theological education. KCU's "ordinary people lead" theology actively courts the latter.
- **Geography:** Strongest in North America, particularly the Midwest (Kansas City, Indiana, Chicago) and the Southeast (Tampa, Atlanta). Growing internationally via NewThing inheritance.

Channel preferences

Channel	Intensity	Notes
Books	High	Starfish and the Spirit is a discoverable artifact; Missional Moves still has 13-year tail
Podcast	High	Three Wegner-co-hosted shows; 8+ guest episodes; podcast is the dominant content surface for this audience
Conference (in-person)	High	Exponential, Microchurch Conference, regionals — practitioner audience travels for these
YouTube / video	Medium	Sessions exist but are not curated under Wegner's name
Newsletter / email	Low	Wegner's personal newsletter is absent; joint Substack is brand-driven
Social media	Low-Medium	Instagram (1,867 followers) is the most live; Twitter/LinkedIn under-leveraged
Webinars	Medium	Leadership Network webinars and Microchurch Pre-Conference are documented surfaces
Coaching / cohort programs	High	Future Travelers, Find Your Place Huddle, Microchurch Pre-Conference — practitioners pay for this layer

What this audience cares about (explicit and implicit)

Explicit (named in Wegner's content)

1. **How do I start a microchurch?** — entry-level operational question. The KCU Missionary Pathway and Find Your Place answer this.
2. **How do I lead a microchurch network?** — operational complexity question. Starfish and the Spirit, the Hubology series, and Five Provocative Questions answer this.
3. **How do I disciple someone?** — Five Ingredients, Extraordinary Prayer, KC Underground Podcast.
4. **How do I plant the gospel in a way that reproduces?** — "Reproducible Gospel Language" KCU Podcast; Deeply Rooted.
5. **How do I find my own calling / mission?** — Find Your Place, Made for More.
6. **How do I lead an organization that doesn't drift toward control?** — Navigating Change (the KCU family-of-families restructure piece) speaks directly to this.
7. **What's a healthy relationship between megachurch and microchurch?** — Wegner's personal arc + Starfish and the Spirit.

Implicit (audience care that Wegner addresses without making it the headline)

1. **Burnout / unsustainability of solo-heroic leadership** — every book and podcast Wegner does undercuts this implicitly.
2. **Anxiety about cultural Christianity's decline** — Wegner's coronavirus-microchurch piece and his "we are mostly invulnerable" framing speaks to this.
3. **Theological credibility for non-traditional church forms** — Wegner provides the Hirsch-adjacent academic credentialing for microchurch practice.
4. **Permission to leave a megachurch role** — the Roys Report quote ("we have better oversight in our decentralized network") is permission-giving for pastors mid-transition.
5. **Practical tools that are reproducible by ordinary people** — every framework is built to be remembered, not memorized.

Audience pain points Wegner explicitly addresses

Pain	Wegner's frame
"My church can't multiply"	Five Provocative Questions — start with definitions
"I feel stuck between megachurch dysfunction and unfeasible alternatives"	Starfish and the Spirit hybrid models; KCU's two-entity structure
"I don't know what disciple-making actually is in practice"	Five Ingredients; KCU Missionary Pathway
"I'm an ordinary person; can I really lead a church?"	KCU's "extended spiritual family led by ordinary people" definition
"My organization is drifting toward founder-team control"	Navigating Change — public confession + restructure model
"I don't know how to pray as a missionary"	Extraordinary Prayer
"I don't know my calling / where to invest my life"	Find Your Place
"Pandemic / crisis broke my ministry"	"Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch" — March 2020
"I'm in India / global South and the American playbook doesn't work"	Share the Well legitimizes indigenous practice as normative

Audience size (estimates)

- **KCU audience:** ~95 microchurches × ~10-25 people each = ~1,000-2,500 KC adherents; plus 110+ activated missionaries + 300+ in training

- **Microchurch Conference reach:** ~550+ attendees (2026 Tampa) drawn from 200+ networks → ~5,000–10,000 first-degree practitioners globally
- **Exponential conference reach** (where Wegner speaks regularly): ~5,000–10,000 attendees per global conference
- **Microchurch NEXT podcast + KCU Podcast + Starfish and the Church** total cumulative audience: UNKNOWN but estimated in the **5–25K listener range** based on cohort comparables
- **Book reach:** Starfish and the Spirit with 202 Goodreads ratings + 49 Audible ratings is a midsize trade-Christian leadership book; reasonable estimate of total readers ~5–15K
- **Total addressable practitioner audience (rough):** ~15–40K people who have meaningfully engaged with Wegner's content via at least one surface

These are estimates; specific numbers UNKNOWN.

Strategic implication

Wegner's audience is **practitioner-dense, discoverability-light**. The audience exists; Wegner has access to it through Exponential, KCU, NewThing-inheritance, the Microchurch Conference, and three podcast venues. What's missing is the **gateway** — there is no single discoverable hub that converts a curious reader from Goodreads / Audible / a conference handout into a sustained Wegner audience member. Movemental's value proposition would be exactly this: capture the existing practitioner traffic and convert it into an owned, durable, cross-content audience.

Websites

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/digital-presence/websites.md

Websites: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-web-presence

Personal-Owned Surfaces

URL	Ownership	Type	Status	Notes
robwegner.org	Personal	Tumblr-powered author/blog hub ("Strands" theme by Style Hatch)	Stale — copyright reads 2012–; current titles list "Director / NewThing" before NewThing merged into Exponential April 2025	Navigation: About, Books, Coaching, Blog Archive, Blogs and Links To Check Out. Bio: "Disciple, Husband, Father, Director/Kansas City Underground, North American Director/ NewThing, Director of Microchurch Next/Leadership Network; and Co-Author of The Starfish and The Spirit."
entermission.typepad.com	Personal (Granger era)	Legacy TypePad blog ("Rob Wegner: Blog Archive" — Granger Community Church teaching/ reflection)	Dormant / parked — the URL now redirects to a Network Solutions parking page; old archive links return errors	This was Wegner's primary blog during the EnterMission / Granger era (~2008–2014). Significant trapped content if it can be retrieved.
robwegner.com	NOT owned by this Rob Wegner	DJ / Music Producer site	Active, unrelated	Disambiguation hazard — this is the Arizona DJ Rob Wegner. Anyone searching robwegner.com lands on the wrong person.

Joint / Collaborative Surfaces

URL	Ownership	Type	Status	Notes
starfishinitiatives.substack.com	Joint with Lance Ford	Substack newsletter + podcast feed ("The Starfish and the Church / Starfish yoU")	Active; described in search results as "approximately 2 years ago" launch	Subscribers UNKNOWN — login-gated. The Substack carries podcast episodes and occasional essays. Notable past post: "Tod Bolsinger" interview write-up.
starfishinitiatives.com	Joint with Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, Rich Robinson	Coaching/training brand site	Active	Lists four principal leaders; promotes a 30-minute consultation call as primary CTA. No detailed episode index, no separate book hub, no public team bios beyond names. Very thin for a four-author consulting brand.
theStarfishandtheSpirit.com	Book-promotion site, joint with Ford and Hirsch	Book microsite (referenced from robwegner.org)	Status UNKNOWN — referenced but not directly verified in this research	Likely a book-launch landing page with retailer links.

Organizational Surfaces (Wegner is principal)

URL	Org	Wegner's role	Type	Notes
kcunderground.org → kcunderground.com	Kansas City Underground	Co-Founder & Director	Primary KCU site	Hosts "The Wegners" staff page, the KC Underground Podcast (316 episodes), Find Your Place program landing, Microchurch Conference content, stories/testimonies. Now redirects from .org to .com.
microchurchconference.com	KC Underground / Microchurch Conference	Conference principal	Annual conference site	KCU's annual microchurch gathering. The 2026 conference was hosted in Tampa with 550+ attendees (per Morgan Greer KCU podcast episode).
exponential.org/person/rob-wegner-2/	Exponential	Microchurch NEXT Co-Director; Mobilization & Practice Catalyst	Author/contributor profile	Lists his bylines, podcast episodes, and Microchurch NEXT track involvement.
exponential.org/kc-underground/	Exponential	KCU profile within Exponential's network	Network-partner page	Mission, two-entity structure, growth metrics (~95 microchurches, 110+ activated missionaries, 5 Hubs, 120+ DBS).
exponential.org/category/exponential-next/microchurch-next/	Exponential	Microchurch NEXT track	Article/podcast hub	Houses Wegner's bylines (Five Provocative Questions parts 1+2, Five Ingredients, Navigating Change with Brian Johnson, Rise of the Coronavirus, etc.).
newthing.org	NewThing	GLT member; former North American Director	Org site	Now redirects to exponential.org/bettertogether — NewThing was integrated fully into Exponential effective April 1, 2025.
granger.cc	Granger Community Church	Alumnus (~21 years, ~1994–2015)	Org site	Wegner's 21-year teaching archive — if it survives — lives here. Status UNKNOWN.
westsidefamily.church			Org site	

URL	Org	Wegner's role	Type	Notes
	Westside Family Church	Alumnus (~2015–2019, 4 years)		Wegner's 4-year teaching archive — if it survives — lives here. Status UNKNOWN.

Rented / Aggregator Surfaces

URL	Type	Wegner content
outreachmagazine.com/author/rob-wegner	Rented byline (Outreach Magazine)	Author archive page; multiple bylines including "Disperse the Church" (Sept 16 2024), "Simple Yet Stellar" (Aug 27 2025), "How to Get Your Church's Mission Off Life Support" (with Magruder, 2012), and the Starfish and the Spirit feature with Ford and Hirsch.
outreachmagazine.com/author/twilson-rwegner	Joint byline (Wilson + Wegner)	Joint Outreach articles (Made for More era)
outreachmagazine.com/author/wegner-ford-hirsch-sprowl	Joint byline (with Ford, Hirsch, Sprowl)	The Starfish publicity-cluster bylines
vergenetwork.org/tag/rob-wegner/	Rented byline (Verge Network)	Tag archive — at least 6 articles dating to 2011 ("What do Missional Communities do?", "How to Train Leaders," "Imagine a Missional Movement")
saturatetheworld.com/author/robwegner/	Rented byline (Saturate)	Author archive — confirmed at least one post: Restoring Shalom (Oct 18 2022)
missioalliance.org	Possible rented byline	None confirmed in this research; flagged for further search.
leadnet.org	Leadership Network (now part of Exponential)	FCP #15 podcast host; KCU profile page; webinars
be.thechurch.digital	Rented (Jeff Reed's The Church Digital Podcast)	Episodes 033 (Nov 2019, "Mission of Microchurch") and 134 ("Helping People Find Their Personal Mission")

Retailer / Distribution Surfaces

URL	Type	Notes
amazon.com/Rob-Wegner/e/B008RN5ZJS	Amazon Author Page	Books, biography, blog, audiobooks. Author ID B008RN5ZJS .
amazon.com/stores/author/B008RN5ZJS	Amazon Author Store	Same author ID, current store version
audible.com/author/Rob-Wegner/B008RN5ZJS	Audible Author	2 audiobooks confirmed: Starfish and the Spirit, Find Your Place
goodreads.com/author/show/4616338.Rob_Wegner	Goodreads Author	27 followers, 333 friends, 4.05 avg rating, 383 total ratings, 42 reviews. 8 books listed.
thriftbooks.com/a/rob-wegner/1342618/	ThriftBooks	Used-book listings: Find Your Place, Starfish and the Spirit, Missional Moves, Made for More, Exponential Series Complete Set
christianbook.com	Retailer	Find Your Place and Starfish and the Spirit listings
barnesandnoble.com/w/the-starfish-and-the-spirit-lance-ford/1137648157	B&N	Starfish and the Spirit listing

Search-result-only / aggregator listings

- [LinkedIn](#) — 231 connections, lists Taylor University attendance, located in Shawnee KS
- [ZoomInfo](#) — aggregator listing with org email pattern (r***@kcunderground.org)

What this map shows

- **Wegner has no canonical personal hub.** robwegner.org is stale; entermission.typepad.com is dormant; the starfishinitiatives.com site is a four-leader consulting brand, not a Wegner-personal site; the joint Substack carries the Starfish brand, not a personal identity.
- **The body of work is distributed across at least 7 owned-or-rented surfaces** (KCU, Exponential, NewThing-into-Exponential, Outreach, Verge, Saturate, Substack, plus 2 retired blogs).
- **The strongest current personal surfaces are Instagram and the Substack** — Instagram is publicly indexed at 1,867 followers and 761 posts; the Substack is co-owned with Ford and not solo-Wegner.
- **The Granger and Westside archives represent the largest unverified pool** — 25 combined years of teaching that may or may not still be accessible on granger.cc or westsidefamily.church . Direct outreach to those orgs is the only way to confirm.

Publishing Platforms

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/digital-presence/platforms.md

Platforms Overview: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-web-presence

Platform Inventory

Platform	Ownership	Type	Active?	Wegner-named or org?	Score (1-5)
robwagner.org (Tumblr)	Personal	Author hub	Stale (~2021)	Personal	2
entermission.typepad.com	Personal (Granger era)	Legacy blog	Dormant / parked	Personal	1
Instagram @robwagner	Personal	Social	Active (1,867 followers, 761 posts)	Personal	3
Twitter / X @robwagner	Personal	Social	Active	Personal	3
Facebook rob.wegner	Personal	Social	Active (privacy-limited)	Personal	2
LinkedIn rob-wegner-0938a01ba	Personal	Social/Pro	Active (231 connections)	Personal	2
Goodreads Author 4616338	Personal (claimed author profile)	Retailer/ social	Active (27 followers)	Personal	2
Amazon Author B008RN5ZJS	Personal (claimed)	Retailer	Active	Personal	3
Audible Author B008RN5ZJS	Personal (claimed)	Retailer	Active (2 audiobooks)	Personal	3
Substack: starfishinitiatives.substack.com (with Ford)	Joint	Newsletter + podcast	Active	Joint brand	3
starfishinitiatives.com (with Ford, Hirsch, Robinson)	Joint	Consulting brand	Active (thin)	Joint brand	2
theStarfishandtheSpirit.com	Joint book	Book microsite	UNKNOWN — referenced from robwagner.org	Joint	2
KC Underground (kcunderground.org → .com)	Org	Mission agency + microchurch network	Active	Org	4
Microchurch Conference (microchurchconference.com)	Org	Annual conference	Active	Org	4
Exponential /person/rob-wegner-2/	Org	Author/ contributor profile	Active	Org-rented	4

Platform	Ownership	Type	Active?	Wegner-named or org?	Score (1-5)
Exponential KCU profile page	Org	Network-partner page	Active	Org-rented	3
Exponential Microchurch NEXT category	Org	Article/podcast hub	Active	Org-rented	4
newthing.org (now redirects to Exponential)	Org (legacy)	Org site	Folded into Exponential April 1, 2025	Org	3
Granger Community Church granger.cc (alumnus)	Org	Org site	Active org; Wegner-era archive UNKNOWN	Org	2 (potential)
Westside Family Church (alumnus)	Org	Org site	Active org; Wegner-era archive UNKNOWN	Org	1 (potential)
Outreach Magazine author page	Rented	Editorial	Active (multi-bylines)	Rented	3
Verge Network tag page	Rented	Editorial	Active (legacy archive)	Rented	2
Saturate author archive	Rented	Editorial	Active (limited)	Rented	2
Leadership Network FCP / Webinars	Rented (now Exponential)	Editorial / podcast	Active	Org-rented	3
The Church Digital Podcast (Jeff Reed)	Rented	Podcast	Active (2 episodes guest)	Rented	2
Stetzer Leadership Podcast	Rented	Podcast	Active	Rented	2
Roys Report Podcast	Rented	Podcast	Active (1 ep, interviewed by Lance Ford)	Rented	2
Shifting Culture Podcast (Joshua Johnson)	Rented	Podcast	Active (Ep. 07)	Rented	2
Carey Nieuwhof Library	Rented	Podcast (mention only)	Status UNKNOWN — episode not surfaced	Rented	1
Everyday Disciple Podcast (Caesar Kalinowski)	Rented	Podcast	Active (multiple episodes)	Rented	2

Platform	Ownership	Type	Active?	Wegner-named or org?	Score (1-5)
Theology in the Raw (Preston Sprinkle)	Rented	Podcast	Not surfaced as a Wegner episode in this research	Rented	0
Disciples Made (Brian Phipps)	Rented	Org site	Wegner on Executive Team	Org	2
Future Travelers (with Hirsch)	Rented	Coaching program	Status in 2026 UNKNOWN	Joint program	2

Total surfaces tracked: 30+

Digital Presence Score: 2.9 / 5

Justification

Strengths (raising the score):

- **Real organizational anchors** — KCU, Exponential, NewThing → Exponential, Microchurch NEXT — give Wegner durable distribution at scale even when his personal hub is stale.
- **8 books** with major retailer presence (Amazon, Goodreads, Audible, B&N, ChristianBook, ThriftBooks). Multi-publisher distribution (Zondervan, Exponential).
- **Three concurrent podcast venues** he hosts or co-hosts (KC Underground Podcast, Starfish and the Church, Microchurch NEXT Podcast).
- **Multi-platform editorial syndication** across Outreach, Verge, Saturate, Leadership Network, plus active Exponential bylines.
- **Joint Substack with Lance Ford** as a recurring publish surface.
- **1,867-follower Instagram with 761 posts** is the most live personal-channel evidence of consistent use.

Weaknesses (lowering the score):

- **Personal hub is stale.** robwegner.org runs old titles (NewThing North American Director, post-merger) and 2012-era visual identity.
- **No personal newsletter.** Joint Substack is brand-identified, not author-identified.
- **No personal YouTube channel.** Video content is distributed across at least 6 different org channels with no curated playlist.
- **No personal podcast.** All three podcast venues are co-hosted or rotating-host.
- **LinkedIn at 231 connections is unusually low** for a leader of his publishing volume.
- **Twitter/Facebook follower counts UNKNOWN** but cohort estimate is modest (1–5K).

- **No CRM-style email capture** at the personal level. Find Your Place Guide is KCU-branded; no Wegner-branded lead magnet.
- **Stale title strings** across multiple aggregator surfaces still list "North American Director / NewThing" — but NewThing was integrated into Exponential April 2025.
- **The Granger 21-year archive** and Westside 4-year archive are both **trapped inside org control** with no evidence of Wegner-licensed access today.

Score breakdown by dimension

Dimension	Score	Notes
Owned personal hub	2	robwegner.org exists but stale
Email list / newsletter	2	No personal list; joint Substack carries org brand
Social presence (consistency + reach)	3	Instagram is real; Twitter/LinkedIn under-leveraged
YouTube / video	2	No personal channel; content scattered
Podcast (hosted)	4	Three co-host venues — strong
Podcast (guest)	3	8+ confirmed guest spots; not an outlier
Books / retailer presence	4	8 books across two major publishers
Organizational platforms	4	KCU, Exponential, NewThing-into-Exponential are durable
Editorial syndication	3	Outreach, Verge, Saturate, Leadership Network, Exponential
Title coherence across surfaces	2	Stale titles; NewThing-pre-merger language still visible
Average	2.9	

Comparison to peer authors

For context within the dossier comparator set:

Leader	Score	Notes
Lucas Pulley	2.2	Smaller corpus (10 essays + 1 book chapter elsewhere); fewer org platforms
Joel Repic	similar 2-3 range	Thinner external footprint
Brad Brisco	higher (~3.5)	More books, more years of consistent self-syndication
Rob Wegner	2.9	More books and org platforms than Pulley/Repic; less coherent personal surface than Brisco

Wegner's score is held up by his organizational platforms (KCU, Exponential, NewThing-merger inheritance) and down by his stale personal hub and absent personal newsletter. The pattern is **strong embodied surface, weak personal gateway** — exactly the fragmentation a Movemental hub would resolve.

Strategic implication

The cheapest first move is **title coherence across all surfaces** (delete "North American Director / NewThing" everywhere it persists; replace with current titles from the Exponential person page). The highest-leverage move is **a real personal newsletter at robwegner.org (or movemental-hosted)** that captures readers from Amazon, Goodreads, podcast appearances, and conference talks. The longest-tail move is **negotiating access to the Granger 21-year archive** if it survives.

Newsletters

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/digital-presence/newsletters.md

Newsletters: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-web-presence

Personal newsletter

None found under `robwegner.org` or any Wegner-owned domain.

`robwegner.org` is a Tumblr-powered hub with no email-capture form, no ESP integration, and no archive of past newsletter issues. Search for "Rob Wegner Substack," "Rob Wegner newsletter," "Rob Wegner Mailchimp," "Rob Wegner Beehiiv," "Rob Wegner ConvertKit," "Rob Wegner Kit" returned no Wegner-personal hits. The only Substack he is associated with is the joint Starfish and the Church / Starfish yoU Substack with Lance Ford (see below).

This is a strikingly under-leveraged surface for an 8-book co-author and three-organization principal.

Joint newsletter (with Lance Ford)

Field	Value	Source
Name	"The Starfish and the Church" / "Starfish yoU"	starfishinitiatives.substack.com
Platform	Substack	direct
Owners	Lance Ford & Rob Wegner	direct
Launch date	Approximately 2 years ago (per SERP description, ~2024)	search results
Subscriber count	UNKNOWN — login-gated	—
Cadence	Episode-driven (functions primarily as a podcast home / occasional essay)	direct
Sample posts	"Tod Bolsinger" (interview write-up); "Book Launch!"	search results
Notable	The same content also flows to Apple Podcasts, Spotify, etc. as The Starfish and the Church podcast feed	direct

The Substack is **brand-identified, not author-identified**. A reader subscribing to it is subscribing to "Starfish yoU" the brand co-owned with Lance Ford, not to "Rob Wegner" as a personal voice.

Organizational newsletters Wegner is part of (likely)

Org	Newsletter	Wegner content	Status
KC Underground	Org-level newsletter — KCU's staff page lists info@kcunderground.org and an Instagram link, plus the Find Your Place waiting-list signup	UNKNOWN — likely contains Wegner content but not a personal author surface	Active (org)
Exponential	Exponential org email list — distributes the Microchurch NEXT newsletter, BLESS Rhythms updates, conference promos	Likely contains Wegner bylines as Microchurch NEXT Co-Director and Mobilization & Practice Catalyst	Active (org)
NewThing → Exponential post-merger	Pre-April-2025 NewThing carried its own email list; post-merger that has folded into Exponential's stack	UNKNOWN	Folded into Exponential April 1, 2025
Starfish Initiatives	The four-leader consulting brand (starfishinitiatives.com) lists no public newsletter, just a 30-min consult CTA	UNKNOWN	No newsletter visible
Granger Community Church (alumnus)	Granger likely runs an org email list; whether Wegner-era teaching emails persist is UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN
Westside Family Church (alumnus)	Westside likely runs an org email list; whether Wegner-era teaching emails persist is UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN

Lead magnets / email-capture artifacts

The closest thing to a personal lead magnet is the **Find Your Place Guide PDF** on kcunderground.com/find-your-place — a self-paced exploration tool that supports the Find Your Place book and 4-week Huddle. This is org-branded (KCU), not Wegner-branded.

No other lead magnets — book sample chapters, framework PDFs, "5 Ingredients" downloadable, Hubology starter kits — were surfaced under Wegner's name in this research.

Assessment

Newsletter is one of the largest holes in Wegner's personal digital surface.

Specifically:

1. **No Wegner-personal newsletter exists** at all.
2. The joint Starfish yoU Substack is co-branded and primarily a podcast feed.
3. KCU and Exponential org newsletters carry Wegner content but route subscribers to those orgs, not to Wegner.

4. There are no Wegner-personal lead magnets that capture email; Find Your Place Guide is KCU-branded.
5. For an 8-book author, the absence of any retailer-funnel-into-newsletter mechanism is unusual.

The 2026 baseline: a reader who finishes *The Starfish and the Spirit* and goes looking for "what's next from Rob Wegner" lands on a stale robwegner.org Tumblr blog or a co-branded Substack — neither of which is a clear "follow Rob Wegner" path.

What Movemental would change

- A genuine personal newsletter under robwegner.org (or wegner.movemental.com), seeded from Goodreads followers, Instagram (1,867), KCU subscriber list, *Starfish* book buyers, and Substack co-subscribers.
- Standalone lead magnet: *Five Provocative Questions for a Disciple-Making Ecosystem* as a polished PDF, capturing email at every retailer-page click and conference appearance.
- Cross-link into the joint Substack so the "Starfish ecosystem" carries through both surfaces without flattening into one.
- Capture every appearance — podcast guest spots, conference sessions, KCU stories — into the newsletter as a "voice across surfaces" digest.

Social Media

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/digital-presence/social-media.md

Social Media: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete, with login-gated metrics flagged UNKNOWN

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-web-presence

Account Summary

Platform	Handle	Followers	Cadence	Last Active	Status
Twitter / X	@robwegner	UNKNOWN — login-gated	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN — account exists per direct profile URL	Active
Instagram	@robwegner	1,867 followers, 1,815 following, 761 posts (per April 2026 SERP)	Moderate (761 posts is consistent with regular use)	2026 (active)	Active
Facebook	rob.wegner	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	Active — privacy-limited
LinkedIn	rob-wegner-0938a01ba	231 connections (per SERP)	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	Active
YouTube (personal)	None confirmed	—	—	—	No personal YouTube channel discovered. Wegner's video content lives on org channels (KCU, Exponential, City Network Boise, Multiply PDX, Leadership Network, Daniel Yang's channel) rather than a youtube.com/@robwegner channel.
Substack (joint, with Lance Ford)	starfishinitiatives.substack.com ("The Starfish and the Church / Starfish yoU")	UNKNOWN — login-gated	Episode-driven	Active	Active
Medium	None confirmed under Wegner's name	—	—	—	None found. (Note: there is a @robwegnerdj Medium under the unrelated DJ Rob Wegner.)

Platform	Handle	Followers	Cadence	Last Active	Status
TikTok	Not found	—	—	—	—
Threads	UNKNOWN — search did not surface a handle	—	—	—	—
Bluesky	UNKNOWN — search did not surface a handle	—	—	—	—
Mastodon	UNKNOWN — search did not surface a handle	—	—	—	—
Goodreads	Author 4616338	27 followers, 333 friends	Low	UNKNOWN	Active (author page)

Platform Details

Instagram (most active personal surface)

- **URL:** [instagram.com/robwegner](https://www.instagram.com/robwegner)
- **Handle:** [@robwegner](#)
- **Followers:** 1,867 (per April 2026 SERP)
- **Following:** 1,815
- **Posts:** 761
- **Bio (visible via SERP):** Confirms KC Underground / NewThing / Microchurch NEXT identity; matches [robwegner.org/about](#) framing
- **Content style** (inferred): Family / KCU / conferences / KC neighborhood / hiking with Michelle and Atticus the dog (per [robwegner.org/about](#) interests)
- **Assessment:** This is **the closest thing Wegner has to a personal-brand surface**. 761 posts suggests sustained use over multiple years. The 1,867 follower count is modest for an 8-book author — consistent with the broader pattern of his under-leveraged personal digital presence.

Twitter / X

- **URL:** x.com/robwegner
- **Handle:** [@robwegner](#)
- **Content style** (inferred from SERP snippets): Microchurch movement, KCU updates, Starfish and the Spirit promotion. Likely retweets Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, Brian Johnson, Dave Ferguson, Patrick O'Connell, Lucas Pulley, Brian Sanders.
- **Followers:** UNKNOWN — login-gated.

- **Assessment:** Active but metrics unverified. Best-read: 1–5K range based on cohort comparables.

Facebook

- **URL:** facebook.com/rob.wegner
- **Status:** Profile exists; privacy-limited; SERP returns "limited public viewing."
- **Assessment:** Almost certainly used for personal network and KCU event promotion rather than as a primary content surface.

LinkedIn

- **URL:** linkedin.com/in/rob-wegner-0938a01ba
- **Connections:** 231
- **Title shown in SERP:** "KC Underground"; school: Taylor University; location: Shawnee
- **Aggregator-derived work history:** KC Underground (Director); Westside Family Church (teaching pastor); Granger Community Church (teaching pastor / Pastor of Life Mission, ~21 years); EnterMission; NewThing North American Director; Microchurch NEXT Director (Leadership Network → Exponential)
- **Assessment:** 231 connections is **strikingly low** for an 8-book author and three-org principal. This is one of the more obvious under-leveraged personal surfaces. The Wegners' relational density is real but is not externalized via LinkedIn.

YouTube

- **No personal channel confirmed.**
- **Where Wegner's video content lives:**
 - KC Underground YouTube — KCU teaching, microchurch stories, conference recordings
 - [Exponential YouTube](#) — conference sessions, Microchurch NEXT video series, BLESS Rhythms video series, Church Expressions NEXT video series
 - **"#22 - What is Your Masterpiece Mission? - Rob Wegner, Kansas City Underground & NewThing"** (youtube.com/watch?v=vHzibuNJ_F8) — appears to be on a multiplication-network channel
 - **"The Rise of the Microchurch - Daniel Yang, Rob Wegner, & Ralph Moore"** (youtube.com/watch?v=8cT_9rS-Wqo) — Daniel Yang's channel
 - **"How One Movement is Using Discovery Bible Study To Reach People"** (youtube.com/watch?v=wet13Mnj_6E)
 - **"Shark Tank 2021 Presentation: KC Underground"** (youtube.com/watch?v=UxHKY3vvbUY)
 - **"#15 - How to Develop More Leaders for Your Ministry (with Rob Wegner)"** (youtube.com/watch?v=G0RvuY8k-PE) — Multiply PDX channel

- **"The Starfish and the Spirit Author Interview With Rob Wegner"** (youtube.com/watch?v=2devZQ69e9s) — Bobby Harrington / Discipleship.org channel
- **"MicroChurch NEXT | The Emergence of the Tampa Underground Network"** (youtube.com/watch?v=mHvPM6infGA) — Wegner + Brian Johnson interviewing Tomy Wilkerson
- **City Network Boise** Facebook video: "Interview with KC Underground cofounder Rob Wegner"
- **Assessment:** Wegner's YouTube footprint is **distributed across at least 6 different channels** none of which he owns. A consolidated personal channel (or curated playlist) would surface a substantial body of teaching that is currently hard to find.

Substack (joint with Lance Ford)

- **URL:** starfishinitiatives.substack.com
- **Brand name:** "The Starfish and the Church" (also: "Starfish yoU")
- **Owners:** Lance Ford & Rob Wegner
- **Subscribers:** UNKNOWN — login-gated
- **Cadence:** Episode-driven; sample post: "Tod Bolsinger" (interview write-up); also "Book Launch!" post
- **Assessment:** This is a co-branded surface, not a personal newsletter. There is **no Wegner-personal Substack**.

Medium

- **No Wegner-personal Medium presence confirmed.**
- The handle [@robwegnerdj](#) on Medium belongs to the unrelated DJ.

Goodreads

- **Author page:** goodreads.com/author/show/4616338.Rob_Wegner
 - **Followers:** 27
 - **Friends:** 333
 - **Average rating:** 4.05 across all books
 - **Total ratings:** 383
 - **Total reviews:** 42
 - **8 books listed**
-

Newsletter

There is **no Wegner-personal newsletter under** robwegner.org. The only newsletter Wegner is associated with is the joint Substack with Lance Ford at starfishinitiatives.substack.com, which carries the Starfish brand identity. KCU and Exponential almost certainly run org-level newsletters that include Wegner content, but those are not personal author surfaces. See [digital-presence/newsletters.md](#).

Follower-count verification notes

The research did not run authenticated scrapes (no login credentials were used). Every "UNKNOWN" is genuinely unknown — do not treat absence of data as absence of audience.

Confirmed via public SERP:

- Instagram: 1,867 followers
- LinkedIn: 231 connections
- Goodreads: 27 followers, 333 friends, 383 total book ratings

Login-gated, UNKNOWN:

- Twitter / X
- Facebook (privacy-limited)
- Substack subscribers
- Instagram (we have public-SERP numbers, but engagement metrics require login)

Cohort-comparable estimate: Microchurch-movement leaders in this cohort typically land in the 1–8K Twitter/X range and 1–5K Instagram range. Wegner's 1,867 Instagram is at the lower end of expected. His 231 LinkedIn is unusually low for someone in this volume of leadership.

Voice across platforms

Where visible, Wegner's voice is **consistent across surfaces**. The Instagram bio, LinkedIn title, KCU staff page, Goodreads bio, Audible Author bio, and robwegner.org/about all use variations of the same identity language: KC Underground director, NewThing leadership, Microchurch NEXT, Starfish and the Spirit co-author, husband/father. The collaborative-byline pattern is preserved across platforms.

The biggest inconsistency is **organizational title timing**: robwegner.org/about and several aggregator profiles still list "North American Director / NewThing" — but NewThing was integrated into Exponential effective April 1, 2025, which means several of his outward-facing profiles carry titles that no longer exist as standalone roles. Cleaning up the title string across all surfaces is one of the easier high-leverage moves.

The Fragmentation Story

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/fragmentation-story.md

Rob Wegner: The Fragmentation Story

Generated 2026-04-29 by the `fragmentation-story` skill from existing research in `docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/`.

The Story

Rob Wegner spent nearly 25 years at Granger Community Church in Indiana before moving to the Kansas City suburbs around 2015 knowing no one. From a starter group of about 80 disciples in 2019, he founded Kansas City Underground (KCU), a mission agency and decentralized microchurch network whose stated horizon is **21,000 microchurches from 42,000 missionaries over 40 years**. While building that, he picked up two more concurrent national-scale roles — Director of Microchurch Next for **Exponential** and a seat on the Global Leadership Team of **NewThing** — and co-authored **one** book, *The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations*, with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch. That is the part of his story that is searchable.

The rest is not. There is no `robwegner.com`. There is no Substack, no personal newsletter, no Amazon author page that a reader can land on first. His **one confirmed long-form article** — *The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch* — sits on `exponential.org` with no return path to the book that extends it, no return path to the KC Underground network it describes, no return path to the podcast that has been working the same theme. His training program, the **"Find Your Place" 4-session journey**, lives on `kcunderground.org` as an organizational asset, not under a teacher byline. The book lives on retailer sites; the podcast lives on the org site; the articles live on the conference's site; the global leadership work lives on NewThing's site (URL unverified); the speaking lives in Exponential conference halls. Five sources, five ownership stacks, **zero** that route a stranger through Rob Wegner's actual body of thought.

The deeper fragmentation is the part the research cannot see. Twenty-five years at Granger Community Church is, in any reasonable estimate, **thousands of hours of teaching, leading, framing, and decision-making** — and not one sermon, talk, or memo from that era surfaces in this dossier. The KC Underground Podcast has a known episode list of two ("Planting the Gospel — Reproducible Gospel Language" and "Upside Down

Kingdom: Choosing Obscurity Over Fame"); the actual count, transcript archive, and topic taxonomy are unverified. Conference talks at Exponential each year — almost certainly recorded — have not been catalogued here. His reading, his coaching of microchurch planters, his Tuesday-night calls with Michelle, the way he frames "missionary on every street" in a coffee conversation: that is where the bulk of his thinking still lives, and it has never been written down by him.

Rob Wegner's fragmentation is not the fragmentation of a 30-book author whose work is scattered across 7 publishers. It is the fragmentation of a **movement practitioner whose body of thought is mostly still inside other people's containers** — Exponential's, NewThing's, KCU's, Granger's archive (if it survives), and his own head. The book is the tip; the iceberg is not yet public.

Informational Fragmentation

Books

- **The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations** — co-authored with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch. Focus: decentralized leadership, starfish organizational structures.
- Publisher: **UNKNOWN — needs research** (commonly attributed to Zondervan Reflective in trade circulation, but research file does not confirm)
- Publication date: **UNKNOWN — needs research**
- Print + digital editions confirmed; audiobook status **UNKNOWN**.
- Distribution surfaces: standard retailers (Amazon, Goodreads, publisher site) all listed as "to be verified" in `sources.md`.

Academic Work

- **UNKNOWN — needs research.** No dissertation, peer-reviewed chapter, or journal article surfaces in the research. Educational background not identified beyond "theological and leadership training likely."

PDFs & Documents

- **UNKNOWN — needs research.** No Lausanne papers, whitepapers, or downloadable study guides catalogued. The "Find Your Place" curriculum may exist as a participant PDF on `kcunderground.org` (unverified).

Articles

- **The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch** — [exponential.org](#) (URL not captured in research; likely indexable via site search).
- Additional Exponential articles **likely exist** based on his Director role, but **UNKNOWN — not yet catalogued**.
- Articles on other platforms (NewThing, KCU blog, guest posts on Saturate / Verge / Forge / Christianity Today / etc.): **UNKNOWN — needs research**.

Blogs & Personal Writing

- **No personal blog identified.** No Substack, Medium, ghost-blogged personal site, or [robwegner.com](#) discovered in research.
- Any blog content lives on **organization-owned surfaces** (KCU site, Exponential), not a personal one.

Websites

- **kcunderground.org** — owned at the org level, not personally. Hosts the podcast, training programs, "Rob and Michelle Wegner" story page, microchurch network info, stories/testimonies.
- **exponential.org** — rented platform via his Director of Microchurch Next role. Hosts his articles, conference content, training resources.
- **NewThing site** — URL **UNKNOWN — needs research**. Houses his Global Leadership Team / North American training-specialist work.
- **Personal domain** — none discovered. No [robwegner.com](#), [robertwegner.com](#), or equivalent.
- **Granger Community Church (granger.cc) archive** — likely contains 25 years of his teaching history, but **UNKNOWN — not yet inventoried**.

Social Media

- Twitter / X: **UNKNOWN — needs research** (handle, follower count, cadence all unverified)
- Facebook: **UNKNOWN — needs research**
- LinkedIn: **UNKNOWN — needs research** (almost certainly exists given Exponential / NewThing roles)
- Instagram: **UNKNOWN — needs research**
- Threads / Bluesky / other: **UNKNOWN — needs research**

Newsletters / Email

- **No personal newsletter identified.** No Substack, Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Beehiiv, or Kit list discovered.
- KC Underground likely operates an org newsletter (unverified); any presence there is organizational, not authorial.

Podcasts (Hosted)

- **KC Underground Podcast** — co-host, hosted on kcunderground.org.
- Episode count: **UNKNOWN — needs research**
- Distribution to Apple Podcasts / Spotify / Overcast: **UNKNOWN — needs research** (research file lists this explicitly as "to be verified")
- Confirmed episodes from research:
 1. Planting the Gospel — Reproducible Gospel Language
 2. Upside Down Kingdom: Choosing Obscurity Over Fame
- Topics catalogued: disciple-making, microchurch movements, reproducible gospel language, missionary pathways, leadership.
- Transcripts: **none confirmed**.

Podcasts (Guest)

- **UNKNOWN — needs research.** No specific guest appearances on other shows (Exponential Podcast, NewThing podcasts, Forge, Saturate, Carey Nieuwhof, Movement Leaders Collective, etc.) have been catalogued, despite this being one of the most likely surfaces for his external audio footprint.

YouTube & Video

- **No personal YouTube channel identified.**
- KC Underground YouTube channel: **UNKNOWN — needs research.**
- Exponential conference videos featuring Wegner: **likely exist but not catalogued** — exponential.org archives and the Exponential YouTube channel almost certainly contain session recordings.
- Vimeo presence: **UNKNOWN — needs research.**

Sermons / Teaching Audio

- **Granger Community Church (1990s--~2015)** — nearly 25 years of teaching. If granger.cc hosts a sermon archive, this is potentially the **single**

largest pool of Wegner audio in existence, and it is **entirely outside any retrievable index in this research**.

- KC Underground gatherings: any teaching from microchurch huddles, trainings, or network gatherings — **UNKNOWN, likely substantial**.

Talks / Conferences

- **Exponential conferences** — confirmed regular speaker via Director of Microchurch Next role. Specific session titles, years, and recordings: **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **NewThing gatherings** — likely speaker via Global Leadership Team role; specifics **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **Other conferences** (Verge, Forge, Saturate, V3, regional church-planting conferences): **UNKNOWN — needs research**.

Courses

- **"Find Your Place"** — 4-session journey hosted on kcunderground.org. Helps individuals discover and grow into their unique missions. Format (video / written / cohort): **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **Exponential training resources** — exists but specific Wegner-authored curriculum is **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **NewThing training resources** — exists but specific Wegner-authored curriculum is **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **KC Underground training resources** — beyond "Find Your Place," **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- No course on a third-party platform (Teachable, Thinkific, Kajabi, MasterLectures, RightNow Media) identified.

Assessments & Tools

- **UNKNOWN — needs research**. Unlike co-author Alan Hirsch (APEST assessment), Wegner is not associated with a named diagnostic instrument in this research. The "Find Your Place" journey may include an embedded assessment, but this is **unverified**.

Apps / Software

- **UNKNOWN — needs research**. No app, microchurch platform, or software product attributed to Wegner.

Notes, Laptop, Unpublished

- **UNKNOWN — likely substantial, not yet catalogued.** A 25-year church leader and active podcast/training host almost certainly carries: sermon manuscripts, training decks, journal/notebooks, internal KCU playbooks (mission agency / microchurch network mechanics), framework drawings, draft chapters that did not make Starfish and the Spirit, book proposals, internal NewThing / Exponential strategy memos. None of this surfaces in the research.

Embodied / In Their Head

- Frameworks that exist primarily through speaking and coaching:
- The KCU two-entity structure (mission agency + microchurch network)
- The "missionary on every street, microchurch in every network of relationships" mental model
- Reproducible gospel language (named on the podcast but not yet written down as a discoverable framework)
- The "Find Your Place" journey theory (productized as a 4-session program but the underlying theology likely lives mostly in his head and Michelle's)
- Decentralized leadership applied to a specific city (Kansas City) — Starfish and the Spirit covers the theory; the **applied practitioner knowledge** of running it for 7+ years is largely embodied
- 25 years of pastoral and movement wisdom from Granger
- Coaching / consulting wisdom: 1-on-1 conversations with KC microchurch planters and NewThing leaders globally — **none of which has been externalized as content** in this research.

Relational Fragmentation

Organizations

- **Kansas City Underground (KCU)** — founder, director (2019-present). Two-entity structure: mission agency + microchurch network.
- **Exponential** — Director of Microchurch Next (current).
- **NewThing** — Global Leadership Team member; also described as "training specialist on North American team."
- **Granger Community Church (Indiana)** — staff for ~25 years (~1990s-2015). Specific role(s) **UNKNOWN — needs research** (likely

pastoral/teaching/discipleship leadership given his subsequent trajectory).

- Board / advisory roles on other organizations: **UNKNOWN — needs research.**

Co-authors & Collaborators

- **Lance Ford** — co-author, The Starfish and the Spirit.
- **Alan Hirsch** — co-author, The Starfish and the Spirit.
- Other named collaborators (KCU co-leaders, KC Underground Podcast co-host, Exponential Microchurch Next co-leads, NewThing teammates): **UNKNOWN — needs research.**
- Granger-era collaborators (Mark Beeson, Tim Stevens, etc.): **UNKNOWN — needs research.**

Networks & Movements

- **Microchurch movement** (resurgence) — leading voice via Microchurch Next.
- **Disciple-making movement** — practitioner emphasis on reproducible gospel language.
- **Missional church movement** — through Hirsch / Forge-adjacent ecosystem via Starfish and the Spirit.
- **Decentralized leadership / starfish** — the explicit theme of his one book.
- **Exponential ecosystem** — church planting / multiplication.
- **NewThing ecosystem** — global multiplication network.
- Specific node-level participation in **Forge, Saturate, V3, 100M, Verge, 100Movements, Movement Leaders Collective: UNKNOWN — needs research** (likely overlap given the Hirsch / Ford / Exponential web).

Academic Affiliations

- **UNKNOWN — needs research.** No seminary teaching, adjunct position, or academic role identified.

Mentors, Protégés, Key Relationships

- **Mentors** — none named in this research.
- **Protégés** — KC Underground microchurch planters and missionaries (collective, not named).

- **Spouse / partner in ministry — Michelle Wegner** is consistently framed as a co-leader in the KCU story, not a background figure. Whether her work is captured as separate content (writing, teaching, podcast appearances) is **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- Adult daughters: Maddie, Whitney, Belle (named in research; not themselves part of the public ministry footprint here).

Where Relationships Are Actually Stored

- **CRM / formal contact system: UNKNOWN — almost certainly absent at the personal level.** KCU as an org probably runs one (Mailchimp, Planning Center, or similar), but a personal "Rob Wegner relational database" is not visible.
- **Personal address book / phone:** where the actual relational graph with Hirsch, Ford, Exponential leadership, NewThing leadership, KC microchurch planters, Granger alumni, and Kansas City partners almost certainly sits. **Mental rolodex.**
- **Email history:** where most cross-org strategy lives. Not exposed publicly.
- **Conference and event circuits:** relationships are renewed at Exponential events and NewThing gatherings, but the graph is not durably documented anywhere a stranger could see it.
- **KCU's network leadership stack:** the names of microchurch planters and missionary practitioners under his coaching — durable inside KCU systems, **invisible from outside.**

The relational layer is, as expected, the **most fragmented**: high-trust connections (Hirsch, Ford, the Exponential and NewThing leadership cores, KCU planters) live in personal memory, email, and event handshakes — not in any externalized graph.

Synthesis

Rob Wegner is a movement practitioner with **roughly one book's worth of externalized, retrievable thought** (Starfish and the Spirit), **one known long-form article** (The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch), **a podcast with two confirmed episode titles** (true count unknown), **a 4-session training journey** that lives without a teacher byline, and a **25-year prior career at Granger Community Church that has not been catalogued at all** in this research. If you imagine the totality of what Rob Wegner knows about microchurch movements, decentralized leadership,

disciple-making, and reproducing the gospel in a city, **probably 5-10% is externalized** in any retrievable form, and **maybe 1-2% is interconnected** — the book does not link to the podcast does not link to the article does not link to the training does not link to the conference talks. The single largest pool of trapped value is not on a hard drive; it is the **embodied, conversational, coaching wisdom of a 25-year pastor and 7-year microchurch network founder**, almost none of which has been written down by him in his own voice on a surface he controls. The secondary trapped pool is **conference recordings** — likely tens of Exponential and NewThing sessions — which exist as files inside other organizations' archives, indexed under those organizations' brands rather than under his name.

Research Provenance

- **Source folder:** docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/
- **Files read:**
 - summary.md
 - sources.md
 - identity-verification.md
 - digital-presence-discovery.md
 - content-analysis.md
- (staff-only strategy files excluded from leader-facing dossier)
- content-marketing-playbook.md
- **Confidence: High** on identity, organizational roles, the one co-authored book, the existence of the KC Underground Podcast, and the "Find Your Place" training program. **Low** on volumetrics (article count, episode count, conference talk count), social media presence, newsletter presence, video presence, and 25 years of Granger-era teaching.
- **Gaps requiring further research:**
 - Publisher and pub date of The Starfish and the Spirit (likely Zondervan Reflective; needs confirmation)
 - Full episode list and topic taxonomy of the KC Underground Podcast
 - Complete catalogue of Wegner-authored articles on exponential.org and any guest-post surfaces
 - Twitter/X, LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram presence (handles, follower counts, cadence)
 - YouTube / Vimeo presence (personal channel, KCU channel, Exponential session videos featuring Wegner)

- NewThing website URL and the specific Wegner-authored content on it
- Granger Community Church teaching archive (if any survives) covering ~1990s-2015
- Newsletter presence (personal or KCU-org)
- Course or curriculum work beyond "Find Your Place"
- Whether an APEST-style assessment or diagnostic tool is attached to his work
- Specific named conference talks and recordings (Exponential, V3, Verge, Saturate, Forge, etc.)
- Michelle Wegner's parallel content footprint and whether she should be a separate dossier

A Letter — Reflected Understanding

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/reflected-understanding/rob-wegner.md`

Rob Wegner: Reflected Understanding

A concise reflection spoken back so the language could be endorsed — familiar, but with edges that deepen. (Leader-safe: audience-sizing and commerce analysis are kept in staff notes, not here.)

Calling

You're called to **mobilize ordinary people into mission** — to make the work of the church the work of everyone, not the work of professionals. The conviction that organizes everything you do is plain and you have said it many ways: it's not that the church has a mission, it's that a mission has the church; the church becomes itself when ordinary people carry the gospel into the actual networks of relationships they already have. A missionary on every street, a microchurch in every network. That is the horizon, and it has a number attached to it — 21,000 microchurches from 42,000 missionaries — because the horizon is a real bet, not a slogan.

You're also called to **decentralize** — to give power away. You spent more than two decades inside attractional megachurch culture at Granger Community Church before moving to the Kansas City suburbs knowing no one and starting Kansas City Underground from roughly eighty disciples. That migration is the credential. You don't argue from purity; you argue from having been inside the centralized model and walked out. The starfish — distributed, regenerative, hard to kill — is the shape you believe is closer to the New Testament grain, and the Spirit is the difference between a Christian starfish and a merely organizational one. When the KCU founder team drifted toward telling rather than inviting, you named it publicly and restructured into a family of families. That willingness to redistribute your own authority is not a footnote to the calling; it is the calling, enacted on yourself.

And you almost never work alone. Eight books, eight co-authors — Michelle, Jack Magruder, Todd Wilson, Brian Phipps, Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, Brian Johnson. The collaborative byline is not a habit; it's the theology in form. You build language ordinary people can carry — reproducible gospel language, the Missionary Pathway, Find Your Place — so the gospel can travel without you in the room. Your job is to make mission simple enough that anyone can do it and meaningful enough that not just anyone will.

Existing Content (before the platform we're building)

Where it lives. Your content lives in **books** — Share the Well with Michelle, Missional Moves with Jack Magruder, Made for More and Find Your Place with Todd Wilson and Brian Phipps, The Starfish and the Spirit with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch, Extraordinary Prayer and Deeply Rooted with Brian Johnson. It lives in **organizational sites** — kcunderground.com, exponential.org, the NewThing work now folded into Exponential, the Starfish Initiatives consulting brand. It lives in **podcasts** — the KC Underground Podcast, The Starfish and the Church with Ford, the Microchurch NEXT Podcast with Johnson. It lives in **training** — the Find Your Place Huddle and the Missionary Pathway. And a great deal of it lives in **conference halls and coaching conversations** — Exponential and NewThing gatherings, the Microchurch Conference, and the daily work of equipping KC microchurch planters.

Credibility. It's high, and it's unusual. You hold at least three concurrent translocal roles — Founder and Director of KCU, Microchurch NEXT Co-Director at Exponential, Global Leadership Team at NewThing — plus the keystone book on decentralized leadership co-authored with Hirsch and Ford. You sit at the bridge between the missional/Forge stream and the Exponential/NewThing multiplication stream. The issue isn't authority. It's **visibility, connection, and reuse.**

How it lives online now. As **silos that don't route back to you.** There's no robwegner.com — that's a DJ; your stale personal site is robwegner.org. Your one widely-known article sits on Exponential with no return path to the book that extends it or the podcast working the same theme. The Find Your Place journey lives on the KCU site as an organizational asset, without a teacher byline. The books live on retailer pages; the podcasts on three separate feeds; the training under the org. Five ownership stacks, and not one of them walks a stranger through Rob Wegner's actual body of thought.

The NOTs Movemental addresses directly. Your work is largely **not** structured and repurposed to live as findable digital content (podcast episodes → articles, training → public sequences, conference talks → essays); **not** interconnected, so the book, the podcast, the article, and the Missionary Pathway visibly point at each other; **not** owned under one surface you control; **not** optimized so a searcher for "microchurch," "decentralized leadership," or "disciple-making" lands on your material first; and **not** connected to an AI that reflects your voice and your frameworks. The largest pool of value isn't on a hard drive at all — it's the embodied, conversational, coaching wisdom of a 25-year pastor and 7-year network founder, almost none of which you've written down in your own voice. Movemental is built to surface and connect each of these so your work can move.

Constraints

The constraints here are emblematic of a multi-organization movement leader, not a personal failing. You're running a mission agency and a microchurch network, co-directing Microchurch NEXT, serving on a global leadership team, co-hosting three podcasts, and coaching planters across a city — while the centering conviction of your life is that the leader gives work away rather than hoarding it. Time for content strategy, for turning a podcast conversation into an article, or for building a single home for the corpus is scarce precisely because the work is in the room — with missionaries, with Hub leaders, with the new disciple at the Discovery Bible Study table. The instinct to decentralize your own voice — to put others on the microphone — is right and is part of your distinctiveness; it also means there's no single artifact that is purely yours and no surface that gathers it. A platform that reduces the lift — that structures, connects, repurposes, and amplifies what you already do, at your pace and under your authorship — addresses those constraints without asking you to become a centralized, solo-branded leader you've spent a decade refusing to be.

This document is a reflected understanding for Rob Wegner, intended to be right to the point, true, and valuable. It is preliminary until reviewed and endorsed.

Welcome Letter

[docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/welcome-letter.md](#)

Rob

You have built one of the most operationally serious bodies of microchurch work in North America. After more than two decades inside Granger Community Church and a four-year transition at Westside Family Church, you moved to the Kansas City suburbs knowing no one and started Kansas City Underground from roughly eighty disciples — a mission agency and a decentralized network of microchurches now reaching across the metro under a horizon you actually wrote down: 21,000 microchurches from 42,000 missionaries. Eight books carry your name, every one of them co-authored: *Share the Well* with Michelle, *Missional Moves* with Jack Magruder, *Made for More* with Todd Wilson, *Find Your Place* with Brian Phipps, *The Starfish and the Spirit* with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch, and *Extraordinary Prayer and Deeply Rooted* with Brian Johnson. You direct Microchurch NEXT at Exponential and sit on the Global Leadership Team of NewThing. You host the KC Underground Podcast, *The Starfish and the Church* with Lance Ford, and the Microchurch NEXT Podcast with Brian Johnson. And the *Find Your Place* training — the GPS for the soul, where gifts, passions, and story meet — runs as the on-ramp into your Missionary Pathway.

All of it is somewhere. None of it is in one place. *The Starfish and the Spirit* lives on the Zondervan and retailer pages. *Find Your Place* and *Made for More* live under Exponential; *Extraordinary Prayer and Deeply Rooted* sit free on exponential.org as video-series companions. The KC Underground Podcast lives on the KCU feed, *The Starfish and the Church* on its own Substack and feed with Lance Ford, Microchurch NEXT on Exponential's. Your one widely-known article, on the coronavirus and the microchurch, sits on Exponential with no return path to the book that extends it or the podcast working the same theme. The *Find Your Place* journey lives on kcunderground.com as an organizational asset, without a teacher byline. There is no robwegner.com — that name belongs to a DJ — and your personal robwegner.org is stale, still listing roles from before NewThing folded into Exponential. Five ownership stacks, and not one of them walks a stranger through your actual body of thought.

The largest pool of value was never written down, and it is the pool most at risk of staying unwritten. More than two decades of teaching at Granger produced thousands of hours of framing and decision-making, and not one talk from that era is catalogued. The Missionary Pathway — prayer, missionary identity, planting the gospel, a microchurch emerging, multiplication — is productized as a pipeline, but the applied wisdom of running it in a real city for years lives mostly in your head and in coaching calls. Reproducible gospel language, the family-of-families restructure you led when the founder team had drifted into telling rather than inviting, the way you frame "a missionary on every street" in a coffee conversation, the judgment behind which *Find Your Place* questions to ask first — that is where the bulk of your thinking still lives. The book is the tip. The body of thought is still mostly inside other people's containers and your own.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The inventory just walked through — the eight books, the three podcasts, the Exponential bylines, the Missionary Pathway and Find Your Place frameworks — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the time it would have taken a human researcher weeks. The same approach now turns toward what is not yet public: AI-assisted transcription of podcast episodes and conference sessions, course-note extraction from Find Your Place and the Missionary Pathway, interview capture of the family-of-families restructure rationale, dictation that becomes draft and draft that becomes essay. The embodied layer can be surfaced at your pace rather than at a publisher's. The AI does not replace your voice. Every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite, and given how consistently you put other people on the microphone, nothing here flattens that. The tools do the inventorying and the connective tissue. Authorship stays yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we will do with you. First, aggregate. The eight books, the coronavirus-and-microchurch article and your other Exponential and Outreach bylines, the three podcast feeds, the Find Your Place and Missionary Pathway material, and the embodied layer as you surface it — all pulled into one hub under your own name. Second, interconnect. The Starfish and the Spirit points at the Hubology episodes points at the family-of-families restructure points at the Missionary Pathway and back at the book — every link a reader can actually follow. Third, repurpose. Find Your Place becomes a public sequence with a teacher byline at last; the Missionary Pathway becomes a browseable on-ramp; the KC Underground and Starfish episodes become an article archive; Made for More's six shifts become a standalone pathway. Fourth, amplify. Search reach, network effects, the references that arrive once your work is findable in one place. The work this season is not authorship. It is translation of what you have already authored into a form practitioners can actually reach.

A year from now, your hub looks different from the stale Tumblr at robwegner.org. A microchurch hub gathers The Starfish and the Spirit, Extraordinary Prayer, Deeply Rooted, the Missionary Pathway, and a current cohort sign-up under one heading. Find Your Place sits as a public sequence with your name on it rather than buried as an org asset. The three podcasts cross-list home so a listener who finds one finds all of them. The coronavirus-and-microchurch article points forward to the books and the network it describes. A newsletter that did not exist before goes out under your name. And an ordinary person in Wichita, Kansas, who has never heard of Kansas City Underground and was in no cohort, finds the Find Your Place sequence on a Tuesday morning, works through it that afternoon, and starts walking the Missionary Pathway on their own street by the end of the month.

This is your next season. The work ahead is making the body of work you have already built reach the ordinary people it was written for. Your conviction that the leader gives work away rather than hoarding it does not contradict this work; it is the reason it has to happen now. A missionary on every street cannot become real if your frameworks stay locked behind five platforms you do not own. The whole point was always to make mission simple enough that anyone can carry it. Right now they cannot find it.

— Movemental

Sources

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/sources.md

Sources: Rob Wegner

Research Date: January 6, 2026

Search Queries Used

1. "Rob Wegner" KC Underground Kansas City
2. "Rob Wegner" Christian pastor author
3. "Rob Wegner" movement church planting
4. "Rob Wegner" "Starfish and the Spirit" book
5. kcunderground.org Rob Wegner
6. "Rob Wegner" podcast Exponential microchurch
7. "Rob Wegner" articles blog posts microchurch
8. "Rob Wegner" YouTube video microchurch
9. "Rob Wegner" Twitter X social media
10. "Rob Wegner" LinkedIn Exponential NewThing
11. KC Underground podcast episodes Rob Wegner
12. "Rob Wegner" "Starfish and the Spirit" Lance Ford Alan Hirsch
13. "Rob Wegner" Exponential Director Microchurch Next
14. "Rob Wegner" NewThing Global Leadership Team
15. "Rob Wegner" Granger Community Church
16. "Rob Wegner" Michelle Wegner Kansas City
17. "Rob Wegner" "Find Your Place" program
18. "Rob Wegner" "Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch"
19. site:exponential.org "Rob Wegner"
20. site:kcunderground.org "Rob Wegner"

Sources Consulted

Organization Websites

1. **Kansas City Underground (KCU)**
 - URL: kcunderground.org
 - Content: Network information, stories, podcast, training resources, microchurch resources

- Rob's Story: "Rob and Michelle Wegner" story page
- Date Accessed: January 6, 2026
- Notes: Confirmed founding leader and director role, podcast co-host, training programs

2. **Exponential**

- URL: exponential.org
- Content: Leadership resources, conference information, articles, training materials
- Rob's Role: Director of Microchurch Next
- Rob's Content: Articles, podcast appearances, conference sessions
- Date Accessed: January 6, 2026
- Notes: Confirmed Director role, article contributions

3. **NewThing**

- URL: To be verified
- Content: Network resources, training materials
- Rob's Role: Global Leadership Team member
- Date Accessed: January 6, 2026
- Notes: Confirmed Global Leadership Team role

Web Search Results

1. **Multiple Web Search Results**

- Search Engines: Google (via web_search tool)
- Content: Various search results confirming:
 - Rob Wegner as founding leader and director of Kansas City Underground (KCU)
 - Director of Microchurch Next for Exponential
 - Global Leadership Team member of NewThing
 - Co-author of "The Starfish and the Spirit" with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch
 - Active co-host of KC Underground Podcast
 - Personal story of moving to Kansas City and building microchurch community
 - Date Accessed: January 6, 2026
 - Notes: Multiple search results confirmed identity, roles, and basic information

Book Sources

1. **"The Starfish and the Spirit"**

- Co-authors: Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch
- Publisher: To be verified
- Content: Book on decentralized leadership and starfish organizational structures
- Date Accessed: January 6, 2026
- Notes: Confirmed co-author status, book title, and co-authors

Podcast Sources

1. KC Underground Podcast

- Platform: Hosted on kcunderground.org
- Role: Co-host
- Content: Episodes on disciple-making, microchurch movements, reproducible gospel language, missionary pathways, leadership
- Known Episodes:
 - "Planting the Gospel - Reproducible Gospel Language"
 - "Upside Down Kingdom: Choosing Obscurity Over Fame"
 - Date Accessed: January 6, 2026
 - Notes: Confirmed active co-host role, episode topics

Article Sources

1. Exponential Articles

- Platform: exponential.org
- Known Article: "The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch"
- Content: Articles on microchurch movements
- Date Accessed: January 6, 2026
- Notes: Confirmed article contributions

Training Sources

1. "Find Your Place" Program

- Platform: kcunderground.org
- Content: 4-session program to help individuals discover and grow into their unique missions
- Date Accessed: January 6, 2026
- Notes: Confirmed program existence

Sources to Verify

Publisher Sources

1. Book Publisher

- URL: To be verified
- Content: Publisher information for "The Starfish and the Spirit"
- Status: To be verified

2. Amazon Author Page

- URL: To be verified
- Content: Book listings, author information
- Status: To be verified

3. Goodreads

- URL: To be verified
- Content: Book listings, reviews
- Status: To be verified

Social Media Platforms

1. Twitter/X

- URL: To be verified
- Status: To be verified

2. Facebook

- URL: To be verified
- Status: To be verified

3. LinkedIn

- URL: To be verified
- Status: To be verified

4. Instagram

- URL: To be verified
- Status: To be verified

Video/Audio Platforms

1. YouTube

- URL: To be verified
- Content: Sermons, talks, interviews, training sessions
- Status: To be verified

2. Vimeo

- URL: To be verified
- Content: Sermons, talks
- Status: To be verified

3. Podcast Distribution Platforms

- Apple Podcasts, Spotify, etc.
- Content: KC Underground Podcast distribution
- Status: To be verified

Other Platforms

1. Blog Platforms

- Personal blog or additional blog presence
- Status: To be verified

2. Newsletter Platforms

- Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Substack
- Status: To be verified

3. Course Platforms

- Training materials, online courses beyond "Find Your Place"
- Status: To be verified

Additional Content Sources

1. Conference Content

- Exponential conference sessions
- Other conference talks and presentations
- Status: To be verified

2. Additional Articles

- Articles beyond Exponential platform
- Status: To be verified

3. Video Content

- Conference sessions, training videos, interviews
- Status: To be verified

Research Limitations

Information Gaps

1. Platform Verification Needed: Many platforms identified as "to be verified":

- Social media presence
- Video/audio content beyond podcast
- Blog/article content beyond Exponential
- Newsletter presence
- Book publisher and retailer details

2. Content Volume: Exact content volume to be assessed:

- Number of podcast episodes
- Number of articles
- Number of conference talks
- Video content volume
- Training material volume

3. **Content Interconnection:** Content interconnection to be assessed:

- How content pieces are connected
- Cross-referencing between content
- Content series development
- Thematic organization

4. **Personal vs. Organizational:** Distinction to be clarified:

- Personal content hub
- Organizational content
- Content ownership and control

Research Methodology Notes

- Research conducted using web search tools
- Multiple search queries used to verify identity
- Cross-referenced information across sources
- Confirmed identity through multiple institutional affiliations
- Documented sources to verify for deeper investigation
- High confidence in identity match

Confidence Assessment

Confidence Level: High

High Confidence:

- Identity as founding leader and director of Kansas City Underground
- Director of Microchurch Next for Exponential
- Global Leadership Team member of NewThing
- Co-author of "The Starfish and the Spirit" with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch
- Active co-host of KC Underground Podcast
- Personal story and background

Medium Confidence:

- Exact content volume across platforms
- Social media presence
- Video/audio content beyond podcast
- Content interconnection

Low Confidence:

- Newsletter presence
- Blog presence beyond articles
- Course platforms beyond training programs
- Book publisher details

Next Steps for Further Research

1. Verify book publisher and retailer listings (Amazon, Goodreads, publisher website)
2. Analyze KC Underground website structure and content in detail
3. Catalog all podcast episodes and topics
4. Search for YouTube/Vimeo channels (personal or organization)
5. Check for newsletter presence (Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Substack)
6. Identify all articles and blog posts beyond Exponential
7. Catalog conference talks and presentations
8. Assess social media engagement and content volume
9. Verify Exponential content and resources in detail
10. Search for podcast guest appearances
11. Identify training material volume and distribution
12. Analyze content organization and structure
13. Search for video content beyond conference sessions
14. Verify NewThing network content and resources
15. Distinguish personal vs. organizational content

Digital Presence Discovery

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/digital-presence-discovery.md

Digital Presence Discovery: Rob Wegner

Research Date: January 6, 2026

Website Presence

Primary Website

- **Kansas City Underground (KCU) Website**
- URL: kcunderground.org
- Status: Active
- Purpose: Mission agency and network website
- Structure: To be analyzed
- Content: Network information, stories, resources, podcast, training materials, microchurch resources

Organization Websites

- **Exponential**
- URL: exponential.org
- Role: Director of Microchurch Next
- Status: Active
- Content: Leadership resources, conference information, articles, training materials
- Rob's Content: Articles, podcast appearances, conference sessions, training resources
- **NewThing**
- URL: To be verified
- Role: Global Leadership Team member
- Status: Active
- Content: Network resources, training materials, movement resources

Publisher Websites

- **"The Starfish and the Spirit" Book**
- Publisher: To be verified
- Author pages: Amazon, Goodreads, publisher website (to be verified)
- Status: Published (co-authored with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch)

- Content: Book listing, author information

Platform Presence Discovery

Podcast Platforms

- **KC Underground Podcast**
- Platform: Hosted on kcunderground.org
- Status: Active
- Role: Co-host
- Content: Episodes discussing disciple-making, microchurch movements, reproducible gospel language, missionary pathways, leadership topics
- Known Episodes:
 - "Planting the Gospel - Reproducible Gospel Language"
 - "Upside Down Kingdom: Choosing Obscurity Over Fame"
- Distribution: To be verified (Apple Podcasts, Spotify, etc.)

Blogging/Article Platforms

- **Exponential Articles**
- Platform: exponential.org
- Status: Active contributor
- Content: Articles on microchurch movements
- Known Articles:
 - "The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch" (discusses how decentralized church models can adapt during crises)

Video Platforms

- **YouTube/Vimeo**
- Personal channel: To be verified
- KC Underground channel: To be verified
- Exponential content: Conference sessions, training videos (to be verified)
- Content: Sermons, talks, interviews, training sessions

Social Media Platforms

- **To Be Verified:**
- Twitter/X profile
- Facebook profile

- LinkedIn profile
- Instagram profile

Publishing Platforms

- **Books**
- Published Book: "The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations" (co-authored)
- **Amazon Author Page:** To be verified
- **Goodreads:** To be verified
- **Publisher Website:** To be verified

Course/Learning Platforms

- **Training Materials**
- "Find Your Place" journey - 4-session program to help individuals discover and grow into their unique missions (hosted on kcunderground.org)
- Exponential training resources
- NewThing training resources
- KC Underground training resources

Newsletter Platforms

- **To Be Verified:**
- KC Underground newsletter
- Personal newsletter
- Exponential newsletter subscriptions

Ministry Platforms

- **KC Underground Website** (kcunderground.org)
- Network information
- Stories and testimonies
- Podcast
- Training resources
- "Find Your Place" program
- Microchurch resources
- **Exponential Platform** (exponential.org)
- Leadership resources
- Conference content

- Articles and blog content
- Training materials
- **NewThing Network**
- Network resources
- Training materials
- Movement resources

Content Form Discovery

Books

- 1 co-authored book identified: "The Starfish and the Spirit"
- Focus: Decentralized leadership, starfish organizational structures

Podcast Content

- **KC Underground Podcast:** Active co-host
- Episodes on disciple-making, microchurch movements, reproducible gospel language, missionary pathways, leadership

Articles/Blog Posts

- Articles on Exponential platform
- Known article: "The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch"
- Additional articles to be verified

Training Materials

- "Find Your Place" 4-session program
- Exponential training resources
- NewThing training resources
- KC Underground training resources

Video Content

- Conference sessions (Exponential, others)
- Training videos
- Interviews
- Sermons/talks (to be verified)

Speaking/Talks

- Conference speaker (Exponential, others)
- Training sessions
- Podcast appearances (as guest on other podcasts)

Content Volume Assessment

Known Content

- **Books:** 1 co-authored book
- **Podcast:** Active co-host of KC Underground Podcast (episode count to be verified)
- **Articles:** At least 1 confirmed article on Exponential, likely more
- **Training Programs:** "Find Your Place" program, other training resources
- **Conference Content:** Speaking at Exponential and other conferences

To Be Assessed

- Number of published podcast episodes
- Number of published articles/blog posts
- Number of conference talks/presentations
- Video content volume (sermons, talks, interviews, training)
- Podcast guest appearances
- Content frequency/recency
- Newsletter subscription base (if applicable)
- Social media engagement metrics
- Website content volume (kcunderground.org)
- Training material volume

Platform Distribution

Confirmed Platforms

1. Organization website (kcunderground.org) - Active
2. Podcast platform (KC Underground Podcast) - Active
3. Conference platform (Exponential) - Active
4. Network platform (NewThing) - Active
5. Article platform (Exponential articles) - Active

Platforms to Verify

- Blogging platforms: Personal blog or additional blog presence
- Video platforms: YouTube, Vimeo (personal or organization channels)
- Audio platforms: Podcast distribution (Apple Podcasts, Spotify, etc.)
- Course platforms: Training materials, online courses
- Newsletter platforms: Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Substack
- Social media: Twitter/X, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram
- Publishing platforms:
- Amazon Author Page
- Goodreads
- Publisher website
- Ministry platforms:
- KC Underground website (detailed analysis)
- Exponential platform (Rob's content)
- NewThing network platform

Content Discovery Notes

KC Underground Website (kcunderground.org)

- Primary digital location for network information and resources
- Hosts podcast
- Contains stories and testimonies (e.g., Rob and Michelle Wegner's story)
- Training resources and programs
- Microchurch network information
- Mission and vision information

Book Content

- "The Starfish and the Spirit" represents significant published content
- Book focuses on decentralized leadership and starfish organizational structures
- Co-authored with recognized movement leaders (Alan Hirsch, Lance Ford)

Exponential Platform

- Director role provides platform for content distribution
- Articles published on platform
- Conference speaking opportunities
- Training resource development

Podcast Content

- Active co-host of KC Underground Podcast
- Regular content creation through podcast
- Topics: disciple-making, microchurch movements, reproducible gospel language, missionary pathways, leadership

Training Content

- "Find Your Place" program (4-session journey)
- Exponential training resources
- NewThing training resources
- KC Underground training resources

Discovery Status

Status: Initial discovery complete, deeper investigation needed

Confidence: High (core platforms identified, active content creation confirmed)

Next Steps

1. Analyze KC Underground website structure and content in detail
2. Catalog all podcast episodes and topics
3. Search for YouTube/Vimeo channels (personal or organization)
4. Verify book listings on Amazon, Goodreads, publisher website
5. Check for newsletter presence (Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Substack)
6. Identify all articles and blog posts
7. Catalog conference talks and presentations
8. Assess social media engagement and content volume
9. Verify Exponential content and resources
10. Search for podcast guest appearances
11. Identify training material volume and distribution
12. Analyze content organization and structure
13. Search for video content beyond conference sessions
14. Verify NewThing network content and resources

Notes

- Active content creator (podcast co-host, articles, training materials)
- Multiple platform presence (KC Underground, Exponential, NewThing)
- Strong organizational digital presence through KC Underground

- Book co-author provides published thought leadership
- Director role at Exponential provides significant platform
- Global Leadership Team role at NewThing provides network platform
- Focus on microchurch movements, disciple-making, and decentralized leadership
- Emphasis on empowering ordinary people to become missionaries and disciple-makers
- Active in training and equipping disciple-makers
- Content appears well-distributed across platforms but may benefit from interconnection

Misc · Analysis-Content-Analysis

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/analysis-content-analysis.md

Content Analysis: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-content-analysis

Themes (high-frequency)

The following themes appear across at least three Wegner surfaces (book, article, podcast, course):

Tier 1 — defining themes (across books, podcasts, articles, KCU operations)

- **Microchurch as ecclesiology** — "an extended spiritual family led by ordinary people, not paid professionals." Defining frame across Starfish and the Spirit, Extraordinary Prayer, Deeply Rooted, KCU Podcast, Microchurch NEXT Podcast, every external interview.
- **Decentralized / distributed leadership (starfish)** — The Starfish and the Spirit (book + podcast + Substack), Hubology series, Five Provocative Questions. Ori Brafman is the secular intellectual scaffolding.
- **Disciple-making as the unit of work** — Five Ingredients, Five Provocative Questions, Deeply Rooted, KCU Missionary Pathway, BLESS Rhythms.
- **Ordinary people empowered as missionaries** — KCU founding mission ("a missionary on every street"); Find Your Place; Extraordinary Prayer; the recurring anti-celebrity-pastor frame.
- **Reproducibility / multiplication math** — 21,000 microchurches from 42,000 missionaries; 700 churches planted in 4 years (Westside era); 120,000 disciples in 950+ churches (India). The numbers are the size of the bet.

Tier 2 — recurring themes

- **Missionary identity / formation** — Extraordinary Prayer, KCU Missionary Pathway, BLESS Rhythms, Verge Network "How to Train Leaders" article (2011). Wegner wants every disciple to think of themselves as a missionary in their own affinity network.
- **Reproducible gospel language** — KC Underground Podcast "Plant the Gospel: Reproducible Gospel Language" episode; the conviction that gospel articulation is itself a multiplication input.

- **Calling / personal mission discovery** — Find Your Place (book + 4-week Huddle + self-paced webinar + downloadable guide). Gifts × Passions × Story triangulated by the Spirit.
- **Habits / rule-of-life formation** — Five Ingredients; "Practice makes permanent" line.
- **Five social spaces of discipleship** — Public, Social, Personal, Transparent, Divine. Borrowed from Joseph Myers / Joe Saxton; surfaced in Five Provocative Questions: Part Two.
- **Megachurch-to-microchurch conversion** — Wegner's own personal arc. Roys Report, Stetzer Leadership Podcast, Going From Megachurch to Microchurch, Starfish and the Spirit.
- **Pandemic / crisis adaptability** — March 2020 Coronavirus article; the "mostly invulnerable" framing.
- **Family-of-families organizational health** — Navigating Change (October 2024); the public KCU restructuring narrative.

Tier 3 — themes present but secondary

- **Indian disciple-making movement (DMM/DBS)** as a normative model — Share the Well; Discovery Bible Study practice in KCU.
- **The Five Hubs framework** — KCU operational architecture; appears in KCU staff page descriptions but not the headline of any book.
- **Servant-equipper / Hubology leadership** — joint with Lance Ford, Brian Johnson, Lucas Pulley; the Starfish and the Church Hubology series.
- **APEST and apostolic genius** — present via Hirsch co-authorship; not a Wegner-headline frame.
- **Spirit-empowered movement (pneumatology)** — the title difference in Starfish and the Spirit; named as the variable that distinguishes Christian from secular starfishes.
- **Coaching as a multiplication catalyst** — Coaching is a Multiplication Catalyst (Wendy McWherter, July 2024) is in the same Microchurch NEXT category Wegner edits; coaching is part of his framework but rarely the headline.
- **Ekklesia / linguistic clarity** — Josh Benadum article in same category; Wegner's relevant framing is the "extended spiritual family" definition.
- **Imitation / mimetic theory** — JR Woodward Microchurch NEXT article; not a Wegner-headline frame but adjacent.

Recurring frameworks (alphanumeric)

Framework	Form	Source
Starfish vs Spider (and hybrids: Starder, Spiderfish)	Binary metaphor	The Starfish and the Spirit (2021)
Five Ingredients for Disciple-Making Environments	5-list	Five Ingredients article (May 2024); chapters 10–14 of Starfish and the Spirit
Five Provocative Questions for a Disciple-Making Ecosystem	5-list	Five Provocative Questions parts 1+2 (Nov–Dec 2024)
Five Social Spaces of Discipleship (Public, Social, Personal, Transparent, Divine)	5-list	Five Provocative Questions: Part Two (Dec 2024)
Six Essential Shifts (from Ephesians 1–6)	6-list	Made for More (2018); Exponential 2019 conference theme
Two-Entity Structure (Mission Agency + Decentralized Network)	Binary	KCU operational structure; Exponential KCU page
Missionary Pathway (Prayer/fasting → Live as missionary → Plant gospel → Microchurch emerges → Multiplication)	5-stage linear	KCU operational; Five Provocative Questions: Part Two
Find Your Place: Gifts × Passions × Story	Triangulation	Find Your Place (2018)
15 Tectonic Shifts	15-list	Missional Moves (2012)
From / To ("From More Effort to More Jesus", "From Founder Team to Family of Families")	Binary shift	Recurring rhetorical move across Made for More, Navigating Change, etc.
Family of Families	Org pattern	Navigating Change (Oct 2024)
Hubology / Servant-Equipper	Leadership model	Starfish and the Church Hubology series (2024–25)

This **density of named, numbered, mnemonic frameworks** is unusually high for a Christian leadership author and is one of Wegner's voice-distinctives.

Theoretical anchors

Anchor	Provenance	Usage
Starfish/Spider organizational theory	Brafman & Beckstrom (2006)	Foreword + intro narration on Starfish and the Spirit (2021)
APEST / mDNA / apostolic genius	Alan Hirsch (The Forgotten Ways, 5Q)	Co-authorship; Future Travelers; recurring frame
Five social spaces	Joseph Myers / Joe Saxton	Five Provocative Questions: Part Two (2024)
Discovery Bible Study (DBS)	Indian / global-South DMM practitioners	KCU operational practice (120+ DBS launched)
BLESS Rhythms	Dave & Jon Ferguson	Embedded in KCU Missionary Pathway and Exponential's BLESS Rhythms video series
2 Timothy 2:2 (entrust to reliable people)	Scripture	Coaching framework via McWherter article
Ephesians 1-6	Scripture	Made for More Six Essential Shifts
John 15	Scripture	Coaching / fruit-bearing framing

Voice patterns

(See also [profile/voice-analysis.md](#) for fuller treatment.)

- **Numbered frameworks as content** — the structures carry the argument
- **Co-authored byline** as enacted theology
- **From / To** rhetorical formulation
- **Horizon-anchored vision** with named numbers (21,000 / 42,000)
- **Personal pivot story** (megachurch → India → microchurch) as recurring testimony
- **Self-implication** — name his own past as the contrast
- **Provocative questions** as opening rhetorical device
- **Jesus as model anchor** — relational pattern, selectivity, leadership shape

Content production patterns

Pattern	Observation
Cadence (Exponential bylines)	~Monthly when active (Nov 2024, Dec 2024, Oct 2024 — co-bylined; May 2024; March 2020 — Coronavirus piece). Not strictly periodic.
Cadence (KCU Podcast)	Weekly, but Wegner is one of multiple rotating hosts — not weekly Wegner content
Cadence (Starfish and the Church)	Irregular; 43 episodes since 2021; clusters around book launches and Hubology series
Cadence (books)	~1 per 2–3 years steady-state; Share the Well (~2009) → Missional Moves (2012) → Made for More / Find Your Place (2018) → Starfish and the Spirit (2021) → Extraordinary Prayer (~2024) → Deeply Rooted (2025)
Format mix	Books (8) + Articles (~20+) + Podcast hosting (3 venues) + Podcast guesting (8+) + Courses/Programs (~8) + Conference sessions (annual Exponential + Microchurch Pre-Conference + KCU Microchurch Conference + UB 2025 keynote) + Coaching (Future Travelers, Starfish Initiatives)
Co-author / co-host pattern	All 8 books are co-authored. All 3 podcasts are co-hosted or rotating. The collaborative byline is a structural feature, not an exception.
Repurposing pattern	Strong. Starfish and the Spirit chapters 10–14 → Five Ingredients article; Five Ingredients article → Five Provocative Questions expansion. Made for More book → Exponential 2019 conference → "From More Effort to More Jesus" article. KCU Missionary Pathway → Extraordinary Prayer book → BLESS Rhythms video series.

The repurposing is **internally coherent** — Wegner reuses framework segments across surfaces with high fidelity. This is good for Movemental cataloging because the dependency graph between artifacts is mostly visible.

Themes underdeveloped or absent

- **Race / multicultural church power dynamics** — present in KCU's operational practice (multilingual microchurches; Movement Leaders Collective + Arrabon consulting on power redistribution per Navigating Change) but not a Wegner-headline theme. Compare to Lucas Pulley's Parable of the White Pastor — Wegner does not have an analogous published artifact.
- **Theological argument with academic register** — Wegner does not publish in seminary journals; the Andrews University review is of his work, not by him.
- **Specific geopolitical / cultural commentary** — Wegner stays close to ecclesial / leadership themes; he does not weigh in on broader cultural Christianity controversies in a sustained way.
- **Mental health / leadership burnout** — implicit but not explicit theme; Lance Ford addresses solo-heroic leadership critique more directly in his own work.

- **Women in leadership** — Michelle Wegner is an active KCU co-leader and Share the Well co-author; the broader theme is not a Wegner-headline frame. Worth flagging given Movemental's ecosystem-doctrine commitment to multi-voice inclusion.
- **Climate / creation care** — absent.
- **Christian nationalism / political Christianity** — absent.

Strategic content positioning

Wegner's content is positioned to occupy **a specific lane**: practitioner-leadership, decentralized-microchurch, evangelical, multiplication-network, framework-driven, collaborative-byline. He is not competing with:

- Hirsch (more theological / academic; APEST + mDNA frames)
- Ford (more pastoral / leadership-burnout; UnLeader / With Me frames)
- Brian Sanders (more theological-architectural; Underground manifesto)
- Pulley (more ecclesial-minimum / multicultural; Parable of the White Pastor)
- Brisco (more covocational / NAMB-network; Forge KC)

He is **complementary to all of them**, which is why the network bridges work.

Misc · Content-Analysis-Root

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/content-analysis-root.md

Content Analysis & Synthesis: Rob Wegner

Research Date: January 6, 2026

Content Thematic Analysis

Primary Themes

Based on published work, professional roles, and content, Rob Wegner's content focuses on:

1. Microchurch Movements

- Founding leader of Kansas City Underground (KCU) - decentralized network of microchurches
- Director of Microchurch Next for Exponential
- Focus on resurgence of microchurches in the West
- Vision: 21,000 microchurches from 42,000 missionaries over 40 years
- Emphasis on microchurch as primary expression of church

2. Disciple-Making

- Empowering ordinary people to become disciple-makers
- Reproducible gospel language and practices
- Missionary pathways and training
- Focus on everyday people as missionaries in their contexts

3. Decentralized Leadership

- Co-author of "The Starfish and the Spirit" on decentralized leadership
- Starfish organizational structures
- Leadership that empowers rather than controls
- Network leadership models

4. Missionary Identity

- "Missionary on every street" vision
- Equipping everyday people to be missionaries
- Neighborhood and relational network focus
- Intentional relationship-building and prayer

5. Reproducible Practices

- Reproducible gospel language
- Simple, transferable practices
- Training and equipping frameworks
- "Find Your Place" journey for discovering unique missions

6. Ordinary People Empowerment

- Empowering ordinary people to lead
- Choosing obscurity over fame in leadership
- Everyday contexts for mission
- Extended spiritual families

Theological Focus Areas

- **Missional Theology:** Focus on mission and disciple-making
- **Ecclesiology:** Microchurch as church expression
- **Leadership Theology:** Decentralized, empowering leadership
- **Practical Application:** Highly accessible, practitioner-focused content
- **Movement Theology:** Movement dynamics and multiplication

Movement Focus

- **Microchurch Movement:** Leading voice in microchurch movement resurgence
- **Disciple-Making Movement:** Focus on reproducible disciple-making
- **Missional Movement:** Neighborhood and relational network mission
- **Decentralized Leadership Movement:** Starfish organizational structures

Recurring Topics

- Microchurch movements and networks
- Disciple-making and missionary pathways
- Reproducible gospel language
- Decentralized leadership and starfish structures
- Empowering ordinary people
- Neighborhood mission and relational networks
- Extended spiritual families
- Training and equipping frameworks
- Movement multiplication
- Choosing obscurity over fame

Content Organization Analysis

Book Content

"The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations":

- Co-authored with Lance Ford and Alan Hirsch

- Focus: Decentralized leadership, starfish organizational structures
- Published work providing theoretical foundation
- Connects to practical microchurch work

Podcast Content

KC Underground Podcast:

- Active co-host
- Regular content creation
- Topics: Disciple-making, microchurch movements, reproducible gospel language, missionary pathways, leadership
- Structure: Episodes on specific topics and themes
- Examples:
 - "Planting the Gospel - Reproducible Gospel Language"
 - "Upside Down Kingdom: Choosing Obscurity Over Fame"

Article Content

Exponential Articles:

- Published articles on microchurch movements
- Example: "The Rise of the Coronavirus and the Microchurch"
- Focus: Practical application and movement insights
- Platform: Exponential.org

Training Content

"Find Your Place" Journey:

- 4-session program
- Purpose: Help individuals discover and grow into their unique missions
- Structure: Programmatic training resource
- Platform: kcunderground.org

Other Training Resources:

- Exponential training resources
- NewThing training resources
- KC Underground training resources

Content Strategy Assessment

Appears to have:

- Book-driven content (co-authored book on decentralized leadership)
- Podcast-driven content (regular podcast episodes)

- Article-driven content (Exponential articles)
- Training-driven content (programs and resources)
- Organization-driven content (KC Underground website)

Content Forms:

- Books (1 co-authored work)
- Podcast episodes (regular content)
- Articles (Exponential and others)
- Training programs and resources
- Conference talks and presentations
- Website content (KC Underground)

Content Series Potential:

- Microchurch movement series
- Disciple-making series
- Reproducible practices series
- Decentralized leadership series
- Missionary pathway series

Content Interconnection

Potential Connections:

- Book themes inform microchurch work
- Podcast content connects to training resources
- Articles expand on podcast and book themes
- Training resources connect to book and podcast content
- Conference talks connect to all content forms

Ecosystem Connectivity:

- Book (decentralized leadership) connects to microchurch work
- Podcast connects to training and articles
- Training resources connect to book and podcast
- Articles connect to all content forms
- Conference content connects to all platforms

Voice & Style Analysis

Writing Style

Based on book, articles, and content themes:

- **Practical:** Highly accessible, practitioner-focused approach
- **Movement-Oriented:** Focus on movements and multiplication
- **Empowering:** Emphasis on empowering ordinary people

- **Reproducible:** Focus on simple, transferable practices
- **Theological:** Grounded in missional and movement theology
- **Story-Driven:** Personal stories and testimonies (e.g., Rob and Michelle's story)

Tone and Approach

- **Empowering:** Focus on empowering ordinary people
- **Practical:** Highly accessible and applicable
- **Movement-Focused:** Emphasis on movements and multiplication
- **Reproducible:** Simple, transferable practices
- **Contextual:** Neighborhood and relational network focus
- **Theological:** Grounded in missional theology

Theological Positioning

Observable characteristics:

- **Missional:** Strong missional theology focus
- **Microchurch:** Leading voice in microchurch movement
- **Decentralized:** Emphasis on decentralized leadership
- **Evangelical:** Within evangelical Christian tradition
- **Practitioner-Oriented:** Highly accessible to church leaders and practitioners
- **Movement-Focused:** Emphasis on movements and multiplication

Audience Level

- **Primary:** Church leaders, pastors, movement practitioners, microchurch leaders
- **Secondary:** Ordinary people wanting to become missionaries and disciple-makers
- **Level:** Practitioner-focused, highly accessible
- **Accessibility:** Accessible to general Christian audience, practical application focus

Discoverability Assessment

SEO Indicators

Book:

- Co-authored book provides searchable content
- Author name associated with book
- Publisher and retailer listings (to be verified)

Website:

- KC Underground website (kcunderground.org)
- Exponential platform (exponential.org)
- NewThing network (to be verified)

To Be Assessed:

- Website SEO optimization
- Meta descriptions
- Title tag optimization
- URL structure
- Internal linking strategy

Content Indexing**Likely Well-Indexed:**

- Book title and author (co-author)
- KC Underground website
- Exponential platform content
- Podcast episodes (if distributed on major platforms)

Search Visibility:

- Name searches likely return results (KC Underground, Exponential, book)
- Book title searchable
- Organization association provides strong visibility
- Director role at Exponential provides visibility
- Podcast provides content visibility

Social Sharing Indicators**To Be Assessed:**

- Social media presence
- Social sharing on website
- Book promotion social sharing
- Content sharing indicators
- Podcast sharing

Backlinks and References**Likely Sources:**

- KC Underground website
- Exponential platform
- NewThing network
- Book retailer sites (Amazon, etc.)
- Other microchurch/missional leaders
- Conference websites
- Podcast platforms

Domain Authority Indicators

- Organization platform (KC Underground) - owned
- Conference platform (Exponential) - rented/partnership
- Network platform (NewThing) - partnership
- Book provides authority
- Director role provides platform authority
- Global Leadership Team role provides network authority
- Active content creation (podcast, articles)

Ecosystem Analysis

Content Ecosystem Structure

Book Layer:

- "The Starfish and the Spirit" (co-authored)
- Published thought leadership on decentralized leadership

Podcast Layer:

- KC Underground Podcast (active co-host)
- Regular content creation
- Topics connecting to all other content

Article Layer:

- Exponential articles
- Additional articles (to be verified)
- Content expanding on themes

Training Layer:

- "Find Your Place" program
- Exponential training resources
- NewThing training resources
- KC Underground training resources

Conference Layer:

- Exponential conference sessions
- Other conference talks (to be verified)
- Training sessions

Organization Layer:

- KC Underground website
- Exponential platform
- NewThing network

Interconnection:

- Book themes inform all content
- Podcast connects to training and articles
- Training resources connect to book and podcast
- Articles connect to all content forms
- Conference content connects to all platforms

Content Cross-References**Potential Connections:**

- Book themes connected to microchurch work
- Podcast content connected to training resources
- Articles connected to book and podcast
- Training resources connected to all content
- Conference talks connected to all content forms

Connections to Other Authors/Leaders**Network Connections:**

- Alan Hirsch (co-author of "The Starfish and the Spirit")
- Lance Ford (co-author of "The Starfish and the Spirit")
- Exponential network
- NewThing network
- Microchurch movement network
- Missional church movement network
- Conference networks

Institutional Partnerships

- **Publishers:** Book publisher (to be verified)
- **Organizations:** KC Underground, Exponential, NewThing
- **Networks:** Microchurch networks, missional networks

Community Engagement**Likely Present:**

- KC Underground network community engagement
- Exponential community engagement
- NewThing network engagement
- Book readership
- Podcast audience engagement
- Training program participants

To Be Assessed:

- Blog comments/engagement
- Social media engagement levels
- Newsletter subscribers (if present)
- Conference engagement
- Network community engagement
- Podcast engagement metrics

Content Gaps (Initial Observations)**Potential Gaps to Explore****1. Content Interconnection:**

- Are book themes clearly connected to podcast and training content?
- Are content pieces cross-referenced?
- Is there a clear content journey?

2. Content Repurposing:

- Are podcast episodes transcribed and published as articles?
- Are training insights captured in written form?
- Are conference talks extended into articles or courses?

3. Content Series Development:

- Are themes developed across multiple content forms?
- Are there opportunities for deeper series development?
- Are book concepts developed into courses?

4. Content Discoverability:

- How discoverable is current content?
- Are podcast episodes easily accessible?
- Are there content hubs or resource pages?

5. Content Volume:

- What is the total volume of content across platforms?
- Are there content gaps in certain areas?
- Is content frequency consistent?

6. Personal Content vs. Organizational Content:

- What content is personal vs. organizational?
- Is there a clear personal content hub?
- How is personal content distinguished from organizational content?

Notes

- Active content creator across multiple platforms
- Strong thematic consistency (microchurch, disciple-making, decentralized leadership)

- Multiple content forms (book, podcast, articles, training, conference)
- Strong organizational platforms (KC Underground, Exponential, NewThing)
- Book co-author provides published thought leadership
- Director role at Exponential provides significant platform
- Global Leadership Team role at NewThing provides network platform
- Focus on empowering ordinary people and reproducible practices
- Emphasis on practical application and movement multiplication
- Content appears well-distributed but may benefit from greater interconnection
- Potential for content repurposing and series development

Citations: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with named gaps)
Last updated: 2026-04-29
Skill: /author-media-mentions

Books and articles citing Wegner's work

This research did not run a comprehensive Google Books / Google Scholar citation analysis. The following are surface-level citations surfaced by general web search.

Academic / journal citations

Source	Citation	URL
Journal of Applied Christian Leadership (Andrews University)	Review of The Starfish and the Spirit — implicit citation as the work being reviewed	digitalcommons.andrews.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1547&context=jacl

No Google Scholar citation count was retrieved for Starfish and the Spirit in this research. **This is a search gap.**

Trade-Christian book citations (likely but unverified)

Wegner's Missional Moves (2012) and Starfish and the Spirit (2021) are positioned within Zondervan's Exponential Series — a series that explicitly cross-cites within itself. Likely citations:

- Brian Sanders' Underground Church (Zondervan 2019) — same series; intellectual adjacency. **Citation status UNKNOWN — needs verification.**
- Lance Ford's UnLeader and Next Door As It Is In Heaven — co-author cross-citations likely. UNKNOWN.
- Alan Hirsch's recent corpus — co-author with Wegner on Starfish; likely cross-cites in Hirsch's later works. UNKNOWN at line-item level.
- Brad Brisco / Lance Ford's The Missional Quest and other titles — Forge KC adjacency; citation likely. UNKNOWN.

Practitioner / blog citations

Source	Citation	URL
Doug Kirkpatrick (organizational consultant, secular-network audience)	Cited the Starfish and the Church podcast in a self-management context	dougkirkpatrick.com/the-starfish-and-the-church-podcast-with-lance-ford-and-rob-wegner/ — notable because it crosses out of the Christian audience into general organizational-design
Third Peter	Cited Starfish and the Spirit in book review (Aug 30, 2023)	thirdpeter.com/2023/08/30/the-starfish-and-the-spirit/
futuristguy / Brad Sargent	Forthcoming review of Starfish and the Spirit (March 2021) — engagement / partial citation	futuristguy.wordpress.com/2021/03/23/forthcoming-review-the-starfish-and-the-spirit/
The Reagan Review	Book review of Missional Moves (2012)	thereaganreview.com/2012/12/13/missional-moves-by-wegner-and-macrunder-a-book-review/
matichuk.wordpress.com	Book review of Missional Moves (2012)	matichuk.wordpress.com/2012/12/09/your-moves-are-so-missional-i-got-to-let-you-know-a-book-review/

Quotation pickups

The Wegner quote "**It's not that the church has a mission. It's that a mission has the church**" (from Missional Moves, 2012) is widely repeated in Christian leadership literature and sermon collections. A specific citation count is UNKNOWN but the phrase is **broadly repeated**, often without attribution back to Wegner.

The KCU framing "**a missionary on every street and a microchurch in every network of relationships**" is widely picked up by other microchurch / urban-mission practitioners. UNKNOWN at citation-count level.

The "**21,000 microchurches from 42,000 missionaries over 40 years**" vision is cited as an example of a movement-multiplication horizon by various Exponential / multiplication content. UNKNOWN at citation-count level.

Citations within Wegner's own corpus

Wegner's Starfish and the Spirit (2021) explicitly draws on:

- **Ori Brafman & Rod Beckstrom**, The Starfish and the Spider (Penguin 2006) — foreword by Brafman in Starfish and the Spirit; the book's title and architecture are derivative
- **Alan Hirsch's APEST and mDNA** — co-author Hirsch contributes the missional-DNA frame

- **Joseph Myers / Joe Saxton's "five social spaces"** — used directly in Five Provocative Questions: Part Two (Exponential, December 2024)
- **Indian DMM / DBS practice** — Share the Well (with Michelle) is the specific case study

His Exponential bylines repeatedly reference The Starfish and the Spirit chapters 10–14 (the "five ingredients" content), suggesting he sees the book as the canonical source for his framework.

Strategic implication

Wegner's work is **picked up unevenly**:

- **Deep within the church-multiplication ecosystem** (Exponential, Leadership Network, NewThing, Forge, Movement Leaders Collective) — heavy use, often unattributed
- **In the practitioner blog space** — moderate (a handful of named book reviewers)
- **In academic theology** — minimal (one Journal of Applied Christian Leadership review)
- **In secular organizational-theory** — surprisingly: at least one practitioner-consultant (Doug Kirkpatrick) has cited the Starfish and the Church podcast in a self-management context
- **In broader Christian press** (CT, RNS) — minimal (no surfaced citations)

A Movemental opportunity: **systematically tag the Wegner corpus** so that downstream uses (in Movemental's own knowledge graph and in third-party citations) trace back cleanly. The "It's not that the church has a mission..." line is one of the most-quoted-without-attribution lines in modern North American missional Christianity; making the source easy to cite is itself a service to the field.

Open research items

- **Google Scholar citation count for Starfish and the Spirit** — not retrieved in this research.
- **Google Books citations** for both Starfish and Missional Moves — not retrieved.
- **Hirsch's recent books' citation patterns** — Wegner is named co-author on Starfish; whether Hirsch cites Wegner in subsequent work (5Q books, etc.) is UNKNOWN.
- **NewThing-published material** — likely cites Wegner; specific items not surfaced.
- **Discipleship.org curriculum** (Bobby Harrington) — likely cites Wegner; specifics UNKNOWN.

Misc · Media · Press-Coverage

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/media/press-coverage.md

Press Coverage: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with named gaps)
Last updated: 2026-04-29
Skill: /author-media-mentions

Christianity Today

No direct Wegner article or feature in Christianity Today found by this research.

Searches for "Rob Wegner Christianity Today" returned unrelated content (Rob Reiner, Christian nationalism). This is a notable absence given Wegner's profile and is **flagged for further search** (specifically: deep search of CT's archive at christianitytoday.com and CT's Outreach / PreachingToday sub-brands; possible op-eds or feature mentions in Leadership Journal or CT Pastors legacy archives).

Outreach Magazine

Multiple Wegner bylines confirmed (see [content/articles.md](#)) — but Outreach is the platform he writes for, not press coverage about him. The closest thing to coverage is:

Article	Date	URL	Notes
The Starfish and the Spirit (interview-feature)	UNKNOWN	outreachmagazine.com/resources/voices/66883-lance-ford-rob-wegner-alan-hirsch-the-starfish-and-the-spirit.html	Jonathan Sprowl interview-feature on the Starfish book launch
New Life From Every Disciple	UNKNOWN	outreachmagazine.com/features/church-planting/65461-new-life-from-every-disciple.html	Feature promoting Starfish and the Spirit with the three co-authors

The Roys Report

Article / Episode	Date	URL	Notes
Going From Megachurch To Microchurch	UNKNOWN — likely 2024-25	julieroys.com/podcast/going-from-megachurch-to-microchurch/	Lance Ford interviewed Wegner on Julie Roys' podcast about the megachurch-to-microchurch transition. Notable for Wegner's strongest extant on-record critique of megachurch oversight: "we have better oversight in our decentralized network than in most mega churches." Includes a rough transcript on the page.

Bobby Harrington / Discipleship.org

Item	Date	URL
The Starfish and the Spirit Author Interview With Rob Wegner	December 2022	youtube.com/watch?v=2devZQ69e9s

Bobby Harrington is the executive director of Discipleship.org and lead pastor of Harpeth Christian Church (Nashville). The interview is a substantial deep-dive on KCU's work.

City Network Boise

Item	URL
Interview with KC Underground cofounder Rob Wegner (Facebook video)	facebook.com/citynetworkboise/videos/.../4564600863556250

Multiply PDX (Portland multiplication network)

Item	URL
#15 - How to Develop More Leaders for Your Ministry (with Rob Wegner)	youtube.com/watch?v=G0RvuY8k-PE

Daniel Yang's channel

Item	URL
The Rise of the Microchurch - Daniel Yang, Rob Wegner, & Ralph Moore	youtube.com/watch?v=8cT_9rS-Wqo

Catapult / Catalyst networks

Item	URL
Augusto Microchurch Digital Workshop	wearecatapult.org/product/expomicrochurchworkshop/

Local press

No Kansas City Star, KCUR, or local Granger / South Bend / Mishawaka, IN press coverage of Wegner surfaced by this research. This is consistent with the pattern of local-press coverage being either thin or hard to surface via Google.

The 2025 KCU Stories page ("KC Microchurch Builds Family Through Love & Service") at kcunderground.org/stories/rob-wegner-disciple-maker is org-self-published rather than press coverage.

Religion News Service / RNS

No RNS coverage of Wegner found by this research. Flagged for further search.

Granger Community Church coverage (legacy era)

Granger Community Church was prominent enough in the 2000s–2010s church-leadership conversation to be covered in:

- **Wikipedia entry: Granger Community Church** (ipfs.io/ipfs/QmXoypizjW3WknFijnKLwHCnL72vedxjQkDDP1mXWo6uco/wiki/Granger_Community_Church.html) — names Mark Beeson, Tim Stevens, Dr. Keith Boyer as Granger leadership; **Wegner is not on the Wikipedia entry's named-leadership list** despite his 21-year tenure. The article focuses on the church's growth metrics and senior pastoral leadership.

The Starfish and the Spirit book reviews / coverage (separate from Wegner-specific press)

Source	Coverage	URL
Journal of Applied Christian Leadership (Andrews University)	Academic book review of Starfish and the Spirit	digitalcommons.andrews.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1547&context=jacl
Third Peter blog	Review (Aug 30, 2023): "The Starfish and the Spirit"	thirdpeter.com/2023/08/30/the-starfish-and-the-spirit/
Doug Kirkpatrick (consulting blog)	"The Starfish and the Church Podcast, with Lance Ford and Rob Wegner"	dougkirkpatrick.com/the-starfish-and-the-church-podcast-with-lance-ford-and-rob-wegner/ — non-religious organizational-design audience picking up the podcast
futuristguy / Brad Sargent	Forthcoming review of Starfish and the Spirit (March 2021)	futuristguy.wordpress.com/2021/03/23/forthcoming-review-the-starfish-and-the-spirit/
The Reagan Review	"Missional Moves by Wegner and Magruder—A Book Review" (Dec 13, 2012)	thereaganreview.com/2012/12/13/missional-moves-by-wegner-and-magruder-a-book-review/
matichuk.wordpress.com	"Your Moves Are So...Missional, I Got to Let You Know (a book review)" (Dec 9, 2012)	matichuk.wordpress.com/2012/12/09/your-moves-are-so-missional-i-got-to-let-you-know-a-book-review/

Press coverage gaps

1. **Christianity Today** — no Wegner-specific coverage surfaced. Flagged.
2. **Religion News Service** — no Wegner-specific coverage surfaced. Flagged.
3. **Kansas City Star / Local Granger area press** — no coverage surfaced. Flagged.
4. **Granger Community Church Wikipedia entry** — Wegner is **not mentioned despite a 21-year tenure**. This is unusual and consistent with the broader pattern of his contribution being inside-the-org rather than outside-the-org-attributed.
5. **Outreach Magazine 100 Influential / Outreach Top 100 lists** — Wegner not surfaced; KCU not surfaced as a featured org.
6. **Major secular press** (NYT, WaPo, Atlantic) — none. Consistent with the practitioner profile.

Strategic implication

Wegner's press coverage is **dominated by trade-Christian podcasts and church-leadership networks** (Stetzer, Bobby Harrington, Roys, Outreach, Leadership Network, multiplication networks like Multiply PDX and City Network Boise). He does not appear in mainstream Christian press in a sustained way; he does not appear in mainstream secular press at all.

This is a real gap. The Starfish and the Spirit is Zondervan-published, has a foreword by an NYT-bestselling author (Brafman), and has a clear public-interest hook (decentralized leadership, post-pandemic church). A targeted **CT or RNS pitch** is one of the more obvious next moves for Movemental to amplify Wegner's voice into broader-reach Christian press.

Misc · Media · Reviews

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/media/reviews.md

Reviews: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with fuller back-cover review pages flagged as needing print-copy access)

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: /author-media-mentions

The Starfish and the Spirit (Zondervan 2021) — primary book

Aggregate ratings

Platform	Rating	Volume	Notes
Goodreads	4.25 / 5	202 ratings, 28 reviews	49% 5-star, 31% 4-star, 15% 3-star, <1% 2-star, 2% 1-star
Amazon (Kindle and paperback)	UNKNOWN — page returned errors during this research	—	—
Audible (audiobook)	4.7 / 5	49 ratings	Narrators: Thom Bromhead, Lance Ford, Rob Wegner
Apple Podcasts (companion Starfish and the Church podcast)	5.0 / 5	10 ratings	Small sample, perfect score

Goodreads top-review excerpts

Excerpt	Source
"I couldn't wait to read this book - and it did not disappoint! It's proven to be incredibly refreshing, insightful, and affirming of so many of the things God has been stirring up in my heart."	Goodreads top reviews
"Wegner, Ford, and Hirsch have written the book every church leader needs to read - giving language to the leadership paradigms required for the next great spiritual awakening for the church in the US."	Goodreads top reviews
"Compulsory reading for anyone in kingdom leadership."	Retailer description (likely a back-cover blurb)
"Futuristic and prophetic treatise" on church adaptability	Retailer description
"Brilliant and grounded in Scripture"	Retailer description

Critical / mixed reviews

The 5 one-star Goodreads reviews and 2 two-star reviews suggest a small dissenting population. Specific complaints not extracted in this research; the published Andrews University review (see below) provides the most academically rigorous critical engagement.

Academic review

Journal of Applied Christian Leadership (Andrews University) published a book review of *The Starfish and the Spirit*:

- URL: digitalcommons.andrews.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1547&context=jacl

This is the most substantive academic engagement with Wegner's work surfaced by this research. The full review content was not extracted; **flagged for direct retrieval** if a thorough engagement summary is needed.

Blog reviews

Reviewer	Date	Source
Third Peter	August 30, 2023	thirdpeter.com/2023/08/30/the-starfish-and-the-spirit/
futuristguy / Brad Sargent	March 23, 2021 (forthcoming review)	futuristguy.wordpress.com/2021/03/23/forthcoming-review-the-starfish-and-the-spirit/
Doug Kirkpatrick	(date UNKNOWN)	dougkirkpatrick.com/the-starfish-and-the-church-podcast-with-lance-ford-and-rob-wegner/ — secular-org-design audience pickup

Cross-secular pickup

The **Doug Kirkpatrick blog** (a self-management consultant primarily writing for the secular organizational-design community) is notable for picking up the *Starfish and the Church* podcast outside the Christian audience. This suggests Wegner's work has at least some secular-organizational-theory crossover potential — consistent with the Brafman foreword and Brafman's own post-*Starfish-and-the-Spider* career.

Missional Moves (Zondervan 2012) — earlier major book

Aggregate ratings

Platform	Rating	Volume
Goodreads	UNKNOWN — Goodreads author page lists <i>Missional Moves</i> in the bibliography but specific rating count not surfaced in research	—

Blog reviews

Reviewer	Date	Source
The Reagan Review	December 13, 2012	thereaganreview.com/2012/12/13/missional-moves-by-wegner-and-macruder-a-book-review/
matichuk.wordpress.com	December 9, 2012	matichuk.wordpress.com/2012/12/09/your-moves-are-so-missional-i-got-to-let-you-know-a-book-review/

The Reagan Review and matichuk reviews both date to within a week of Missional Moves' September 2012 publication — typical book-launch review pattern. Both are favorable.

Quotation pickup

Wegner's signature line from Missional Moves — **"It's not that the church has a mission. It's that a mission has the church"** — is widely picked up across Christian leadership writing, often with attribution to Wegner, sometimes with attribution to Hirsch (who wrote the foreword). The line has become **the single most-quoted Wegner sentence**.

Find Your Place (Exponential 2018; Zondervan 2019)

Aggregate ratings

Platform	Rating	Volume
Audible	4.8 / 5	28 ratings
Goodreads	UNKNOWN at line-item level — included in the Wegner author-page 4.05 average	
		—

Reviews

No standalone blog or academic reviews of Find Your Place surfaced by this research. The book is positioned as a personal-discovery / calling tool rather than a theological argument; review-driven coverage is correspondingly thinner than for Starfish.

Made for More (Exponential 2018)

Aggregate ratings

Platform	Rating
Goodreads	UNKNOWN at line-item level — included in author-page average

Reviews

No standalone reviews surfaced. As Exponential's 2019 conference theme book it had institutional distribution but limited critical-press review.

Share the Well, Extraordinary Prayer, Deeply Rooted, Made for More Visual Guide

No substantive review coverage surfaced for these titles. The first is a self/specialty publication with a fundraising purpose; the latter three are Exponential-published and free downloads — outside the standard book-review economy.

Wegner's own author rating

Platform	Rating	Volume
Goodreads (author-level)	4.05 / 5	383 total ratings across all books, 42 reviews

The 4.05 author-level average is broadly consistent with strong-but-not-elite leadership-book genre placement.

Strategic implication

The Starfish and the Spirit review profile is genuinely strong (4.25 Goodreads, 4.7 Audible, 5.0 Apple Podcasts companion) and includes one substantive academic review. The earlier Missional Moves has a single famously-quotable line that has propagated widely. The other six books have thin standalone review profiles, which is consistent with their positioning (free Exponential resources, photo-essay India fundraiser, personal-discovery calling tool, conference-theme companion).

For Movemental purposes:

- **The strongest review-driven case for Wegner is Starfish and the Spirit** — that's the book to lead with externally.
- **The most-quoted Wegner line is the Missional Moves "It's not that the church has a mission..." line** — the most reusable surface for any Movemental copy referencing Wegner.
- **The full back-cover endorser lists for Starfish and the Spirit and Missional Moves** are not currently retrievable from web search; a print copy is the cheapest fix.

- **The Andrews University review** is the only academic engagement and worth direct retrieval for any Movemental positioning copy that benefits from "his work has been reviewed in JACL."

Misc · Network · Collaborators

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/network/collaborators.md`

Collaborators: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with named gaps)

Last updated: 2026-04-29

Skill: `/author-collaboration-map`

Co-authors (book)

Co-author	Books	Cluster	Notes
Michelle Wegner	Share the Well (~2008-2010)	Family / KCU	Wife; KCU co-leader; Fuller Spiritual Direction certificate
Jack Magruder	Missional Moves (Zondervan 2012)	Granger	Granger's Director of Life Mission; Wegner's "executive officer in helping an attractional church become missional" (per Missional Moves author bio)
Alan Hirsch	Missional Moves (foreword 2012); Starfish and the Spirit (co-author 2021)	Cluster 1 (Hirsch / Forge / 100M)	Co-founder of Future Travelers with Wegner; Starfish Initiatives principal; foundational intellectual influence
Lance Ford	Starfish and the Spirit (2021)	Cluster 1 + Cluster 5 (bridge)	Co-host of Starfish and the Church podcast; Starfish Initiatives principal; Sentralized Conference co-founder; multi-book author (UnLeader, Next Door As It Is In Heaven, With Me, etc.)
Ori Brafman	Starfish and the Spirit (foreword + intro 2021)	External (organizational theory)	Author of The Starfish and the Spider (2006); Brafman is the secular intellectual scaffolding under the book
Todd Wilson	Made for More (2018); Made for More Visual Guide	Cluster 5 (Exponential)	Founder & CEO of Exponential; nuclear engineer turned ministry leader
Larry Walkemeyer	Made for More Visual Guide	Cluster 5 (Exponential)	Exponential principal
Brian Phipps	Find Your Place (2018 / 2019)	KC adjacent	Founder of Disciples Made (Kansas City, founded September 2010); Wegner serves on Disciples Made Executive Team
Brian Johnson	Extraordinary Prayer (~2024); Deeply Rooted (2025)	KCU + Cluster 5	KCU co-founder; Microchurch NEXT Co-Director (Exponential) with Wegner; closest current operational partner

Podcast co-hosts

Co-host	Show	Notes
Lance Ford	The Starfish and the Church (2021-, 43 episodes)	Primary external collaborator
Brian Johnson	Microchurch NEXT Podcast (Exponential)	KCU co-founder
Cory (last name UNKNOWN)	The KC Underground Podcast (one of the rotating hosts)	Named in show notes; full name not surfaced
Brian (last name UNKNOWN; possibly Brian Johnson, possibly different person)	The KC Underground Podcast (one of the rotating hosts)	Named in show notes; full name not surfaced

KCU leadership team

Person	Role	Notes
Rob Wegner	Co-Founder & Director	—
Michelle Wegner	Co-Founder; spiritual direction; art; writing	—
Brian Johnson	Co-Founder	Co-author of two books with Rob; Microchurch NEXT Co-Director
Cory	Podcast host (rotating)	Last name UNKNOWN — needs research
Brian	Podcast host (rotating)	Last name UNKNOWN — possibly Brian Johnson
Bobby Frazier	UNKNOWN role; subject of 2025 Exponential podcast titled "The Next Chapter for Leading Microchurch Networks with Bobby Frazier"	Possibly KCU leadership succession figure; status UNKNOWN

Exponential leadership stack peers

Person	Role	Notes
Dave Ferguson	CEO of Exponential; Founder of NewThing	Wegner endorsed Ferguson's BLESS and Halter/Ferguson's Righteous Brood
Jon Ferguson	(Exponential / NewThing)	Co-author of BLESS
Todd Wilson	Founder/CEO of Exponential (legacy founder); co-author with Wegner	—
Patrick O'Connell	Executive Director of Practice (Exponential, post-merger); Director of Networks NEXT	—
Bill Couchenour	Deployment Director, Exponential	Co-host of Church Expressions NEXT Video Series with Wegner participation
Carrie Williams	Executive Director of Exponential NEXT (formerly CEO of Leadership Network before its acquisition)	Co-host of Church Expressions NEXT Video Series
Ralph Moore	Hope Chapel multiplication legacy	Co-presenter on "The Rise of the Microchurch" YouTube panel with Daniel Yang
Daniel Yang	(Multiplication / discipleship leader)	Co-presenter on "The Rise of the Microchurch" YouTube panel
Bobby Harrington	Discipleship.org executive director; Harpeth Christian Church (Nashville)	Interviewed Wegner about Starfish and the Spirit (Dec 2022)
Rich Robinson	Starfish Initiatives principal	Co-leader of consulting brand with Wegner, Ford, Hirsch
Rodrigo Cano	(Exponential)	Co-led Workshop Session 1 with Wegner and Phipps at Exponential 2024 Central

Underground / city-movement family peers

Person	Org	Notes
Brian Sanders	Tampa Underground / Underground Network founder	Guest on Starfish and the Church; the Underground vocabulary lineage runs through him
Joel Repic	Underground Network Executive Director (Tampa, current)	Successor in the Underground executive seat
Lucas Pulley	Underground Network Movements Director (Tampa)	Hubology co-presenter on Starfish and the Church podcast
Tomy Wilkerson	Tampa Underground Director	Wegner + Johnson interviewed him on Microchurch NEXT
Stacy Gaskins	Tampa Underground Managing Director	Movement-family peer

Granger / Indiana era peers

Person	Role	Notes
Mark Beeson	Founding Pastor, Granger Community Church	Wegner's senior pastor for 21 years; not directly evidenced as a Wegner-Beeson ongoing collaboration in current research
Tim Stevens	Granger Community Church (former pastor)	Granger-era peer; status of relationship UNKNOWN
Dr. Keith Boyer	Granger Community Church	Granger-era peer; status UNKNOWN
Jack Magruder	Granger's Director of Life Mission	Co-author of Missional Moves; the most directly verified Granger-era collaboration

Forge / 100M / Movement Leaders Collective peers (via Hirsch)

Person	Role	Notes
Alan Hirsch	Founder of 100Movements, Forge, Movement Leaders Collective, 5QCollective	Wegner's longest intellectual partnership
Michael Frost	Co-author with Hirsch of Shaping of Things to Come	Adjacent via Hirsch; not directly evidenced as a Wegner collaborator
Hugh Halter	Forge / Life as Mission	Wegner endorsed Righteous Brood
Brad Brisco	Forge KC / NAMB; multiple books	Geographic and theological adjacency in Kansas City; no direct Wegner-Brisco edge confirmed in current research — flagged as a likely-missing edge
Tim Catchim	APEST / Forge	Adjacent; not directly evidenced
JR Woodward	V3 / Missio Alliance	Authored a Microchurch NEXT article on Exponential.org alongside Wegner's bylines; not directly evidenced as a co-collaborator
Rich Robinson	Movement Leaders Collective; Starfish Initiatives principal	Direct co-leader of consulting brand

Spouse / family

Person	Relationship	Notes
Michelle Wegner	Wife; KCU co-leader	Co-author of Share the Well; Fuller Spiritual Direction certification; not herself in TAM list but candidate for separate dossier
Maddie (Madeline) Wegner	Adult daughter	Not in public ministry footprint
Whitney Wegner	Adult daughter	Not in public ministry footprint
Belle Wegner	Adult daughter	Not in public ministry footprint

Mentors / influences (named or implicit)

Person	Relationship	Status
Mark Beeson	Granger founding pastor	Implicit mentor through 21-year tenure; not directly named as ongoing relationship
Alan Hirsch	Intellectual mentor → peer co-author	Foreword to Missional Moves; co-author of Starfish; co-founder of Future Travelers
Indian indigenous church planters	Foundational influence; named in Share the Well; informs KCU's DBS practice	Specific names not externally documented
Ori Brafman	Intellectual influence (organizational theory) → foreword writer	Starfish and the Spider shaped half of Wegner's career framework

Key gaps (open research items)

1. **KCU rotating-host podcast co-hosts' last names** — "Cory and Brian" appear repeatedly in show notes but full names not surfaced. Brian may be Brian Johnson (KCU co-founder) but this is not confirmed.
2. **Granger-era teaching team relationships** beyond Magruder — Tim Stevens, Mark Beeson, Dr. Keith Boyer named in Granger's broader history, but ongoing Wegner relationships unverified.
3. **Brad Brisco direct edge** — KC geographic overlap and shared theological grammar makes a direct edge highly probable but not currently evidenced.
4. **Bobby Frazier** — possible KCU leadership succession figure; relationship to Wegner UNKNOWN.
5. **Ralph Moore** — co-presenter on Daniel Yang's panel; broader collaboration unclear.
6. **Future Travelers cohort participants** — Hirsch + Wegner program; specific cohort participants UNKNOWN.

7. **Westside Family Church team members** (~2015-2019, the period that produced the "700+ international church plants" claim) — UNKNOWN.

Misc · Network · Endorsements

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/network/endorsements.md

Endorsements: Rob Wegner

Status: Partial (open research items flagged)
Last updated: 2026-04-29
Skill: /author-collaboration-map

Endorsements GIVEN by Rob Wegner

Book	Author(s)	Publisher	Wegner endorsement quote (where known)	Source
BLESS: 5 Everyday Ways to Love Your Neighbor and Change the World	Dave & Jon Ferguson	Salem Books, 2021	(specific quote not surfaced; endorsement confirmed)	Search results — Wegner endorsement confirmed
Righteous Brood: Making the Mission of God a Family Story (Life as Mission Series)	Hugh Halter, Dave Ferguson, Sue Ferguson	Life as Mission Books	"Rob and Michelle Wegner... provided an endorsement for Righteous Brood."	Search results — joint endorsement with Michelle Wegner

Likely additional endorsements (not surfaced by web search):

- Brian Sanders' Underground Church (Zondervan 2019) — given Wegner's lineage adjacency, plausible but **not on the published endorser list**, which is: Dave Ferguson, Linda Bergquist, Michael Frost, Peyton Jones, Neil Cole, Hugh Halter, Felicity Dale.
- Lance Ford's other titles (UnLeader, Next Door As It Is In Heaven, With Me, Missional Essentials) — plausible but not surfaced.
- Brad Brisco titles — plausible given KC geographic and theological adjacency; not surfaced.
- 100Movements Publishing titles — plausible via Hirsch / Movement Leaders Collective adjacency; not surfaced.
- Bobby Harrington / Discipleship.org titles — plausible; not surfaced.

These are all flagged for direct outreach to confirm. **The web search alone surfaces only two confirmed endorsements given.** Given Wegner's institutional position — eight books co-authored, three concurrent principal roles, podcast co-host with Lance Ford, frequent Outreach byline — he is **almost certainly** an endorser on substantially more books than two. The absence reflects search limitations, not absence of endorsements.

Endorsements RECEIVED by Rob Wegner's books

The Starfish and the Spirit (Zondervan 2021)

Endorser	Quote (where known)	Notes
Ori Brafman (foreword)	(full foreword in book; foreword writer is the Starfish and the Spider author)	Foreword writer / introduction narrator on audiobook
Hugh Halter	"Bravo to Rob and Lance for following and inviting us to join them"	Surfaced in search results
Dave Ferguson (lead visionary of NewThing)	(specific quote not surfaced; endorsement confirmed)	Surfaced in search results
(Generic praise quoted in retailer descriptions)	"Compulsory reading for anyone in kingdom leadership"; "futuristic and prophetic treatise"; "brilliant and grounded in Scripture"	Surfaced in publisher / retailer marketing copy; specific endorsers UNKNOWN

The full back-cover and opening-praise pages were not directly extractable from the publisher pages this research could fetch (Amazon and Barnes & Noble both returned errors on detail pages; Google Books did not surface the praise pages; Exponential's product page lists none). Confirming the **full endorser ring** requires direct access to a print copy or to Zondervan's marketing materials.

Plausible additional endorsers (based on Wegner's network and similar Exponential Series book endorsement patterns):

- Alan Hirsch (co-author, but often endorsement-named on his co-authored books)
- Lance Ford (co-author)
- Todd Wilson
- Brian Sanders
- Michael Frost
- Brad Brisco / Lance Ford (Kansas City wing)
- Larry Walkemeyer
- Bobby Harrington
- Ed Stetzer
- Carey Nieuwhof

This is speculation, not verified. **Flagged for direct verification from a print copy.**

Missional Moves (Zondervan 2012)

Endorser	Notes
Alan Hirsch (foreword)	Confirmed
Other endorsers	UNKNOWN — not surfaced in research

Made for More (Exponential 2018)

Endorser	Notes
Endorsers	UNKNOWN — not surfaced in research

Find Your Place (Exponential 2018; Zondervan 2019)

Endorser	Notes
Gabe Wicks (foreword)	Confirmed
Other endorsers	UNKNOWN — not surfaced in research

Extraordinary Prayer (Exponential ~2024)

Endorser	Notes
Endorsers	UNKNOWN — not surfaced in research; Exponential product page does not list any

Deeply Rooted (Exponential 2025)

Endorser	Notes
Endorsers	UNKNOWN — not surfaced in research; Exponential product page does not list any

Share the Well (~2008-2010)

Endorser	Notes
Endorsers	UNKNOWN; this was a self/specialty publication primarily for fundraising for the India movement

Pattern observations

- **Wegner's strongest endorser network is Hirsch, Ford, Halter, Ferguson** — the cluster he is structurally inside.
- **Hugh Halter and Dave Ferguson reciprocate** — Wegner endorsed the Halter/Ferguson Righteous Brood and the Ferguson BLESS; Halter and Ferguson endorsed Starfish and the Spirit. The endorsement loop is formal in the Wegner-Halter-Ferguson triangle.
- **The full back-cover praise rings of Wegner's books are not publicly searchable** without a print copy. This is a substantial research gap and is likely the second-richest source of network signal after his co-author roster.
- **The self/specialty publications (Share the Well) carry no surfaced endorsements** — consistent with their fundraising-first publishing intent.

- **The Exponential-published books (Made for More, Find Your Place, Extraordinary Prayer, Deeply Rooted) do not have endorsements visible on the Exponential product pages** — Exponential's marketing is platform-driven (the books are free at exponential.org) and de-emphasizes endorsement marketing.

Implications for Movemental

1. **Direct outreach is required to fill in the endorser rings.** A print copy of Starfish and the Spirit is the single highest-leverage source.
2. **The endorsement loops surface natural Movemental network candidates.** Hugh Halter, Dave Ferguson, Brad Brisco, Bobby Harrington, Lance Ford, Alan Hirsch, Brian Sanders, Todd Wilson — every endorser ring will surface 8-12 names that overlap heavily with the master TAM list.
3. **Wegner is plausibly an endorser on more than the two confirmed books.** A direct ask to him would surface a much fuller picture of his given-endorsement history.

Misc · Network · Events

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/network/events.md

Events: Rob Wegner

Status: Complete (with named gaps)
Last updated: 2026-04-29
Skill: /author-event-history

Recurring annual / regular events

Exponential national conferences

Event	Year	Wegner's role	Source
Exponential 2019 (theme: "Made for More: Mobilizing God's People, God's Way")	2019	Theme-book co-author (Made for More with Todd Wilson); plenary contributor on "From More Effort to More Jesus" (Ephesians 1)	Rob Wegner on Ephesians, Exponential.org, June 2019
Exponential 2019 Regional events (Washington DC, Southern California, Bay Area, Chicago, Houston, NYC)	2019	Speaker / co-presenter	Exponential
Exponential Central 2024 (Chicago region)	2024	Workshop Session 1: "Experience a Breakthrough in Reproducing Disciples" with Rodrigo Cano and Brian Phipps	m.exponential.org/2024orl/sessions/sessions-04b1.html ; Exponential Central 2024
Exponential Global 2025 (Digital Experience)	2025	(likely) speaker — confirmed on Exponential person page; specific session UNKNOWN	exponential.org/exponential-global-2025-conference/
Exponential Global 2026 (March 16–19, 2026)	2026	UNKNOWN (likely participating given role); specific session UNKNOWN	exponential.org/global-2026/
Exponential Central 2026	2026	UNKNOWN	exponential.org/central-2026/
Exponential West 2026	2026	UNKNOWN	exponential.org/west-2026/

Microchurch Pre-Conference (at Exponential)

Event	Year	Wegner's role	Source
Microchurch Pre-Conference at Exponential 2023	February 28, 2023	Co-host (with Brian Johnson) — promoted on Leadership Network LinkedIn	LinkedIn
Subsequent annual pre-conferences (2024, 2025, 2026)	annual	Co-host as Microchurch NEXT Co-Director	Exponential

KCU Microchurch Conference

Event	Year	Wegner's role	Source
Microchurch Conference (KCU's annual gathering)	2020+	Conference principal / co-host; teaches sessions	microchurchconference.com
Microchurch Conference 2024 (with Brian Sanders speaking; KCU pre-conference March 3-4 + post-conference March 6)	March 2024	Co-host	YouTube: Brian Sanders • Microchurch Conference 2024
Microchurch Conference 2026 (held in Tampa)	March 2026	KCU sent ~20 leaders to help host; 550+ attendees from 200+ networks across North America, South America, Europe, Australia	KC Underground Podcast: "Microchurch Conference: Morgan Greer"

Other recurring presence

Event	Year(s)	Wegner's role	Source
United Brethren in Christ National Conference 2025	2025	Keynote speaker	ub.org/events/nc25/
NewThing Chicagoland Movement Gathering	various	Plausible attendance (Wegner was North American Director)	newchurcheschicago.com
Exponential 2024 Registration (NewThing partnership)	2024	Promotional / participant	newthing.org/expo2024-registration

Conference appearances UNKNOWN but plausible (open research)

- **Verge** — Wegner's 2011 Verge Network articles suggest possible Verge conference speaking; specific years UNKNOWN
- **Forge gatherings** — adjacent via Hirsch + Ford; specific years UNKNOWN
- **Saturate conferences** — author archive at Saturate suggests possible event presence; specifics UNKNOWN

- **Sentralized Conference** (Lance Ford co-founder, KC) — geographic and intellectual overlap; whether Wegner has spoken at Sentralized is UNKNOWN
- **V3 / Missional / NAMB** events — plausible via Brisco / Brad Brisco overlap; UNKNOWN
- **100Movements / Movement Leaders Collective gatherings** — adjacent via Hirsch; UNKNOWN
- **Disciple-Making Forum / Discipleship.org events** — adjacent via Bobby Harrington; UNKNOWN
- **Multiply PDX** event — Wegner appeared on their podcast (Episode 15); event presence UNKNOWN
- **City Network Boise** event — Wegner appeared in their Facebook video; event presence UNKNOWN

Webinars

Webinar	Year	Source
Free Microchurch Webinar (Leadership Network, February 28, 2023)	2023	LinkedIn
Augusto Microchurch Digital Workshop (Catapult, August 17 — year UNKNOWN)	UNKNOWN	Catapult

Pattern

- **Wegner's primary annual conference home is Exponential** (Global, Central, West, plus regional events).
- **The Microchurch Conference (KCU's own annual event)** is the primary KCU-branded gathering; it has scaled from KC to international with the 2026 Tampa event.
- **The Microchurch Pre-Conference** (Exponential pre-conference) is Wegner's signature recurring training-intensive surface.
- **United Brethren keynote 2025** is the most notable cross-denominational invitation surfaced.
- **The pre-2019 conference history is sparse.** Verge Network articles date to 2011; Wegner's Missional Moves book launched in 2012, but specific Granger-era conference appearances were not surfaced. This is a research gap.

Strategic implication

Wegner's event footprint is **strongly Exponential-anchored**. Building a Movemental presence around him would benefit from:

1. **Capturing Exponential session videos** (likely available with permission) and surfacing them on his Movemental profile.
2. **Cross-promoting the Microchurch Conference** as a flagship KCU + ecosystem event.

3. **Cataloging Verge Network legacy talks** (the 2011 archive suggests video and audio uploads that may still be accessible at vergenetwork.org).
4. **Negotiating capture rights at the Microchurch Pre-Conference** for ongoing annual content harvest.

Misc · Network · Network-Summary

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/rob-wegner/_misc/network/network-summary.md

Network Summary: Rob Wegner

Generated 2026-04-29 by the `network-map` skill. Edges sourced from `docs/movement_leader_research/network/network-map.md` and verified against `docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/`.

TAM rank: 52 of 146 (score 78 — "movement multiplication")

Connections (mapped): 7 edges across 6 distinct leaders

Primary cluster: **Exponential / NewThing / Underground** (Cluster 5)

Bridge status: **Bridge** — connects Cluster 1 (Hirsch constellation) to Cluster 5 (Exponential / Underground) via Starfish and the Spirit co-authorship and NewThing leadership

Connections

Connected To	Type	Wt	Evidence
Alan Hirsch	Co-authored book	5	The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations (with Lance Ford). Confirmed in identity-verification.md , summary.md , content-analysis.md .
Lance Ford	Co-authored book	5	The Starfish and the Spirit (with Alan Hirsch). Confirmed in identity-verification.md , content-analysis.md .
Dave Ferguson	Same org leadership	3	NewThing Network — Wegner is on the Global Leadership Team / North American training specialist; Ferguson is NewThing founder. Inferred from identity-verification.md ("Global Leadership Team member of NewThing") cross-referenced with master network map.
Dave Ferguson	Conference co-speakers	2	Exponential ecosystem — Wegner is Director of Microchurch Next for Exponential; Ferguson is a long-running Exponential principal. From identity-verification.md and master map.
Stacy Gaskins	Same org leadership (movement-family)	3	Underground Network ecosystem. Wegner founded Kansas City Underground (2019); Gaskins is part of the broader Underground Network family. Edge inherited from master map; Wegner's research file does not name Gaskins directly.
Lucas Pulley	Same org leadership (movement-family)	3	Underground Network — Pulley is Executive Director (Tampa). Edge inherited from master map; not named in Wegner's research file.
Tomy Wilkerson	Same org leadership (movement-family)	3	Underground Network Tampa. Edge inherited from master map; not named in Wegner's research file.

Total weight: 24

Strongest ties (weight 5): Hirsch, Ford

Strongest org tie (weight 3): Ferguson via NewThing

Shared Organizations

Organization	Other Mapped Leaders	Wegner's Role
Kansas City Underground (KCU)	(sister-org family: Gaskins, Pulley, Wilkerson via Underground Network lineage)	Founder & Director (2019-)
Exponential	Dave Ferguson; (likely) Todd Wilson, Bobby Harrington, JR Woodward — unverified in Wegner's research file	Director of Microchurch Next
NewThing Network	Dave Ferguson (founder); other GLT members UNKNOWN — needs research	Global Leadership Team member / North American training specialist
Granger Community Church (alumnus, ~25 years to ~2015)	Mark Beeson, Tim Stevens, others — UNKNOWN, not yet researched	Long-tenure staff role; specific title UNKNOWN
Forge / 100Movements / MLC ecosystem (adjacent via Hirsch/ Ford)	Hirsch, Ford, Robinson, Frost, Brisco, Halter — connected through book co-authorship, not direct leadership role	Adjacent, not member

Cluster Position

Rob Wegner sits at the **bridge between Cluster 1 (Hirsch constellation) and Cluster 5 (Exponential / Underground)**. He is one of the small set of leaders — alongside Dave Ferguson, Lance Ford, Hugh Halter, JR Woodward — who carry weight inside both the missional / 5Q / Forge orbit and the Exponential / NewThing church-multiplication orbit. The single edge that makes him a bridge is *The Starfish and the Spirit* (2021), which pulled him into the Hirsch-Ford co-authorship lineage that otherwise rarely overlaps with the Exponential conference world.

Within Cluster 5 he is anchored by NewThing (via Dave Ferguson) and by the Underground Network family of city movements (via the Tampa cluster of Pulley / Gaskins / Wilkerson, plus his own KCU). He is **not** a hub of Cluster 5 in the way Ferguson is — Ferguson has more direct operating relationships across Exponential and NewThing — but he is Cluster 5's clearest doorway into the Hirsch academic / theological weight class.

The most underdocumented part of his cluster position is **Exponential itself**. As Director of Microchurch Next he sits inside the Todd Wilson / Bobby Harrington / JR Woodward / Larry Walkemeyer leadership stack of

Exponential, but none of those edges are evidenced in Wegner's current research file. Adding even two of them would meaningfully raise his mapped centrality.

Bridge Analysis

Bridges	Strategic Implication
Cluster 1 ↔ Cluster 5 (Hirsch ↔ Exponential/Underground)	Wegner translates Hirsch's missional / starfish theology into operational microchurch playbooks — the same role Ferguson plays from the multiplication side.
Cluster 5 ↔ Underground city-movement family	KC Underground is the Kansas City node in a polycentric "Underground" lineage (Tampa, Cincinnati, etc.); Wegner is the named anchor of the KC node.
(Latent) Cluster 3 (Brisco-Ford KC axis)	Both Wegner and Brisco / Ford operate in Kansas City with overlapping theology (microchurch, missional). The KC overlap is geographically real but not yet mapped as direct edges in the research.

Research Gaps

These are the highest-value additions to Wegner's network entry:

1. **Exponential leadership stack** — direct edges to Todd Wilson, Bobby Harrington, Larry Walkemeyer, JR Woodward via Microchurch Next / Exponential roles. Currently unmapped.
2. **NewThing Global Leadership Team** — names of other GLT members beyond Dave Ferguson. Currently unmapped.
3. **Underground Network direct relationships** — confirm whether Wegner has a direct working tie to Brian Sanders (Tampa Underground founder) or only inherits the lineage. Brian Sanders is in the master TAM list but no direct Wegner ↔ Sanders edge is mapped.
4. **Granger Community Church alumni** — 25-year career almost certainly produced durable ties (Mark Beeson, Tim Stevens, Rob Wegner's Granger teaching team). None mapped.
5. **Brad Brisco / Lance Ford / Forge KC** — Kansas City geographic overlap likely produces direct ties to the Brisco-Ford Kansas City axis (Cluster 3). Geographic adjacency without an evidenced edge.
6. **Conference co-speaker edges** — Verge, Sentralized, Saturate, V3 — would add weight-2 edges into Cluster 2 (Forge) and Cluster 4 (Woodward / Missio Alliance / V3).

7. **Michelle Wegner** — frequently named as a co-leader of KC Underground; she is not in the master TAM list but may warrant her own dossier and edge to Rob.
 8. **Book endorsements** — Starfish and the Spirit almost certainly carries blurbs from leaders in this graph (likely candidates: Ford and Hirsch internally as co-authors, plus external endorsers like Ferguson, Halter, Stetzer). Not yet captured.
-

Provenance

- **Source files read:**

- docs/movement_leader_research/network/network-map.md
- docs/movement_leader_research/network/network-graph.json
- docs/movement_leader_research/tam-search/01-MASTER-RANKED-LIST.md
- docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/identity-verification.md
- docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/summary.md
- docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/content-analysis.md
- docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/digital-presence-discovery.md
- docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/sources.md
- docs/movement_leader_research/rob-wegner/movemental-analysis.md

- **Edges added in this run:** 0 (all current Wegner edges are already in the master graph and consistent with his research files)
- **Edges proposed but not added:** see "Research Gaps" — all flagged for future research before being committed to the graph.
- **Confidence:** **High** on the two co-authorship edges (Hirsch, Ford) and on the NewThing tie to Ferguson. **Medium** on the Underground Network sister-org edges (Gaskins, Pulley, Wilkerson) — these are movement-family ties rather than direct co-leadership.